

Streams in the Desert 1
by L. B. Cowman

荒漠甘泉上

考門夫人著

January 1

The land you are ... to take possession of is a land of mountains and valleys that drinks rain from heaven. It is a land the Lord your God cares for; the eyes of the Lord your God are continually on it from the beginning of the year to its end. (Deuteronomy 11:11-12)

If He is the Source of our mercies, mercy will never fail us. No heat or drought can dry the “river whose streams make glad the city of God” (Ps. 46:4).

If life were always smooth and level, the boring sameness would weigh us down. It is the difficulty encountered on the hills that drives us to the throne of grace and brings the showers of blessing. Yes, it is the hills, the cold and seemingly barren hills of life that we question and complain about, that bring down the showers. And how many would have been killed by the cold, destroyed or swept desolate of their fruitfulness by the wind, if not for the hills—stern, hard, rugged, and so steep to climb? God’s hills are a gracious protection for His people against their foes!

Nicholaus Ludwig Zinzendorf

January 2

The side rooms all around the temple were wider at each successive level. The structure surrounding the temple was built in ascending stages, so that the rooms widened as one went upward. A stairway went up from the lowest floor to the top floor through the middle floor. (Ezekiel 41:7)

We should never be content to rest in the mists of the valley when the summit of Mount Tabor awaits us. How pure is the dew of the hills, how fresh is the mountain air, how rich the food and drink of those who dwell above, whose windows look into the New Jerusalem! Many saints are content to live like people in coal mines, who never see the sun. Tears sadden their faces when they could be anointed with heavenly oil. I am convinced that many believers suffer in a dungeon when they could walk on a palace roof, viewing the lush landscape and Lebanon. Wake up, believers, from your lowly condition! Throw away your laziness, sluggishness, coldness, or whatever is interfering with your pure love for Christ. Make Him the Source, the Center, and the One who encompasses every delight of your soul. Refuse to be satisfied any

一月一日

「你們要過去得為業的那地乃是有山有谷，雨水滋潤之地，是耶和華你神所眷顧的。從歲首到年終，耶和華你神的眼目時常看顧那地。」
(申11:11-12)

祂既是我們所蒙憐憫的源頭，這憐憫便永不會使我們失望。沒有熱力或乾旱能使「神的城歡喜的河」(詩46:4)乾涸。

若生命總是平順和平坦，沉悶的千篇一律會使我們沮喪。在山中遇見的困難驅使我們去到施恩座前求神帶來恩雨。是的，我們所質疑和埋怨的寒冷和似乎貧瘠的山中生活就是帶來恩雨的山。若不是有嚴峻、難行、崎嶇和太陟斜難爬的山，又有多少人死於寒冷之中，被疾風摧毀或吹走他們的果實而丟零？神的山是祂子民面對仇敵時的施恩保護！

尼古拉斯·甩域·辛新多夫

一月二日

「這圍殿的旁屋越高越寬。因旁屋圍殿懸疊而上，所以越上越寬，從下一層，由中一層，到上一層。」(結41:7)

當他泊山頂等着我們攀登時，我們不應安於山谷的迷霧中。山間露水是何等清純，山上空氣何等清新，那些在上面居住之人的飲食何等豐饒，他們的窗門外望新耶路撒冷！很多聖徒滿足於像煤礦工人的生活，他們從來不見天日。當他們得天上的油膏抹時，必會以淚洗面。我深信很多信徒當行在王宮殿頂時，遙望鬱蔥的景致和利巴嫩時，他們卻像困於地牢中受煎熬。信徒啊，從你低下的情況下醒來吧！棄掉你的懶惰、緩慢、冷漠、或任何使你對基督純潔之愛受干擾的東西。以祂為本源、中心、和將生命喜悅之事圍繞你的那一位。拒

longer with your meager accomplishments. Aspire to a higher, a nobler, and a fuller life. Upward to heaven! Nearer to God!

Charles H. Spurgeon

Too low they build who build beneath the stars.

January 3

I [will] move along slowly at the pace of the droves before me and that of the children. (Genesis 33:14)

“Since you have never been this way before” (Josh. 3:4).

We “have never been this way before,” but the Lord Jesus has. It is all untraveled and unknown ground to us, but He knows it all through personal experience. He knows the steep places that take our breath away, the rocky paths that make our feet ache, the hot and shadeless stretches that bring us to exhaustion, and the rushing rivers that we have to cross—Jesus has gone through it all before us. As John 4:6 shows, “Jesus, tired as he was from the journey, sat down.” He was battered by every possible torrent, but all the floodwaters coming against Him never quenched His love. Jesus was made a perfect leader by the things He suffered. “He knows how we are formed, he remembers that we are dust” (Ps. 103:14). Think of that when you are tempted to question the gentleness of His leading. He remembers all the time and will never make you take even one step beyond what your feet are able to endure. Never mind if you think you are unable to take another step, for either He will strengthen you to make you able, or He will call a sudden halt, and you will not have to take it at all.

Frances Ridley Havergal

January 4

Jesus replied, “You may go. Your son will live.” The man took Jesus at his word and departed. (John 4:50)

Whatever you ask for in prayer, believe. (Mark 11:24)

When you are confronted with a matter that requires immediate prayer, pray until you believe God—until with wholehearted sincerity you can thank Him for the answer. If you do not see the external answer immediately, do not pray for it in such a way that it is evident you are not definitely believing God for it, you will find that your faith has been weakened

絕再滿足於你微薄的成就，立志作一個更高、更尊貴和更豐盛的生命。往天上行！更親近神！

司布真

星空下建築的人建築得太低。

一月三日

「我要量着在我面前群畜和孩子的力量慢慢地前行。」(創33:14)

「因為這條路你們向來沒有走過。」(書3:4)

主耶穌走過我們從未走過的路。我們完全未到過和未識之地祂藉個人經歷全認識。祂知道那些叫我們喘氣的陡斜之地，那些石路叫我們腳痛，那酷熱無蔭之長路帶叫我們虛脫，還有洶湧之河我們必要渡過。這一切耶穌在我們前面都已走過。正如約4:6所說「耶穌因走路困乏，就坐在井旁。」祂被每個可能的洪流所肆虐，但所有衝着祂而來的大水永不能叫祂的愛熄滅。耶穌藉祂所忍受的東西使祂成為一完美的領頭人。「因為祂知道我們的本體，思念我們不過是塵土。」(詩103:14)想想當你被試探來質疑祂的帶領是否仁慈時，祂任何時候都緊記不叫你腳走不能忍受的一步。不要介懷想到你不能多走一步，因為祂必會加你力來叫你能以行上，或者祂會臨時叫停，叫你一步也不用行上。

弗朗西斯·里德利·海弗格爾

一月四日

「耶穌對他說：回去吧。你的兒子活了。那人信耶穌所說的話，就回去了。」(約4:50)

「相信凡你們禱告祈求的。」(可11:24)

當需要立時祈禱的事情來到時，祈禱直至你相信神，直至你全心實意地為着祂的垂聽來感謝祂。若你見不到即時的外在垂聽，不要再用這方法來祈禱了，明顯你在這事上肯定是不相信神，你會發覺你的信心已然削弱，甚或完全丟失了。

or has entirely gone. The urgency you felt to offer this kind of prayer is clearly from self and Satan.

You may tell Him you are waiting, still believing and therefore praising Him for the answer. There is nothing that so fully solidifies faith as being so sure of the answer that you can thank God for it. “Now we who have believed enter that rest” (Heb. 4:3).

The type of prayer that empties us of faith frequently arises from focusing our thoughts on the difficulty rather than on God’s promise. Abraham, “without weakening in his faith, ... faced the fact that his body was as good as dead....Yet he did not waver through unbelief regarding the promise of God, but was strengthened in his faith and gave glory to God” (Rom. 4:19-20). May we “watch and pray so that [we] will not fall into [the] temptation” (Matt. 26:41) of praying faith-diminishing prayers.

C. H. P.

Faith is not a sense, nor sight, nor reason, but simply taking God at His word.

Christmas Evans

The beginning of anxiety is the end of faith, and the beginning of true faith is the end of anxiety.

George Mueller

You will never learn faith in comfortable surroundings. God gives us His promises in a quiet hour, seals our covenants with great and gracious words, and then steps back, waiting to see how much we believe. He then allows the Tempter to come, and the ensuing test seems to contradict all that He has spoken. This is when faith wins its crown. This is the time to look up through the storm, and among the trembling, frightened sailors declare, “I have faith in God that it will happen just as he told me” (Acts 27:25).

January 5

Then Asa ... said, “Lord, there is no one like you to help the powerless against the mighty.” (2 Chronicles 14:11)

Remind God of His exclusive responsibility: “There is no one like you to help.” The odds against Asa’s men were enormous. “Zerah the Cushite marched out against them with a vast army and three hundred chariots” (v. 9). It seemed impossible for Asa to hold his

你感到要逼切來作這種禱告明顯是出於自己和撒但。

你要對神說你正等待，仍相信，因而為着垂聽來感謝祂。沒有像因肯定得蒙垂聽而感謝神來得信心完全堅固。「但我們已經相信的人，得以進入那安息。」（來4:3）

叫我們信心一掃而空的祈禱常因我們專注想到我們的困難，而不想到神的應許。亞伯拉罕「雖然想到自己的身體如同已死，.....他的信心還是不軟弱。並且仰望神的應許，.....反倒因信，心裏得堅固，將榮耀歸給神。」（羅4:19-20）讓我們「儆醒禱告，免得入了迷惑」（太26:41）來作那削弱信心的祈禱。

C.H.P.

信心不是感覺，不是眼見，不是理性，而只是單單接受神的話。

克瑞斯馬·伊凡思

憂慮的開始便是信心的結束；真信的開始便是憂慮的結束。

慕勒

你永不能藉安舒的環境學到信心。神在安靜時刻給我們祂的應許，以偉大和恩惠的說話把約封印後便退去，等看我們信得多少。之後祂容許試探者來到，而隨後的試煉似乎與祂所有曾說的都背道而馳。這就是信心可贏取冠冕之時。這也是抬頭望着暴風雨，在那些戰慄和驚恐的水手中宣告「我信神，祂怎樣對我說：事情也要怎樣成就。」（徒27:25）的時刻。

一月五日

「亞撒呼求耶和華他的神說：耶和華阿，惟有祢能幫助軟弱的。」（代下14:11）

要提醒神祂獨有「惟有祢能幫助」的責任。亞撒方面的人所面對的逆境是巨大的，「有古實王謝拉率領軍兵一百萬，戰車三百輛。」（代下14:9）亞撒在敵人人多勢眾的

own against that vast multitude. There were no allies who would come to his defense. Therefore his only hope was in God.

Asa, realizing his lack of strength, saw Jehovah as standing between the might of Zerah and himself. Believe that He is between you and your difficulty, and what troubles you will flee before Him, as clouds in the wind.

F. B. Meyer

January 6

When you pass through the waters ... they will not sweep over you. (Isaiah 43:2)

God does not open paths for us before we come to them, or provide help before help is needed. He does not remove obstacles out of our way before we reach them. Yet when we are at our point of need, God's hand is outstretched.

Many people forget this truth and continually worry about difficulties they envision in the future. They expect God to open and clear many miles of road before them, but He promises to do it step by step, only as their need arises. You must be in the floodwaters before you can claim God's promise. Many people dread death and are distressed that they do not have "dying grace." Of course, they will never have the grace for death when they are in good health. Why should they have it while in the midst of life's duties, with death still far away? Living grace is what is needed for life's work and calling, and then dying grace when it is time to die.

J. R. M.

January 7

I have learned to be content whatever the circumstances. (Philippians 4:11)

Paul, while being denied every comfort, wrote the above words from a dark prison cell.

A king who went to his garden one morning, only to find everything withered and dying. Yet coming to a violet, the king found its face as bright and happy as ever and said, "Well, violet, I'm glad to find one brave little flower in the midst of this discouragement. You don't seem to be the least disheartened." The violet responded, "No, I'm not. I know I'm small, yet I thought if you wanted an oak or a pine or a peach tree or even a lilac, you would have planted one. Since I knew you wanted a violet, I'm determined to be the best little

情況下能立於不敗之地似乎沒有可能。既無盟友來作保衛，那麼他唯一的希望就在於神了。

明瞭一己缺乏力量的亞撒見到耶和華站在謝拉的強軍和他自己之間。當相信祂是在你和你的困難中間時，任何困擾你的事物在祂面前都會如雲在風吹下逃跑了。

邁爾

一月六日

「你從水中經過，.....水必不漫過你。」(賽43:2)

我們若非走上，神不會打通那路徑；祂也在我們真需要幫助時才提供幫助；在我們到達障礙物之前祂不會移除他們。然而當我們來到需要當前時，神的手是伸張的。

很多人忘記這真理，卻持續在擔憂他們預視未來的困難。他們期待神清除多哩以外路途上的障礙，祂卻應許一步一步來作，就在他們的需要冒起時。要到你身在洪水當中時你才會索取神的應許。多人怕死，因沒有那「好死」而苦惱。他們還是身壯力健時當然不會得着好死的恩典了，在他們正值生命盡責之年，死亡仍遙遙無期時，又怎會得着這個？生命的工作和呼召所需的是活着的恩典，要到死亡一刻才是好死恩典之時。

J.R.M.

一月七日

「我無論在甚麼景況，都可以知足。」(腓4:11)

保羅寫以上說話時，是身陷黑暗的囚牢中，失卻任何安舒。

一個王帝在某個早上來到他的花園，發現每樣東西都是垂死凋謝。他看見一棵紫羅蘭如往昔般燦爛開心，便說：「紫羅蘭啊，我高興在這沮喪當中有一勇敢的小花。你似乎連少少的洩氣也沒有。」答說：「沒有，我知我細小，但我想你若想要一棵橡樹、松樹、桃樹甚或丁香，你便會種植。只因我知你想要一棵紫羅蘭，我便決定作一棵我

violet I can be.”

January 8

I will send down showers in season; there will be showers of blessing. (Ezekiel 34:26)

A season of drought is the season for showers. A season of great heaviness with dark clouds too is the season for showers. “Your strength will equal your days” (Deut. 33:25). Notice that the word “showers” is plural.

God will send all kinds of blessings. And all His blessings go together like links in a golden chain. If He gives you saving grace, He will also give you comforting grace.

Charles H. Spurgeon

Job received sunshine after the rain. You have crowned Your sorrow. Let this be my crown, O Lord. I will only triumph in You once I have learned the radiance of the rain.

George Matheson

January 9

I consider that our present sufferings are not worth comparing with the glory that will be revealed in us. (Romans 8:18)

I watched my imprisoned moth patiently striving and struggling to be free. In any case, I thought I was wiser and more compassionate than its Maker, so I resolved to give it a helping hand. With the point of my scissors, I snipped the confining threads to make the exit just a little easier. Immediately and with perfect ease, my moth crawled out, dragging a huge swollen body and little shriveled wings! My misplaced tenderness had proved to be its ruin. The moth suffered an aborted life, crawling painfully through its brief existence instead of flying through the air on rainbow wings.

Our Father’s love is too steadfast to be weak. Because He loves His children, He “disciplines us ... that we may share in his holiness” (Heb. 12:10). With this glorious purpose in sight, He does not relieve our crying. Made perfect through suffering, as our Elder Brother was, we children of God are disciplined to make us obedient, and brought to glory through much tribulation.

from a tract

能夠作得最好的小紫羅蘭。」

一月八日

「我也必叫時雨落下，必有福如甘霖而降。」(結 34:26)

旱季隨後是雨季。黑雲重壓也是降雨的季節。「你的日子如何，你的力量也必如何。」(申 33:25) 當留意「甘霖」(showers) 一詞是覆數的。

神必會降下各類的福，這些所有的福就像金鏈子環環相扣。祂若給你救恩，祂也會給你安慰的恩典。

司布真

約伯雨後得到陽光。祢已將祢的憂愁加上冠冕，那麼，主啊，就讓這成為我的冠冕吧。我一旦學會了雨的光輝便能在祢裏頭得勝了。

喬治·麥得勝

一月九日

「我想現在的苦楚，若比起將來要顯於我們的榮耀，就不足介意了。」(羅 8:18)

我見我的皇帝蛾兒整朝在忍耐地努力和掙扎去得自由。在任何事上以為較創造者聰明和富同情心的我斷然伸出援手了。我用剪刀剪斷那外圍的絲線來令到那出口略為方便吧了，我的蛾兒立能輕易地爬出，拖曳着龐大肥腫的身軀和那對無力的翅膀！我錯誤的慈悲已證明做成牠的損毀。蛾兒因發育不全而受苦，在牠短暫的存在中痛苦地爬行，而不是以牠彩虹的雙翼在空中飛翔。

我們天父堅定不移的愛不致退縮。因祂愛祂的兒女，祂「管教我們.....使我們在祂的聖潔上有分。」(來 12:10) 祂既有這榮耀目的在望，便不會解除我們的痛苦。我們作神兒女的既如長兄般藉受苦得完全，好應藉管教來順服，藉更多的苦難來引進榮耀。

摘自一小冊子

January 10

Paul and his companions ... [were] kept by the Holy Spirit from preaching the word in the province of Asia. (Acts 16:6)

It is interesting to study the way God extended His guidance to these early messengers of the Cross. It consisted mainly in prohibiting their movement when they attempted to take a course other than the right one. When they wanted to turn to the left, toward Asia, He stopped them. When they sought to turn to the right, toward Bithynia in Asia Minor, He stopped them again. In his later years, Paul would do some of his greatest work in that very region, yet now the door was closed before him by the Holy Spirit. The time was not yet ripe for the attack on these apparently impregnable bastions of the kingdom of Satan. Apollos needed to go there first to lay the groundwork. Paul and Barnabas were needed more urgently elsewhere and required further training before undertaking this responsible task.

Let me hear Your voice behind me whenever I 'turn aside to the right or to the left' [Deut. 5:32]."

January 11

Comfort, comfort my people, says your God. (Isaiah 40:1)

Store up comfort. This was the prophet Isaiah's mission. The world is full of hurting and comfortless hearts. But before you will be competent for this lofty ministry, you must be trained. And your training is extremely costly, for to make it complete, you too must endure the same afflictions that are wringing countless hearts of tears and blood. Consequently, your own life becomes the hospital ward where you are taught the divine art of comfort. You will be wounded so that in the binding up of your wounds by the Great Physician, you may learn how to render first aid to the wounded everywhere. Do you wonder why you are having to experience some great sorrow? Over the next ten years you will find many others afflicted in the same way. You will tell them how you suffered and were comforted. As the story unfolds, God will apply the anesthetic He once used on you to them. Then in the eager look followed by the gleam of hope that chases the shadow of despair from the soul, you will know why you were afflicted. And you will bless God for the discipline that filled your life with such a treasure of experience and helpfulness.

一月十日

「聖靈既然禁止他們（保羅和同伴）在亞西亞講道。」（徒16:6）

認識神給這些早期十字架的傳訊者在引導上的延展是有趣的，它主要包括禁止他們的行動，那時他們試圖走上不對的路途上。當他們想右轉入亞洲時，祂阻止他們。當他們想轉左進入小亞細亞的庇推尼時，祂再次阻止他們。在保羅作工的後期年月中，他就在這些地區中作那最偉大的工作，但如今在他面前的門被聖靈關上了。攻擊撒但王國中這些似乎是堅不可摧的堡壘的時機尚未成熟，還需阿波羅先奠下根基的工作，保羅和巴拿巴在進行這責任重大的工作前要到更有需要去的地方作進一步的訓練。

讓我得聽我後面祢不『偏離左右』（申:12）的聲音。

一月十一日

「你們的神說：你們要安慰，安慰我的百姓。」（賽 40:1）

先知以賽亞的使命是將安慰貯存起來。世界充滿受傷和不得安慰的心靈，在你有資格來作這高尚的使命前，定須接受訓練，而這訓練極之昂貴；為使這工得完成，你同時必須忍受使無數的心擠出淚和血那相同的苦痛。到頭來，你自己的生命成為學會了安慰這神聖藝術的醫院病房。你必要受傷，當那偉大的醫生替你包紮傷口時，你便學會怎樣向每處的受傷患者實施急救了。你是否不明白為何要經歷一些重大的憂傷？在未來的十年中，你將會遇見受相同痛苦的人，你會告訴他們你怎樣受苦和如何得着安慰。當你將實情相告時，神便會敷上祂曾用在你身上的麻醉藥了。之後在隨着希望之光將別人失望的陰影驅除後而來的期待面容上，你知道你為何要受苦；你便感謝神的管教來使你的生命充滿這般寶貴的經驗和於人有益了。

God comforts us not to make us comfortable but to make us comforters.

John Henry Jowett

神安慰我們不是要使我們舒服，而是使我們成為安慰者。

約翰·亨利·祖屈

January 12

Reckon it nothing but joy ... whenever you find yourself hedged in by the various trials, be assured that the testing of your faith leads to power of endurance. (James 1:2-3 WEYMOUTH)

God hedges in His own in order to protect them. Yet often they only see the wrong side of the hedge and therefore misunderstand His actions. And so it was with Job when he asked, "Why is life given to a man whose way is hidden, whom God has hedged in?" (Job 3:23). Ah, but Satan knew the value of that hedge! He challenged the Lord by saying, "Have you not put a hedge around [Job] and his household and everything he has?" (Job 1:10).

Onto the pages of every trial there are narrow shafts of light that shine. Thorns will not prick you until you lean against them, and not one will touch you without God knowing.

January 13

In all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us. (Romans 8:37)

Temptation is necessary to establish and ground us in our spiritual life. It is like the fierce winds that cause the mighty cedars on the mountainside to sink their roots more deeply into the soil. Our spiritual conflicts are among our most wonderful blessings, and the Adversary is used to train us for his own ultimate defeat.

The prophet Isaiah tells of "fly[ing] upon the shoulders of the Philistines" (Isa. 11:14 KJV). They would be able not only to conquer the Philistines but also to ride on their backs to further triumphs. Just as a skilled sailor can use a head wind to carry him forward, by using its impelling power to follow a zigzag course, it is possible for us in our spiritual life, through the victorious grace of God, to turn completely around the things that seem most unfriendly and unfavorable. Then we will be able to say continually, "What has happened to me has really served to advance the gospel" (Phil. 1:12).

一月十二日

「我的弟兄們，你們落在百般試煉中，都要以為大喜樂。因為知道你們的信心經過試驗就生忍耐。」（雅1:2-3）

神圈上籬笆是要保護他們，但他們只常見到籬笆錯誤的一面，誤會神的舉動。約伯說「人的道路既然遮隱，神又把他四面圍困，為何有光賜給他呢？」（伯3:23）上這樣誤會神。呀！撒但認識這籬笆的價值！他挑戰神說：「你豈不是四面圈上籬笆，圍護他和他的家，並他一切所有的麼？」（伯1:10）

每個試煉總有一微弱光線照射其上，荊棘不會刺傷你，除非你挨其上，未得神的知悉下沒有一荊棘會觸碰到你的。

一月十三日

「然而靠着愛我們的主，在這一切的事上，已經得勝有餘了。」（羅8:37）

必須有試探來建立和鞏固我們的屬靈生命。這就像疾風會使在山邊的巨大雪松把根更深地沉入泥土中一樣。我們屬靈的爭戰是在我們最奇妙的恩福之中，而仇敵是被用來訓練我們去帶來他至終的被擊敗。

先知以賽亞說到「撲在非利士人的肩頭上」（賽11:14）。他們不單打敗非利士人，且撲在他們的肩頭上，得進一步的勝利。如同一個熟練的水手能用逆風來載他前行，方法是用風的推動力來走那之字型的航道。同樣在我們屬靈的生命上，藉着神得勝的恩典也是可以將那些似乎是最不友善和不利的東西完全倒轉過來。那麼我們得以持續說：「我所遭遇的事，更是叫福音興旺。」（腓1:12）

But thanks be to God, who always leads us in triumphal procession in Christ and through us spreads everywhere the fragrance of the knowledge of him. 2 Corinthians 2:14

January 14

When he has brought out all his own, he goes on ahead of them. (John 10:4)

This is intensely difficult work for Him and us—it is difficult for us to go, but equally difficult for Him to cause us pain. Yet it must be done. It would not be in our best interest to always remain in one happy and comfortable location. Therefore He moves us forward. The shepherd leaves the fold so the sheep will move on to the vitalizing mountain slopes. In the same way, laborers must be driven out into the harvest, or else the golden grain would spoil.

This is the blessed life—not anxious to see far down the road nor overly concerned about the next step, not eager to choose the path nor weighted down with the heavy responsibilities of the future, but quietly following the Shepherd, one step at a time.

January 15

That night the Lord appeared to [Isaac]. (Genesis 26:24)

Why did it come to Isaac the night he reached Beersheba? Because that was the night he reached rest. In his old land he had been tormented. There had been a whole series of petty quarrels over the ownership of insignificant wells. Therefore he was determined to leave and seek a change of scenery. He pitched his tent far away from the place of his former strife. That very night the revelation came. God spoke to him when there was no inner storm. He could not speak to Isaac when his mind was troubled. God's voice demands the silence of the soul. Only in the quiet of the spirit could Isaac hear the garments of his God brush by him. His still night became his shining night.

My soul, have you pondered these words: "Be still, and know" (Ps. 46:10)? In the hour of distress, you cannot hear the answer to your prayers. How often has the answer seemed to come much later! The heart heard no reply during the moment of its crying, its thunder, its earthquake, and its fire. But once the

「感謝神，常帥領我們在基督裏誇勝，並藉着我們在各處顯揚那因認識基督而有的香氣。」(林後2:14)

一月十四日

「既放出自己的羊來，就在前頭走。」(約10:4)

對於祂和我們來說，這都是極度困難的工作。我們要向前走是難，要祂使我們受痛苦也是同樣的難。停留在一快樂和舒適的地方不會帶給我們最大的益處，因此祂帶我們前行。牧羊人離開羊圈，羊便要前行往使他們回復生氣的山坡處去。同樣地，勞力的人須被趕往禾場去，否則金黃的穀物會變壞。

蒙福生命就是不為路上遠處所遇上或是為看下一步而過度關切而憂慮，不熱衷於選擇前路或因未來的重責而垂頭喪氣；卻是靜靜地跟隨牧羊人每次走一步。

一月十五日

「當夜耶和華向他(以撒)顯現。」(創26:24)

為甚麼神在以撒來到別是巴那晚來到？因為他就在這晚得着安息。他在這重回之地被欺負，為的是一系列無價值水井擁有權的小規模爭執。因此他決意去離開和尋找視野上的改換，他在遠離吵架之地來搭帳棚。就在這晚那啟示來到，當他再沒有內裏的風暴時神便來向他說話。若他心思仍是騷亂時神不能向以撒說話的。神的聲音是需求靈魂安靜的。只有當靈的安靜時以撒才能聽到神的衣袍擦過他的衣袍。祂那靜止的一晚成為他蒙光照的一晚。

我的魂啊，你曾否默想「要休息，要知道」(詩46:10)？在悲歎的時刻中，你不能聽到你的祈禱蒙允。祈禱蒙允似乎經常都會遲來！在響聲、行雷、地震和火中的心是聽不到禱告蒙應允的。但一旦響聲

crying stopped, once the stillness came, once your hand refrained from knocking on the iron gate, and once concern for other lives broke through the tragedy of your own life, the long-awaited reply appeared.

George Matheson

停止，一旦靜止來到時，一旦你的手不再敲打鐵閘時，一旦關懷別人的生命突破一己生命的悲慘時，那期待已久的答覆便會出現。

喬治·麥得勝

January 16

A furious squall came up. (Mark 4:37)

Some of life's storms—a great sorrow, a bitter disappointment, a crushing defeat—suddenly come upon us. Others may come slowly, appearing on the uneven edge of the horizon no larger than a person's hand. But trouble that seems so insignificant spreads until it covers the sky and overwhelms us.

No one is complete until he has been out into the surge of the storm and has found the glorious fulfillment of the prayer "O God, take me, break me, make me."

January 17

Daniel, servant of the living God, has your God, whom you serve continually, been able to rescue you? (Daniel 6:20)

We forget that He is now exactly what He was three or four thousand years ago, that He has the same sovereign power, and that He extends the same gracious love toward those who love and serve Him.

Martin Luther, deep in thought and needing to grasp hidden strength during a time of danger and fear in his life, was seen tracing on the table with his finger the words, "He lives! He lives!"

Alexander Maclaren

Dr. John Douglas Adam considered his greatest spiritual asset to be his unwavering awareness of the actual presence of Jesus. He said Christ was the center of his thoughts. Whenever his mind was free from other matters, it would turn to Christ. Whenever he was alone, and no matter where he was, he would talk aloud to Christ as easily and as naturally as to any human friend. That is how very real Jesus' actual presence was to him."

January 18

Thanks be to God, who always leads us in triumphal procession in Christ. (2 Corinthians 2:14)

God wins His greatest victories through apparent defeats. Very often the enemy seems to triumph for a

一月十六日

「忽然起了暴風。」(可4:37)

人生的一些風暴是忽然來到的，有太大的憂傷，有苦痛的失望，有徹底的打敗。也有慢慢來到的，在天際的邊陲出現時也不及一隻手掌大。似乎不甚起眼的困難來到時忽然就鋪天蓋地地傾覆我們。

沒有人完全，直至被放進風暴的波浪中才發覺祈禱的榮美成就：「神啊，用我，陶我，造我。」

一月十七日

「永生神的僕人但以理阿，你所常事奉的神能救你脫離獅子麼？」(但6:20)

我們忘記了祂與三四千年前的祂無異，祂仍有那相同的至高權力，祂向那些愛祂服事祂的人所施的乃是相同的恩典。

有一次馬丁·路德面對生命的危險和驚恐而沉思，需尋求隱藏力量時，有人發現他在枱上摹寫「祂活！祂活！」等字。

亞歷山大·麥拿倫

約翰·德格斯·亞當博士認為他最偉大的屬靈資產是他對耶穌真實存在的不動搖認識。他說基督是他思想的中心。每當他不再想到任何事時，便轉向基督。每當他獨自一人，無論身在何方，他會高聲與基督說話，如同與任何一人類朋友交談般隨意和自然。對他來說真實的耶穌就這樣真的和他同在。」

一月十八日

「感謝神，常帥領我們在基督裏誇勝。」(林後2:14)

神藉似乎被打敗來取得祂最大的勝利。多時仇敵似乎勝利一時，

season, and God allows it. But then He comes in and upsets the work of the enemy, overthrows the apparent victory, and as the Bible says, “frustrates the ways of the wicked” (Ps. 146:9). Consequently, He gives us a much greater victory than we would have known had He not allowed the enemy seemingly to triumph in the first place.

The enemy “crowded around them. They saw that the fire had not harmed their bodies, nor was a hair of their heads singed; their robes were not scorched, and there was no smell of fire on them ... for no other god can save in this way” (Dan. 3:27, 29).

January 19

Then Jesus told his disciples ... that they should always pray and not give up. (Luke 18:1)

Prayer that uses previously unanswered prayers as an excuse for laziness has already ceased to be a prayer of faith. To someone who prays in faith, unanswered prayers are simply the evidence that the answer is much closer. From beginning to end, our Lord’s lessons and examples teach us that prayer that is not steadfast and persistent, nor revived and refreshed, and does not gather strength from previous prayers is not the prayer that will triumph.

William Arthur

January 20

Sorrow is better than laughter, because a sad face is good for the heart. (Ecclesiastes 7:3)

In a fallen world, sorrow, yet with despair removed, is the power chosen to reveal us to ourselves. Accordingly, it is sorrow that causes us to take the time to think deeply and seriously.

God never uses anyone to a great degree until He breaks the person completely. Joseph experienced more sorrow than the other sons of Jacob, and it led him into a ministry of food for all the nations. For this reason, the Holy Spirit said of him, “Joseph is a fruitful vine ... near a spring, whose branches climb over a wall” (Gen. 49:22). It takes sorrow to expand and deepen the soul.

from The Heavenly Life

January 21

I consider my life worth nothing to me, if only I may finish the race and complete the task the Lord Jesus has given me. (Acts 20:24)

卻原來是得神容許的。但隨後祂進而顛覆仇敵的工作，推翻他似乎的勝利，正如聖經所說：「使惡人的道路彎曲」(詩146:9)。到頭來，祂給我們的勝利比我們所認識祂容讓仇敵得着表面的勝利大得多。

仇敵們「一同聚集看這三個人，見火無力傷他們的身體，頭髮也沒有燒焦，衣裳也沒有變色，並沒有火燎的氣味。.....因為沒有別神能這樣施行拯救。」(但3:27,29)

一月十九日

「耶穌設一個比喻，是要人常常禱告，不可灰心。」(路18:1)

禱告者若用先前禱告未蒙應允作為懶惰的藉口便已不再是相信的禱告者了。對於用信禱告的人，未蒙應允的禱告不過是應允更近的明證。由始至終，我們主的教訓和榜樣都教導我們不持久和不堅持的禱告、不復甦不常新的禱告、和不能從先前的禱告來積聚力量的禱告都不是會得勝的禱告。

威廉·亞瑟

一月二十日

「憂愁強如喜笑，因為面帶愁容，終必使心喜樂。」(傳7:3)

在墮落的世界，在除去絕望下，憂慮被選擇用來揭示我們自己的能力，因此憂慮使我們花時間來作深入並認真的思考。

神永不大用人，除非祂完全將這人破碎。約瑟經歷的憂傷比雅各的其他兒子更多，這也領他來到為各國供應食物的職事。為這緣故，聖靈這樣說到他：「約瑟.....是泉旁多結果的枝子，他的枝條探出牆外。」(創49:22) 憂慮叫靈魂得以擴展和進深。

摘自《屬天的生命》

一月二十一日

「我卻不以性命為念，也不看為寶貴，只要行完我的路程，成就我從主耶穌所領受的職事。」(徒20:24)

We read in 2 Samuel 5:17, “When the Philistines heard that David had been anointed king over Israel, they went up in full force to search for him.” The moment we receive anything from the Lord worth fighting for, the Devil comes seeking to destroy us.

When the Enemy confronts us at the threshold of any great work for God, we should accept it as evidence of our salvation, and claim double the blessing, victory, and power.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

Crowns are cast in crucibles, and the chains of character found at the feet of God are forged in earthly flames. No one wins the greatest victory until he has walked the winepress of woe. With deep furrows of anguish on His brow, the “man of sorrows” (Isa. 53:3) said, “In this world you will have trouble” (John 16:33). But immediately comes the psalm of promise, “Take heart! I have overcome the world.”

“These are they who have come out of the great tribulation” (Rev. 7:14). In spite of his blindness, wasn’t Homer the unparalleled poet of the Greeks? Writing *Pilgrim’s Progress*, John Bunyan’s vision gilded the dingy walls of an old English jail in Bedford, while he, a princely prisoner and a glorious genius, made a faithful transcript of the scene.

January 22

He withdrew ... to a solitary place. (Matthew 14:13)

There is no music during a musical rest, but the rest is part of the making of the music. In the melody of our life, the music is separated here and there by rests. During those rests, we foolishly believe we have come to the end of the song. God sends us times of forced leisure by allowing sickness, disappointed plans, and frustrated efforts. He brings a sudden pause in the choral hymn of our lives, and we lament that our voices must be silent. We grieve that our part is missing in the music that continually rises to the ear of our Creator.

God does not write the music of our lives without a plan. Our part is to learn the tune and not be discouraged during the rests. They are not to be slurred over or omitted, nor used to destroy the melody or to change the key. If we will only look up, God Himself will count the time for us. With our eyes on Him, our next note will be full and clear.

在撒下5:17我們讀到：「非利士人聽見人膏大衛作以色列王，非利士眾人就上來尋索大衛。」在我們為主爭戰而得着任何東西時，魔鬼便會來嘗試毀滅我們。

當仇敵在我們為神作大工的門檻迎面而來時，我們應認定這卻顯明我們的救恩，叫我們祈求雙倍的祝福、勝利和能力。

摘自《在地若天的日子》

冠冕是在坩鍋鑄造的，神腳處的種種好品格都是地上火焰鍛煉成的。最大的勝利是藉走過悲痛的壓酒池得着的。面容滿佈深刻苦惱皺紋的「憂患之子」(賽53:3)說：「在世上你們有苦難。」接着來到的是應許的讚歌：「你們可以放心，我已經勝了世界。」(約16:33)

「這些人是從大患難中出來的。」(啟7:14)眼瞎的荷馬不是希臘無人可比的詩人麼？寫《天路歷程》約翰·本仁的光華使英國貝德福德監牢的骯髒牆壁耀發金光，是這如王子般的囚犯和榮耀的天才寫成這場場信仰堅定的手稿。

一月二十二日

「耶穌.....獨自退到野地裏去。」(太14:13)

音樂休止便沒有音樂，但休止符是音樂的一部分。在我們生命的旋律中，這處那處都有休止符把音樂隔開。當休止時，我們會愚蠢地以為來到歌曲的終結。神給我們送來強逼空閒的時刻，有時藉疾病、計劃挫敗和無功之力。祂在我們生命的合唱詩中帶入突然停頓，我們為着必定要靜默而悲歎。我們為着持續升到創造主耳中的音樂缺了我們的部分而憂傷。

神譜寫我們生命的樂章時不會沒計劃，我們的分就是學會那曲調和不要因休止私洩氣。他們不是要被忽略或刪去，或用來破壞旋律或改動音調。只要抬頭仰望，神親自為我們數算時間。定睛在祂那處，下一個音符必會完滿和清晰。

January 23

Why, O Lord, do you stand far off? (Psalm 10:1)

God is ... an ever-present help in trouble” (Ps. 46:1). But He allows trouble to pursue us, as though He were indifferent to its overwhelming pressure, so we may be brought to the end of ourselves. Through the trial, we are led to discover the treasure of darkness and the immeasurable wealth of tribulation.

We may be sure that He who allows the suffering is with us throughout it. It may be that we will only see Him once the ordeal is nearly passed, but we must dare to believe that He never leaves our trial. Our eyes are blinded so we cannot see the One our soul loves. The darkness and our bandages blind us so that we cannot see the form of our High Priest. Let us not rely on our feelings but trust in His unswerving faithfulness. Although His presence is veiled, once we begin to speak to Jesus as if He were literally present, an answering voice comes to show us He is in the shadow, keeping watch over His own.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

January 24

But the dove could find no place to set its feet ... so it returned to Noah in the ark....He waited seven more days and again sent out the dove from the ark. When the dove returned to him in the evening, there in its beak was a freshly plucked olive leaf! (Genesis 8:9-11)

God knows exactly when to withhold or to grant us any visible sign of encouragement. How wonderful it is when we will trust Him in either case! Yet it is better when all visible evidence that He is remembering us is withheld. It is good when He sends the visible evidence, but we appreciate it even more after we have trusted Him without it. And those who are the most inclined to trust God without any evidence except His Word always receive the greatest amount of visible evidence of His love.

Charles Gallaudet Trumbull

Delayed answers to prayers are not refusals. Many prayers are received and recorded, yet underneath are the words, “My time has not yet come.”

一月二十三日

「耶和華阿，祢為甚麼站在遠處？」
(詩 10:1)

「神.....是我們在患難中隨時的幫助。」(詩 46:1) 祂容許困難纏繞我們，如同祂對它勢不可擋的壓力漠不關心，我們被帶到自己的盡頭。我們是藉試煉被帶到發現黑暗的寶貴和苦難無法計量的財富。

我們該肯定容許我們受苦的祂與我們一同經過。我們只有在嚴峻考驗幾乎過去時才得見祂，但定須敢於相信祂永不會在試煉時離開我們。我們眼瞎，因此看不見到生命所愛的那位。黑暗和束縛叫我們看不見到大祭司的形狀。我們不要倚重情感，卻要信靠祂不搖動的信實。雖然祂的同在隱秘，一旦我們開始跟耶穌說話，如同祂照字義地同在時，顯示祂的回應聲音就在暗中，持續看顧屬祂的人。

摘自《每日靈修註釋》

一月二十四日

「鴿子找不着落腳之地，就回到方舟挪亞那裏.....。他又等了七天，再把鴿子從方舟放出去。到了晚上，鴿子回到他那裏.....嘴裏叼着一個新擰下來的橄欖葉子。」(創 8:9-11)

神完全知道何時按住不給和何時給我們任何鼓勵的可見表示。我們在兩種情況下都信靠祂時是何等美妙！但是更好的就是祂記念我們的所有可見證明都被按住不給時。祂顯明那可見的證明是好的，但我們若沒有這證明下也能信靠祂時，這叫我們更賞惜這證明。那些除了神的話之外沒有任何證明下仍是最傾向信靠神的人總是得着祂的愛大量的證據。

查理士·哥洛地·湛布

禱告遲了蒙允不是被拒絕，很多祈禱都接收了和作了記錄，但其背後的是這說話：「我們時候還沒

January 25

Your rod and your staff, they comfort me. (Psalm 23:4)

At my father's house in the country, there is a little closet near the chimney, where we keep the canes, or walking sticks.

During the war, when we were experiencing a time of discouragement and impending danger, the verse "He will have no fear of bad news; his heart is steadfast, trusting in the Lord" (Ps. 112:7) was a staff to walk with on many dark days.

When our child died and we were left nearly brokenhearted, I found another staff in the promise "Weeping may remain for a night, but rejoicing comes in the morning" (Ps. 30:5).

When I was forced to be away from home for a year due to poor health, not knowing if God would ever allow me to return to my home and work again, I chose this staff, which has never failed: "For I know the plans I have for you, ... plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future" (Jer. 29:11).

In times of impending danger or doubt, when human judgment seems to be of no value, I have found it easy to go forward with this staff: "In quietness and trust is your strength" (Isa. 30:15). And in emergencies, when there has been no time for deliberation or for action, this staff has never failed me: "He that believeth shall not make haste" (Isa. 28:16 KJV).

Abbott Benjamin Vaughan, in The Outlook

January 26

I have begun to deliver....Now begin to conquer and possess. (Deuteronomy 2:31)

Once we begin to obey, He will begin to bless us. Great things were promised to Abraham, but not one of them could have been obtained had he waited in Chaldea. He had to leave his home, friends, and country, travel unfamiliar paths, and press on in unwavering obedience in order to receive the promises. The ten lepers Jesus healed were told to show themselves to the priest, and "as they went, they were cleansed" (Luke 17:14). If they had waited to see the cleansing come to their bodies before leaving, they

一月二十五日

「祢的杖，祢的竿，都安慰我。」
(詩23:4)

在我父親鄉間的屋子裏，在煙囪旁有一我們用來保存手杖和行路竿的小壁櫥。

在戰事期間，我們經歷了失望和逼在眉睫的危險時刻，「他必不怕兇惡的信息。他心堅定，倚靠耶和華。」(詩112:7)這經節就是陪着我走過很多黑暗日子的竿杖。

當我們的孩子死亡時，留給我們的是幾乎心碎，我發現有另一根應許之杖：「一宿雖然有哭泣，早晨便必歡呼。」(詩30:5)

我因患病被逼遠離家庭一年之久，不知神會否容許我再次回到我家和工作崗位時，我選了從未令人失望的杖：「我知道我向你們所懷的意念是賜平安的意念，不是降災禍的意念，要叫你們末後有指望。」(耶29:11)

當危險或困擾逼在眉睫，當人的判斷似乎毫無價值時，我發現有這根杖能使路途輕省：「你們得力在乎平靜安穩。」(賽30:15)在危急時，沒時間想到解救和作甚麼行動時，「信靠的人必不着急。」(賽28:16)這根杖從沒叫我失望。

阿博·便雅憫·華庚的《看守人》

一月二十六日

「從此起首，我要將西宏和他的地交給你，你要得他的地為業。」(申2:31)

我們一旦開始順服，祂必會開始來祝福我們。所應許亞伯拉罕的是重大事情，但沒有一項是在迦勒底等待而可得着的。他定必要離開祂的家人、朋友和國家，走那不熟悉的道路，和為要得着應許而以堅決的順服來向前走。耶穌所醫治的那十個麻瘋病人被要求給祭師察看，「他們去的時候就潔淨了。」(路17:14)當他們等待見到身體被潔淨

would never have seen it. The moment their faith began to work, the blessing came.

When the Israelites were entrapped by Pharaoh's pursuing army at the Red Sea, they were commanded to "go forward" (Ex. 14:15 KJV). Years later the Israelites were commanded to show their faith again by beginning their march over the Jordan while the river was at its highest point.

We are destined to fight certain battles, and we think we can never be victorious and conquer our enemies. Yet as we enter the conflict, One comes who fights by our side. Through Him we are "more than conquerors" (Rom. 8:37).

J. R. Miller

January 27

Make you strong, firm and steadfast. (1 Peter 5:10)

Before we can establish a new and deeper relationship with Christ, we must first acquire enough intellectual light to satisfy our mind that we have been given the right to stand in this new relationship. Even the shadow of a doubt here will destroy our confidence. Then, having seen the light, we must advance. We must make our choice, commit to it, and take our rightful place as confidently as a tree is planted in the ground. As a bride entrusts herself to the groom at the marriage altar, our commitment to Christ must be once and for all, without reservation or reversal.

Then there follows a time of establishing and testing, during which we must stand still until the new relationship becomes so ingrained in us that it becomes a permanent habit. It is comparable to a surgeon setting a broken arm by splinting it to keep it from moving. God too has His spiritual splints. He wants to put on His children to keep them quiet and still until they pass the first stage of faith. Sometimes the trial will be difficult, but "the God of all grace, who called you to his eternal glory in Christ, after you have suffered a little while, will himself restore you and make you strong, firm and steadfast" (1 Peter 5:10).

A. B. Simpson

January 28

I am jealous for you with a godly jealousy. (2 Corinthians 11:2)

God loves you more than any harpist loves his

後才離開，他們便永不會得見了。

當以色列人被法老的追兵困在紅海邊時，他們被命令往前走（出 14:15）。多年後以色列人被吩咐再次顯示他們的信心，在約但河水位最高時開始邁步操過去。

我們被命定在某些戰役中作戰。我們也以為永不能得勝和征服敵人。當我們進入戰場時，站在我們那方來作戰的便來到。藉祂我們「得勝有餘」（羅 8:37）。

J.R. 米勒

一月二十七日

「必要親自成全你們，堅固你們，賜力量給你們。」（彼前 5:10）

在我們與基督建立一既新且更深的關係之先，我們定須先取得叫我們心靈滿意的智慧亮光來叫我們站在這新關係上。就是一點兒的疑惑足能摧毀我們的確信。我們既得見光，便必須前行。我們必須作出選擇，委身於其中。像一棵樹種植在地上般信確地取用當然的地位。如同新娘在婚姻的台前將自己託付給新郎一樣，我們對基督的委身也定必是一次且是最後一次，毫無保留，不再回頭。

之後是建立和試驗的時刻，這時我們須站穩，直至這新關係在我們裏頭根深蒂固，成為永久的習慣。這好比為斷臂所施的手術，用夾板防止它的移動。神也有祂用在祂兒女身上叫他們安靜和安息的夾板，直至他們通過信心的初步考驗。有時試煉艱難，但「那賜諸般恩典的神，曾在基督裏召你們，得享他永遠的榮耀，等你們暫受苦難之後，必要親自成全你們，堅固你們，賜力量給你們。」（彼前 5:10）
宣信

一月二十八日

「我為你們起的憤恨，原是神那樣的憤恨。」（林後 11:2）

神愛你過於豎琴手愛他的豎琴

harp, He finds you nothing but harsh, discordant sounds. He plucks your heartstrings with torturing anguish. Tenderly leaning over you, he strikes the strings and listens. Hearing only a harsh murmur, He strikes you again. His heart bleeds for you while He anxiously waits to hear the strain "Not my will, but yours be done" (Luke 22:42)—a melody as sweet to His ears as angels' songs. And He will never cease from striking the strings of your heart until your humbled and disciplined soul blends with all the pure and eternal harmonies of His own being.

selected

January 29

God is in the midst of her, she will not be moved; God will help her when morning dawns. (Psalm 46:5 NASB)

When the apostle Paul was on his way to Jerusalem, the Holy Spirit warned him that "prison and hardships" (Acts 20:23) awaited him. Yet he could triumphantly say, "But none of these things move me" (Acts 20:24 KJV).

And if we will only let God have His way with us, we can come to the same point. Then, like Paul, neither the stress and strain of little things nor the great and heavy trials of life will have enough power to move us from "the peace of God, which transcends all understanding" (Phil. 4:7).

"Him who overcomes I will make a pillar in the temple of my God. Never again will he leave it" (Rev. 3:12).

Hannah Whitall Smith

When God is the center of a kingdom or a city, He makes it strong "like Mount Zion, which cannot be shaken" (Ps. 125:1). And when God is the center of a soul, although disasters may crowd in on all sides and roar like the waves of the sea, there is a constant calm within. The world can neither give nor take away this kind of peace. What is it that causes people to shake like leaves today at the first hint of danger? It is simply the lack of God living in their soul, and having the world in their hearts instead.

R. Leighton

January 30

I will be like the dew to Israel. (Hosea 14:5)

Dew is so often recognized in the Scriptures and

，祂看你不過是生硬不和諧之音。祂以折磨之痛苦彈奏你的心弦，溫柔地俯就你，擊弦來聽。若所聽見的生硬輕聲，便再次敲彈。祂心為你悲痛，急切等待聽你說：「不要成就我的意思，只要成就祢的意思」（路22:42）這扭痛之言，於祂耳這如同天使之歌般優美。祂會不斷地來敲擊你的心弦，直至你謙卑和受教導的生命，與祂一己一切清純和永恆的和諧混在一起。

選

一月二十九日

「神在其中，城必不動搖。到天一亮，神必幫助這城。」（詩46:5）

使徒保羅往耶路撒冷去時，聖靈向他作出「捆鎖與患難等待」（徒20:23）的警告，他能得勝地說：「我卻不以性命為念，也不看為寶貴」（徒20:24）。

只要我們讓神的旨意與我們同行，我們也能來到這相同之處。那麼我們便如保羅般，沒有小事上的壓力和張力，或人生重大的試煉有足夠能力使我們失去「神所賜出人意外的平安」（腓4:7）。

「得勝的，我要叫他在我神殿中作柱子，他也必不再從那裏出去。」（啟3:12）

漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

當神在國或城的中心時，祂使她「好像錫安山，永不動搖。」（詩125:1）當神在生命的中心時，雖然災難從四方八面湧至，像海浪怒吼，但內裏是有恆常的平靜，世界不能給予或取走這種平安。甚麼導至今日世人在危險初露時便像葉子般搖晃？只因在他們的靈魂中缺少神活在他們的生命中，反而有世界在他們心中。

R·禮頓

一月三十日

「我必向以色列如甘露。」（何14:5）

聖經常以甘露作為屬靈甦醒的

used as a symbol of spiritual refreshment. Just as nature is bathed in dew, the Lord renews His people. In Titus 3:5 the same thought of spiritual refreshment is connected with the ministry of the Holy Spirit and referred to as “renewal by the Holy Spirit.”

Beloved fellow worker, you recognize the folly of a laborer attempting to work all day without eating, but do you recognize the folly of a servant of God attempting to minister without eating of the heavenly manna? Neither is it sufficient to have spiritual nourishment only occasionally. Every day you must receive the “renewal by the Holy Spirit.”

Dr. Pardington

January 31

He giveth quietness. (Job 34:29 KJV)

His voice is heard above the screaming of the wind through the ropes and rigging, and over the thrashing of the waves. “Quiet! Be still!” (Mark 4:39). Can you not hear it? And instantly there is a great calm. “He giveth quietness” —quietness even in the midst of losing our inner strength and comforts. Sometimes He removes these because we make too much of them. We are tempted to look at our joys, pleasures, passions, or our dreams, with too much self-satisfaction. Then through His gracious love He withdraws them, leading us to distinguish between them and Himself. He draws near and whispers the assurance of His presence, bringing an infinite calm to keep our hearts and minds.

February 1

This is my doing. (1 Kings 12:24)

The disappointments of life are simply the hidden appointments of love.

C. A. Fox

Have you ever realized that whatever concerns you concerns Me too? “For whoever touches you touches the apple of [my] eye” (Zech. 2:8). “You are precious and honored in my sight” (Isa. 43:4). Therefore it is My special delight to teach you.

I want you to learn when temptations attack you, and the enemy comes in “like a pent-up flood” (Isa. 59:19), that “this is my doing” and that your weakness needs My strength, and your safety lies in letting Me fight for you.

Have you not asked Me to make you humble?

象徵。如同大自然浸淫在雨露中一樣，祂也使祂的民甦醒。多3:5也有相同屬靈甦醒的思想，關聯到聖靈的職事，被稱為「聖靈的更新」。

親愛的同工啊，你既知道工人沒吃東西下嘗試去工作的愚蠢，豈也不應認識神的工人沒有屬天嗎哪得吃下嘗試去服事的同樣愚蠢麼？只有間中才得屬靈的營養也是不夠的，你定須每天接收「聖靈的更新」。

栢定頓博士

一月三十一日

「祂使人安靜。」(伯34:29)

祂的聲音從上面繩索間的呼風中和向着痛打的浪濤上得聽：「住了吧，靜了吧。」(可4:39)你聽否這個？立時有一大大的平靜。「祂使人安靜」，在我們失去內裏力量和安慰中的安靜。有時祂除去這些，因我們製造太多這些東西了。我們落在注目我們的喜樂、歡愉、情感或我們夢想的試誘中，想多得自我滿足。祂卻藉祂恩典的愛來除去他們，引導我們認識到這些和祂自己的分別。祂親就和輕聲說到祂同在的保證，帶來一無限的平靜，保守我們的心思意念。

二月一日

「這事出於我。」(王上12:24)

人生的失望只是暗中委派愛吧了。

C.A.霍士

你曾否明白所關於你的事也同時是關於神？因為凡「摸你們的，就是摸祂眼中的瞳人。」(亞2:8)「因我看你為寶為尊。」(賽43:4)因此我特別喜愛來教導你。

當試探攻擊你，敵人「好像急流的河水沖來」(賽59:19)時，我想你知道「這事出於我」；並且你的疲倦需要我的力量，你的平安就在於你讓我替你而作戰。

你豈不曾求我使你謙卑麼？見

Then see that I have placed you in the perfect school where this lesson is taught. Your circumstances and the people around you are only being used to accomplish My will.

Are you having problems with money, finding it hard to make ends meet? “This is my doing,” for I am the One who keeps your finances, and I want you to learn to depend upon Me. My supply is limitless and I “will meet all your needs” (Phil. 4:19). I want you to prove My promises so no one may say, “You did not trust in the Lord your God” (Deut. 1:32).

Are you experiencing a time of sorrow? “This is my doing.” I am “a man of sorrows, and familiar with suffering” (Isa. 53:3). I have allowed your earthly comforters to fail you, so that by turning to Me you may receive “eternal encouragement and good hope” (2 Thess. 2:16). Have you longed to do some great work for Me but instead have been set aside on a bed of sickness and pain? “This is my doing.” You were so busy I could not get your attention, and I wanted to teach you some of My deepest truths.

Laura A.

February 2

In the shadow of his hand he hid me; he made me into a polished arrow and concealed me in his quiver. (Isaiah 49:2)

“In the shadow”—each of us must go there sometimes, such as the shadowed sickroom, the shadowed house of grief, or the shadowed life where the sunlight has departed.

But fear not! It is the shadow of God’s hand. He is leading you, and there are lessons that can be learned only where He leads.

The photograph of His face can only be developed in the dark room. But do not assume that He has pushed you aside. You are still “in his quiver.” He has not thrown you away as something worthless.

He is only keeping you nearby till the moment comes when He can send you quickly and confidently on some mission that will bring Him glory. O shadowed, isolated one, remember how closely the quiver is tied to the warrior. It is always within easy reach of his hand and jealously protected.

from Christ in Isaiah, by F. B. Meyer

February 3

否我正放你在教導這個的正確學校。你的環境和圍繞你的人只是用來成就我的旨意吧了。

你是否財務拮据，難以過活？「這事出於我」，我是照顧你財務的那位，我想你學會倚靠我。我的供應無限，和「我.....使你們一切所需用的都充足。」(腓4:19)我想你證明我的應許，以致沒人說：「你們在這事上卻不信耶和華你們的神。」(申1:32)

你是否正經歷憂傷時刻？「這事出於我」。我是「多受痛苦，常經憂患」(賽53:3)之子。我容許你地上的安慰者叫你失望，好叫你轉向我，從而得着「永遠的安慰，並美好的盼望」(帖後2:16)。你曾否期望為我作大事，卻反被撇在病床上或痛苦的一旁？「這事出於我」。你因太忙碌而不留意我，我想教導你一些出於我最深的真理。

羅拉·A

二月二日

「祂.....將我藏在祂手蔭之下。又使我成為磨亮的箭，將我藏在祂箭袋之中。」(賽49:2)

終有一日我們每個定必去到「蔭下」那裏，例如陰暗的病房、陰暗的憂傷房子、或是陽光遠去的陰暗生命。

但不用驚恐！這是神的手蔭。祂正引導着你，只要當祂在引導時總有可學習的教訓。

祂臉面的相片惟有在黑房中才能顯影，但不要以為祂把你撇棄一旁。你仍是在祂的箭袋中。祂未曾把你如同無用之物般拋開。

祂只是留你在身旁，好當合適時機時便快快沉實地差派你作為祂帶來榮耀的一些事奉。噢陰暗，孤單的陰暗，謹記箭袋如何繫近戰士，它總是在他手可及之處，留意提防地防衛着。

摘自邁爾著《以賽亞書中的基督》

二月三日

At once the Spirit sent him out into the desert.
(Mark 1:12)

“At once” —after what? After heaven was opened and the Spirit descended “like a dove” (v. 10), and the Father voiced His blessing, “You are my Son, whom I love; with you I am well pleased” (v. 11). Yet it is not an abnormal experience.

Aren't your times of deepest depression the moments that immediately follow your loftiest highs? Just yesterday you were soaring high in the heavens and singing in the radiance of the morning. Today, however, your wings are folded and your song is silent. At noon you were basking in the sunshine of the Father's smile, but by evening you were saying from the wilderness, “My way is hidden from the Lord” (Isa. 40:27).

God shines His light on you to make you fit for life's deserts, Gethsemanes, and Calvaries. He lifts you to new heights to strengthen you so that you may go deeper still. He illuminates you so He may send you into the night, making you a help to the helpless.

George Matheson

After blessings comes the battle.

It is a period that always ends in certain triumph for those who have committed the keeping of their souls to God. And the testing “later on ... produces a harvest of righteousness and peace” (Heb. 12:11) and paves the way for the thirtyfold to one hundredfold increase that is promised to follow (see Matt. 13:23).

Aphra White

February 4

I will cause you to ride on the heights of the land.
(Isaiah 58:14)

The sufferings of life are God's winds. Sometimes they blow against us and are very strong. They are His hurricanes, taking our lives to higher levels, toward His heavens.

When the storms of life appear, the atmosphere is changed, purified, filled with new life, and part of heaven is brought down to earth.

selected

Facing obstacles should make us sing. The wind finds its voice not when rushing across an open sea but when it is hindered by the outstretched limbs of a pine tree or broken by the strings of an aeolian wind harp.

「聖靈就把耶穌催到曠野裏去。」
(可1:12)

「就」，在何時之後？就在天開啟和聖靈「像鴿子」(可1:10)降臨後。天父發出祂恩福之言：「你是我的愛子，我喜悅你。」(可1:11)但這不是反常的經歷。

那最高峰立即隨來的不是你沮喪最深之時麼？就昨天你還高飛在天上，在早晨的光輝中歌唱着，但今天你的雙翼已收摺，你的歌聲已寂滅。在正午你還沐浴在天父微笑的陽光中，但在黃昏你在曠野唱着：「我的道路向耶和華隱藏。」(賽40:27)

神把祂的恩光照射你來使你熬過人生的曠野、客西馬尼和加略山。祂把你提升至新的高度來加你能力得以進深。祂照亮你來差你進入黑夜，在無助者中成為幫助。

喬治·馬得勝

恩典之後就是爭戰。

對那些將生命委身給神讓祂維持之人來說，這也是一個肯定以勝利告終的時刻。這試驗「後來.....結出平安的果子」(來12:11)和鋪平那條應許隨之而有增加三十倍至一百倍的路(參看太13:23)。

亞發·威特

二月四日

「耶和華要使你乘駕地的高處。」
(賽58:14)

人生的患難就是神的風。有時他們向我們吹襲，且十分猛烈。他們是神的颶風，把我們的生命帶到更高的層次，往祂的天上而去。

當人生的暴風雨出現時，環境氣氛都改變了，淨化了，充滿新生命，部分的天被帶下來到人間。

選

面對障礙物時會使我們歌唱，風不是在橫掃一空曠的海洋時發出聲響，而是當它被松樹外展的樹枝或被颶颶作響的風鈴阻礙時。

February 5

You will not leave in haste. (Isaiah 52:12)

We are in such a hurry, always doing, that we are in danger of not allowing God the opportunity to work. You may be sure that God will never say to us, “Stand still,” “Sit still,” or “Be still,” unless He is going to do something. This is our problem regarding the Christian life: we want to do something to be Christians, instead of allowing Him to work in us.

Think of how still you stand when your picture is being taken, as the photographer captures your likeness on film. God has one eternal purpose for us: that we should be “conformed to the likeness of his Son” (Rom. 8:29). But in order for that to happen, we must stand still. We hear so much today about being active, but maybe we need to learn what it means to be quiet.

from Crumbs

February 6

He turned the sea into dry land, they passed through the waters on foot—come, let us rejoice in him. (Psalm 66:6)

During times of prosperity, we lose sight of their brilliance. But when night falls—the deep, dark night of sorrow—a host of stars begin to shine, bringing forth God’s blessed constellations of hope, and promises of comfort from His Word.

Just as Jacob experienced at Jabbok, it is only once the sun sets that the Angel of the Lord comes, wrestles with us, and we can overcome. It was at night, “at twilight” (Ex. 30:8), that Aaron lit the sanctuary lamps. And it is often during nights of trouble that the brightest lamps of believers are set ablaze.

It was during a dark time of loneliness and exile that John had the glorious vision of his Redeemer. Many of us today have our “Isle of Patmos,” which produces the brightest memories of God’s enduring presence, uplifting grace, and love in spite of solitude and sadness.

J. R. Macduff

There I will give her back her vineyards, and will make the Valley of Achor a door of hope. There she will sing. Hosea 2:15

二月五日

「你們出來必不至急忙。」(賽 52:12)

我們總是趕忙，總在工作，身陷不讓神有機會工作的危險中。你可肯定神永不會叫我們「站定」，「坐定」或「要靜止」，除非祂有所行動。這是基督徒生命的問題：我們為着是基督徒而作一些東西，而不是讓祂在我們裏頭來作。

想像一下當你在被拍照時，攝影師如何將你的影像攝入菲林中。神為我們有一永恆的計劃：我們能以「效法祂兒子的模樣」(羅 8:29)。為了叫這得以成就，我們定須站定。我們今天聽得太多的是如何積極，但我們也許需要學習安靜的意義。

摘自《碎渣兒》

二月六日

「祂將海變成旱地，眾民步行過河，我們在那裏因祂歡喜。」(詩66:6)

在順境之時，我們看不見其輝煌；但當深沉憂傷的夜幕低垂時，眾星就會開始照耀，帶來神施恩的星輝希望，來自祂聖經的安慰應許。

像雅各在雅博渡口所經歷的一樣，一旦在日落時主的使者來和我們摔跤，我們便能克服。亞倫到晚上，在「黃昏」(出30:8)時如何點燃聖所的燈，我們同樣也常在困難的夜晚點亮我們信徒最光明的燈。

約翰就在他黑暗孤單的放逐中得見榮耀的救主，我們今天也有很多我們「拔摩海島」的最幸福的記憶，那裏有神長久的同在、提升的恩典和勝過孤獨和憂傷的愛。

J · R · 麥道夫

「她從那裏出來。我必賜她葡萄園，又賜她亞割谷作為指望的門，她必在那裏歌唱。」(何2:15)

February 7

Why are you downcast, O my soul? (Psalm 43:5)

If we were still unbelievers, we would have a reason to be downcast; or if we have been converted but continue to live in sin, we are downcast as a consequence.

Except for these two conditions, there is never a reason to be downcast, for everything else may be brought to God “by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving” (Phil. 4:6). And through all our times of need, difficulty, and trials, we may exercise faith in the power and love of God.

“Put your hope in God” (Ps. 43:5).

Our work is to lay our petitions before the Lord, and in childlike simplicity to pour out our hearts before Him, saying.

“For I will yet praise him” (Ps. 43:5).

George Mueller

February 8

Surely I am with you always. (Matthew 28:20)

Never look ahead to the changes and challenges of this life in fear. Instead, as they arise look at them with the full assurance that God, whose you are, will deliver you out of them. Hasn't He kept you safe up to now?

Do not look ahead to what may happen tomorrow. The same everlasting Father who cares for you today will take care of you tomorrow and every day. Either He will shield you from suffering or He will give you His unwavering strength that you may bear it. Be at peace, then, and set aside all anxious thoughts and worries.

Francis de Sales

The Lord is my shepherd. Psalm 23:1

Not was, not may be, nor will be. “The Lord is my shepherd.” He is when I'm at home and in China. He is during peace or war, and in times of abundance or poverty.

J. Hudson Taylor

February 9

Jesus did not answer a word. (Matthew 15:23)

He will quiet you with his love. (Zephaniah 3:17)

Are you experiencing a crushing sorrow, a bitter

二月七日

「我的心哪，祢為何憂悶？」(詩 43:5)

若我們仍是未曾相信的人，我們便有理由來憂悶；又或者我們已決志信主，但卻仍活在罪中，憂悶就是必然的後果了。

除了這兩個情況之外，再沒有憂悶的原因了，因為我們凡事都可以「藉着禱告、祈求和感謝」(腓 4:6)帶到神面前。在我們有需要、困難和試煉的時刻中，我們可以在神的能力和愛中運用信心。

「應當仰望神」(詩 43:5)。

我們的工作是將請求呈在主面前，以小孩子的單純來在祂面前傾心吐意。

「因我還要稱讚祂。」(詩 43:5)
慕勒

二月八日

「我就常與你們同在。」(太 28:20)

不要在驚恐中看今生的改變和挑戰，當他們冒起時，反用十足的確定來看，確信神必把你從中拯救出來。祂不曾保守你平安至今麼？

不要前望那些明天會發生的事情，那位今天照顧你的永活天父，明天和每天也會看顧你。祂一是保衛你免受苦難，一是祂必會給你不動搖的能力叫你得以經得起這苦難。那麼，當安靜，把一切憂慮的思想和掛慮放在一旁。

梳士的法蘭西斯

「耶和華是我的牧者。」(詩 23:1)

不是過去、可能、將會，「耶和華是我的牧者」。在家還是在中國時祂是，在和平還是戰爭中時祂是，在豐富或是窮乏時祂是。

戴德生

二月九日

「耶穌卻一言不答。」(太 15:23)

「耶和華必默然愛你。」(番 3:17)

當經歷肝腸欲碎憂傷時，是否

disappointment, longing to hear your Master's voice calling you, saying, "Take courage! It is I. Don't be afraid" (Matt. 14:27)? Yet only silence, the unknown, and misery confront you—"Jesus did not answer a word."?

"Why are you downcast, O my soul? ... I will yet praise him" (Ps. 43:5). Yes, praise Him even for His silence.

When they knelt the Master drew near to them. As He approached the first of the three, He bent over her with tenderness and grace. He smiled with radiant love and spoke to her in tones of pure, sweet music. Upon leaving her, He came to the next but only placed His hand upon her bowed head and gave her one look of loving approval. He passed the third woman almost abruptly, without stopping for a word or a glance.

The first kneeling woman needs the full measure of My tenderness and care to keep her feet on My narrow way. She needs My love, thoughts, and help every moment of the day, for without them she would stumble into failure.

He "will do wonders never before done." (Ex. 34:10)

selected

February 10

Do not take revenge, my friends. (Romans 12:19)

There are times when doing nothing demands much greater strength than taking action. Maintaining composure is often the best evidence of power. Even to the vilest and deadliest of charges, Jesus responded with deep, unbroken silence. His silence was so profound, it caused His accusers and spectators to wonder in awe. To the greatest insults, the most violent treatment, and to mockery that would bring righteous indignation to the feeblest of hearts, He responded with voiceless, confident calmness. Those who are unjustly accused, and mistreated without cause, know the tremendous strength that is necessary to keep silent and to leave revenge to God.

The apostle Paul said, "None of these things move me" (Acts 20:24 KJV). He did not say, "None of these things hurt me." Paul had a very tender heart, for we do not read of any other apostle who cried as he did. It takes a strong man to cry. "Jesus wept" (John 11:35), and He was the strongest man that ever lived.

期望得聽主呼喚你「你們放心。是我，不要怕。」(太14:27)還是只有寂靜、不明所已和不幸橫阻在前，「耶穌卻一言不答」？

「我的心哪，祢為何憂悶？.....我還要稱讚祢。」(詩43:5)是的，就算祢沉默時仍稱讚祢。

當她們三人跪下時，主走近。來到第一位時，祂向她俯身，極盡溫柔和恩典，以愛心洋溢的笑容和如甜美音樂曲調的清純來與她說話。離開她後，祂來到第二位，只按手在她下垂的頭，給她慈愛肯定的一望。之後祂幾乎猝然走過第三位，沒停下發一言或作一望。

第一位跪着的婦人需要我全面溫柔和關顧來保守祂的腳仍走窄路。她需要我每天無時無刻的愛、思想和幫助，若得不着這些祂必會絆倒失敗。」

祂行從未行過奇妙的事(出34:10)。

選

二月十日

「親愛的弟兄，不要自己伸冤。」(羅12:19)

有時在不作事所需的力量大於有所行動時。保持沉著常是力量的最佳證明。就算面對最卑劣和最致命的指控，耶穌總以深沉和不被打破的沉默來作回應。祂的沉默是那樣深遠，以致祂的指控者和旁觀者都感驚奇。面對最大的羞辱、最粗暴的對待、和叫最詭弱心靈帶來義憤的嘲弄，祂是以無聲、沉着的安靜來回應。那些被不公指控的人和那些沒有合理原因下遭惡待的人都知道要保持沉默和讓神來報應所需的是極大的能力。

使徒保羅說：「這些東西沒有一樣可搖動我。」(徒20:24)他不是說「這些東西沒有一樣可傷害我。」保羅有極柔軟的心，沒有使徒像他般哭。堅強的人也會哭，「耶穌哭了」(約11:35)，祂是曾活在世上之人最堅強的。

The apostle Paul never looked for the easy way, and placed no value on his mortal life. He only cared about one thing, and that was his loyalty to Christ—to gain Christ's smile. To Paul, more than to any other man, doing Christ's work was his earthly pay, but gaining Christ's smile was heaven.

Margaret Bottome

February 11

As soon as the priests ... set foot in the Jordan, its waters ... will be cut off. (Joshua 3:13)

The Israelites were not to wait in the camp until the Jordan was opened but to “walk by faith” (2 Cor. 5:7 KJV). They were to break camp, pack up their belongings, form a marching line, and actually step into the river before it would be opened.

We must learn to take God at His word and walk straight ahead in obedience, even when we can see no way to go forward. The reason we are so often sidetracked by difficulties is that we expect to see barriers removed before we even try to pass through them.

If we would only move straight ahead in faith, the path would be opened for us. But we stand still, waiting for the obstacle to be removed, when we ought to go forward as if there were no obstacles at all.

from Evening Thoughts

Faith that goes forward triumphs.

February 12

Your heavenly Father knows. (Matthew 6:32)

A visitor at a school for the deaf was writing questions on the board for the children. Soon he wrote this sentence: “Why has God made me able to hear and speak, and made you deaf?”

The shocking sentence hit the children like a cruel slap on the face. They sat paralyzed, pondering the dreadful word “Why?” And then a little girl arose.

With her lip trembling and her eyes swimming with tears, she walked straight to the board. Picking up the chalk, she wrote with a steady hand these precious words: “Yes, Father, for this was your good pleasure” (Matt. 11:26). What a reply! It reaches up and claims an eternal truth upon which the most mature believer, and even the youngest child of God, may securely rest—the truth that God is your Father.

使徒保羅從不尋找舒泰的路，也以他必死的生命為沒有價值。他只關心一事，忠於基督，搏取基督的微笑。保羅作基督的工作不像世人要得地上的報酬，而獲取基督的微笑則是天上的報酬。

瑪嘉烈·博滕美

二月十一日

「祭司把腳站在約但河水裏，約但河的水……必然斷絕。」(書3:13)

以色列人不是在約但河水打開了才離營，而是「憑着信心行」(林後5:7英皇欽定本)。他們卸營，執拾所屬物，組成行軍的行列，真的在河水分開前踏入河中。

我們定要學習到照神的說話來順服行上，那怕我們看見前無去路。我們常時被困難轉移視線的原因是因為我們期望在我們嘗試通過之前得見障礙被除去。

只要我們以信勇往直前，那條路就會為我們而開。我們卻站穩，等待着障礙物被除去，誰知那是該像完全沒有障礙物下來前進之時。

摘自《黃昏默想》

向前行的信心是得勝的信心。

二月十二日

「你們的天父是知道的。」(太6:32)

一個聾人學校的訪客在黑板上為小朋友們寫一個問題。不久他寫罷「為甚麼神令我聽得見和說得到，卻叫你們成為聾子？」這話。

這震驚的句子像打在小朋友臉上的殘忍耳光。他們呆坐，沉思那可怕的「為甚麼」。之後一個小女孩起來。

她雙唇顫抖，兩眼淚水滾動，走向黑板，拿起粉筆，用穩定的手寫下這些珍貴的字：「父阿，是的，因為祢的美意本是如此。」(太11:26)這是何等的答案！它冒起宣告一永恆的真理，就是最成熟的信徒，甚至最年輕的神的兒女也可確保得着「神是你的天父」的真理。

Can you state that truth with full assurance and faith? Once you do, your dove of faith will no longer wander the skies in restless flight but will settle forever in its eternal resting place of peace: your Father!

Arthur Christopher Bacon

February 13

The forested hill country ... will be yours. (Joshua 17:18)

When the valleys are full of Canaanites, whose mighty iron chariots are slowing your progress, go up to the hills and occupy the higher land. If you find you can no longer do work for God, pray for those who can. You may not be able to move things on earth with your words, but you may move heaven. If it seems that your continued growth is impossible on the lower slopes due to limited areas of service, the constraints of maintaining the day-to-day necessities, or other hindrances, allow your life to burst forth, reaching toward the unseen, the eternal, and the heavenly.

As God instructed them to clear the forests, He also reminded them of the sufficient power they possessed. The great strength God has placed within us through His indwelling Holy Spirit.

Difficulties are sent in order to reveal what God can do in answer to faith that prays and works. Are you being squeezed from all sides in the valley? Then “ride on the heights of the land” and be “nourished ... with honey from the rock” (Deut. 32:13). Gain wealth from the terraced slopes that are now hidden by the forests.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

February 14

Rejoice in the Lord always. I will say it again: Rejoice! (Philippians 4:4)

Even when you cannot feel any joy, there is no spring in your step, nor any comfort or encouragement in your life, continue to rejoice and “consider it pure joy” (James 1:2). “Whenever you face trials of many kinds” (James 1:2). His Holy Spirit will sustain you in your bold advance and fill your heart with gladness and praise. You will find that your heart is exhilarated and refreshed by the fullness within. Lord, teach me to rejoice in You—to “be joyful always” (1 Thess. 5:16).

selected

你能否以完全確定和信心來宣稱這真理？一旦你這樣，你信心的鴿子必不在空中迴蕩，卻永遠安居在永恆安息之所，就是你的天父！

鴉打·基斯杜化·培根

二月十三日

「山地也要歸你。」(書17:18)

當山谷佈滿迦南人，鐵車阻越你的前進、上山和佔據高地。若你發覺你不能再為神作工時，為那些仍能作工的祈禱。你也許不能用你的說話來移動地上的東西，但你可以移動天上的。若你在低坡的持續增長因為事奉的範圍有限、不能維持日復一日所需、或其他牽制的催逼，而似乎不可能容許人生有所突破時，那麼向前面不可見、永恆和屬天之處進發吧。

當神指示他們移平山林時，祂同時亦提醒他們是擁有足夠能力的，惟有藉神放置在我們裏頭居住的聖靈而來的大能力便可以。

困難來到是為了彰顯神回應信心的祈禱和工作而能行的工作。你是否正在山谷的四方八面受着壓制？那麼「乘駕地的高處」和「從磐石中啞蜜，從堅石中吸油」(申32:13)吧。從隱藏於山林中的階坡上得財寶吧。

摘自《每日靈修註釋》

二月十四日

「你們要靠主常常喜樂。我再說：你們要喜樂。」(腓4:4)

就算你感受不到任何喜樂，在你的步履上沒有春天，在你的人生中沒有任何安慰和鼓舞，要常常喜樂，就算落在百般試煉中，都要以為大喜樂。(雅1:2)祂的聖靈必會使你能勇往直前，以喜悅和讚美來充滿你的心。你必會發覺你的心被內裏的豐滿而興奮和復甦。主啊！教導我來在祢裏頭歡欣，來「常常喜樂」(帖前5:16)。

選

About midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the other prisoners were listening to them. Acts 16:25

O Paul, you gloried in the fact that you “bear on [your] body the marks of Jesus” (Gal. 6:17). You bore the marks from nearly being stoned to death, from three times being “beaten with rods” (2 Cor. 11:25), from receiving 195 lashes from the Jews, and from being bloodily beaten in the Philippian jail. Surely the grace that enabled you to sing praises while enduring such suffering is sufficient for us.

J. Roach

February 15

Do not fret because of evil men or be envious of those who do wrong. (Psalm 37:1)

“Do not fret.” Never get unduly upset! Stay cool! Even for a good reason, worrying will not help you. It only heats up the bearings but does not generate any steam. It does not help the locomotive for its axles to become hot; their heat is only a hindrance.

Friction caused by fretting is an indication of the absence of the anointing oil of the grace of God. When we worry, a little bit of sand gets into the bearings. It may be some slight disappointment, ungratefulness, or discourtesy we have experienced— suddenly our life is no longer running smoothly. Friction leads to heat, and heat can lead to very dangerous conditions. Do not allow your bearings to become heated. Let the oil of the Lord keep you cool so that an unholy heat will not cause you to be regarded as one of the “evil men.”

from The Silver Lining

February 16

Although I have afflicted you, ... I will afflict you no more. (Nahum 1:12)

There is a limit to our affliction. God sends it and then removes it. Do you complain, saying, “When will this end?” May we quietly wait and patiently endure the will of the Lord till He comes. Our Father takes away the rod when His purpose in using it is fully accomplished. If the affliction is sent to test us so that our words would glorify God, it will only end once He has caused us to testify to His praise and honor. In fact, we would not want the difficulty to depart until God has removed from us all the honor we can yield to Him.

Charles H. Spurgeon

「約在半夜，保羅和西拉，禱告唱詩讚美神，眾囚犯也側耳而聽。」(徒16:25)

保羅啊，你在「身上帶着耶穌的印記」(加6:17)這事上榮耀神。這印記來自被石頭打至幾乎要死，三次「被棍打」(林後11:25)，被猶太人被鞭打了一百九十五下，在腓立比的獄中被打至流血。肯定的是叫你能忍受這些苦難且能歌唱讚美的恩典，同樣也足夠我們使用。

J·羅柱

二月十五日

「不要為作惡的心懷不平，也不要向那行不義的生出嫉妒。」(詩37:1)

「不要心懷不平」，不要作不必要的煩惱！保持冷靜！就算是有根有據，擔憂卻不能對你有幫助，它只把齒輪加熱，卻不能產生蒸氣，他們的熱力不過是妨礙。

因不平而產生的摩擦力顯示缺乏神恩典之油的抹擦。當我們憂慮時，有一點點沙塵進入了齒輪中。這可能是我們經歷到的輕微失望、不愉快和無禮，使我們的生命突然不再順利運作。摩擦力帶來熱力，而熱力能導至十分危險的狀況。不要容許齒輪加熱，讓主的油使你保持涼快，叫這不聖潔的熱力不致使你被看作其中一個惡人了。

摘自《銀邊白雲》

二月十六日

「我雖然使你受苦，卻不再使你受苦。」(鴻1:12)

我們的苦難有限度。神差來，後便除去。不要埋怨「這何時才結束？」。我們該安靜等待，耐性忍受主的旨意來到。我們的父除去杖竿是在祂使用目的得完全成就時。若苦難來到是試驗我們，為叫我們說話能榮耀神，那麼它只會到神使我們用口稱頌祂和尊榮祂之後才停止。事實上，我們不會求困難離開我們，直至神除去我們向祂呈獻我們一切對祂的尊榮。

司布真

“The Lord of the harvest” (Luke 10:2) is not always threshing us. His trials are only for a season, and the showers soon pass. “Weeping may remain for a night, but rejoicing comes in the morning” (Ps. 30:5). “Our light and momentary troubles are achieving for us an eternal glory that far outweighs them all” (2 Cor. 4:17). Trials do serve their purpose.

Even the fact that we face a trial proves there is something very precious to our Lord in us, or else He would not spend so much time and energy on us. Christ would not test us if He did not see the precious metal of faith mingled with the rocky core of our nature, and it is to refine us into purity and beauty that He forces us through the fiery ordeal.

Be patient, O sufferer! The result of the Refiner’s fire will more than compensate for our trials, once we see the “eternal glory that far outweighs them all.” Just to hear His commendation, “Well done” (Matt. 25:21); to be honored before the holy angels; to be glorified in Christ, so that I may reflect His glory back to Him—ah! that will be more than enough reward for all my trials.

from Tried by Fire

The sweetest perfumes are obtained only through tremendous pressure, the fairest flowers grow on the most isolated and snowy peaks, the most beautiful gems are those that have suffered the longest at the jeweler’s wheel, and the most magnificent statues have endured the most blows from the chisel. All of these, however, are subject to God’s law. Nothing happens that has not been appointed with consummate care and foresight.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

February 17

The land which I do give to them, even to the children of Israel. (Joshua 1:2 KJV)

God meets you today in the present and tests your faith. As long as you are waiting, hoping, or looking, you are not believing, for “faith is being sure of what we hope for and certain of what we do not see” (Heb. 11:1). The command regarding believing prayer is: “Whatever you ask for in prayer, believe that you have received it, and it will be yours” (Mark 11:24).

from Joshua, by A. B. Simpson

「莊稼的主」(路10:2)不是時常擊打我們的。祂的試煉不過是一時，風雪不久就過去。「一宿雖然有哭泣，早晨便必歡呼。」(詩30:5)「我們這至暫至輕的苦楚，要為我們成就極重無比永遠的榮耀。」(林後4:17)試煉有其目的。

我們面臨試煉這事實證明主有十分珍貴的東西給我們，否則祂不會花那麼多時間和精力在我們身上。基督若非見到我們本性的岩芯中夾集着貴金屬的，便不會來試煉我們。祂強逼我們經過火熱的磨煉就是要提煉我們的純潔和美麗。

受苦者啊，當忍耐！看見那「極重無比永遠的榮耀」，便知煉淨者之火的結果比所受試煉的補償好得多。聽到祂說「好」(太25:21)的評語，在聖天使面前得尊榮，在基督裏得榮耀，得反照祂的榮光，這必超於我們所受一切的試煉而得的補償。

《火中的試煉》

最芳香的香薰只有經過驚人的壓力才能得到的，最美麗的花兒是生長在最荒蕪和雪封的山巔，最美麗的寶石是曾忍受最長時間在寶石匠之輪上，最莊嚴的石像經得起鑿子最多的打擊。但這一切都基於神的定律。沒有完滿的關顧和遠見下沒有事情可被命定來發生。

摘自《每日靈修註釋》

二月十七日

「眾百姓……往我所要賜給以色列人的地去。」(書1:2)

神今天這一刻遇見你來試驗你的信心。只要你仍在等待、盼望和張望，那麼你不是在相信，因為「信就是所望之事的實底，是未見之事的確據。」(來11:1)涉及相信的祈禱的命令是「凡你們禱告祈求的，無論是甚麼，只要信是得着的，就必得着。」(可11:24)

摘自宣信著《約書亞》

When we “live by faith” (2 Cor. 5:7), we need no evidence other than God’s Word. He has spoken, and in harmony with our faith it will be done. We will see because we have believed, and true faith sustains us in the most trying of times, even when everything around us seems to contradict God’s Word.

The psalmist said, “I am still confident of this: I will see the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living” (Ps. 27:13). He had not yet seen the Lord’s answer to his prayers, but he was confident he would see, and his confidence sustained him.

It is in these places of severe testing, with no human way out of our difficulty, that our faith grows and is strengthened.

from Life of Praise

February 18

Whatever you ask for in prayer, believe that you have received it, and it will be yours. (Mark 11:24)

When my little son was about ten years old, his grandmother promised him a stamp collecting album for Christmas. Christmas came and went with no stamp album and no word from Grandma. I was astonished, after he had listed all the gifts he had received, to hear him add, “And a stamp album from my grandmother.” “Grandma said, and that is the same as.” is his reason.

My dear George,

I have not forgotten my promise to you for a stamp album. I could not find the one you wanted here, so I ordered one from New York. It did not arrive until after Christmas, and it was not the right one. I then ordered another, but it still has not arrived. I have decided to send you thirty dollars instead so that you may buy the one you want in Chicago.
Your loving Grandma.

George “against all hope ... in hope believed” (Rom. 4:18) that the stamp album would come. And while he was trusting, Grandma was working, and in due time faith became sight.

It is only human to want to see before we step out on the promises of God. Yet our Savior said to Thomas and to a long list of doubters who have followed, “Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have

當我們「行事憑着信心」(林後5:7)時，除了神的話，不需別的證據。當祂曾說的與我們信心一致時，事便成就。我們因信得見，真信在最艱難時刻中持定我們，那怕四圍每件事都與神的話相違背。

詩人說：「我若不信在活人之地得見耶和華的恩惠，就早已喪膽了。」(詩27:13)他未曾見到耶和華垂聽他的禱告，但他確信他能見到，是他的確信支持着他。

當來到沒有人的方法使我們得脫離困境這些嚴厲試煉的境地時，我們的信心才會增長和得力。

摘自《讚美的人生》

二月十八日

「凡你們禱告祈求的，無論是甚麼，只要信是得着的，就必得着。」(可11:24)

當我的小兒子還十歲大時，他的祖母應承聖誕節時會送他一本郵票簿。聖誕節來到了，沒有郵票簿，也沒有來自祖母的說話。當他列舉所有他收到的禮物時，我驚奇地聽到他加上：「和一本來自祖母的郵票簿。」理由是「祖母所說的就是所的。」

我親愛的喬治：

我沒忘記應承你的郵票簿，在我這兒找不到你想要的那一款，所以我從紐約訂購一本，要到聖誕後才收到，原來那本仍不合適。我便訂購過另一本，但至今仍未收到。我已決定改寄給你三十元，那麼你可以在芝加哥買你想買的一本。
愛你的祖母

喬治「在無可指望的時候，因信仍有指望」(羅4:18)那郵票簿會來到。當他確信時，祖母在作工，到了時候，得見信果。

只有人在踏上神的應許之前才想看見，但我們的救主對多馬和一個長長懷疑的跟隨者清單說：「那沒有看見就信的，有福了。」(約

believed" (John 20:29).

Mrs. Rounds

20:29)

朗斯太太

February 19

Every branch that does bear fruit he prunes so that it will be even more fruitful. (John 15:2)

A child of God was once overwhelmed by the number of afflictions that seemed to target her. As she walked past a vineyard during the rich glow of autumn, she noticed its untrimmed appearance and the abundance of leaves still on the vines. The ground had been overtaken by a tangle of weeds and grass, and the entire place appeared totally unkempt. While she pondered the sight, the heavenly Gardener whispered: "My dear child, are you questioning the number of trials in your life? Remember the vineyard and learn from it. The gardener stops pruning and trimming the vine or weeding the soil only when he expects nothing more from the vine during that season. He leaves it alone, because its fruitfulness is gone and further effort now would yield no profit. In the same way, freedom from suffering leads to uselessness. Do you now want me to stop pruning your life? Shall I leave you alone?"

Homera Homer-Dixon

February 20

Nothing will be impossible for you. (Matthew 17:20)

It is possible for believers who are completely willing to trust the power of the Lord for their safekeeping and victory to lead a life of readily taking His promises exactly as they are and finding them to be true. It is possible to daily "cast all your anxiety on Him" (1 Peter 5:7) and experience deep peace in the process.

It is possible to become strong through and through by completely taking refuge in the power of God and by realizing that our greatest weakness and the things that upset our determination to be patient, pure, or humble provide an opportunity to make sin powerless over us. This opportunity comes through Him who loves us and who works to bring us into agreement with His will, and thereby supplies a blessed sense of His presence and His power.

H. C. G. Moule

Christ puts the key to His treasure chest in our hands and invites us to take all we desire. And whose

二月十九日

「凡結果子的，他就修理乾淨，使枝子結果子更多。」(約15:2)

一個神的兒女有一次因着被大量似乎是針對她的苦難所困繞。那時正值豐收喜悅的秋天，她走經一葡萄園，她留意到它不齊整的外貌和大量的葉子還在樹上。地上被雜草和野草所侵佔，整個地方看起來完全是亂七八糟。當她為着所見的沉思時，天上的園丁輕聲向她說：

「親愛的孩子，你是否問及你人生中的幾個試煉？想想那葡萄園，從中得教訓。當園丁認為該季不再期望從葡萄樹得甚麼時，他便會停止修剪和整理，停止除雜草。他不再理會它，因為它結果的能力已沒有了，再花氣力也得不到果效。同樣地，不受苦便帶來無用了。你如今還想不想我停止修剪你的生命？要否我不再理會你？」

荷馬拉·荷馬·迪臣

二月二十日

「你們沒有一件不能作的事了。」(太17:20)

完全樂意信靠主的能力能保守和叫他們得勝的信徒有可能活出的生命毫不猶豫地照字面來接受祂的應許和以這些應許為真實的。每天可「將一切的憂慮卸給神」(彼前5:7)和在其中經驗深深的平安。

要徹底完全成為強健是有可能的，只要完全在神的權力蔭底下和藉明白我們最大的軟弱，和明白甚麼攪擾我們不再決意要忍耐、單純和謙卑，這些本提供機會叫罪不再有權來勝過我。這機會是藉着愛我們和作工的那一位，為要帶我們進入與祂的旨意一致，和蒙恩覺知得供應祂的同在和祂的能力。

H.C.G.毛利

基督將祂寶箱的鑰匙放在我們手中，邀請我們按一切所渴望來提

fault is it that Christians usually have such meager portions of the free riches of God?

Alexander Maclaren

取。可白取神豐足的卻常是貧乏的基督徒是誰的錯？

亞歷山大·麥拿倫

February 21

Be still before the Lord and wait patiently for Him. (Psalm 37:7)

“Wait for it patiently” (Rom. 8:25). Patience eliminates worry. The Lord said He would come, and His promise is equal to His presence. Patience eliminates weeping. Why feel sad and discouraged? He knows your needs better than you do, and His purpose in waiting is to receive more glory through it. Patience eliminates self-works. “The work of God is this: to believe” (John 6:29), and once you believe, you may know all is well.

Patience eliminates all want. Perhaps your desire to receive what you want is stronger than your desire for the will of God to be fulfilled. Patience eliminates all weakness. Instead of thinking of waiting as being wasted time, realize that God is preparing His resources and strengthening you as well. Patience eliminates all wobbling. “He touched me and raised me to my feet” (Dan. 8:18). God’s foundations are steady, and when we have His patience within, we are steady while we wait. Patience yields worship. Sometimes the best part of praiseful waiting is experiencing “great endurance and patience ... joyfully” (Col. 1:11). While you wait, “let [all these aspects of] patience have her perfect work” (James 1:4 KJV), and you will be greatly enriched.

C. H. P.

二月二十一日

「你當默然倚靠耶和華。」(詩37:7)

「忍耐等候。」(羅8:25) 忍耐除去憂慮。主說祂會來，而祂的應許等同祂的同在。忍耐除去哭泣。為何感到傷心和沮喪？祂比你更知道你的需要，而祂叫你等待的目的是要叫你藉等待來得更多榮耀。忍耐除去一己工作。「信神所差來的，這就是作神的工。」(約6:29) 你一相信，便知一切安好。

忍耐除去一切想望，也許你想望要得你所想要的多於你想望神旨意得成就。忍耐除去一切軟弱，不要想着等待是浪費時間，要明白神正預備祂的供應，也要來使你堅強。忍耐除去一切動搖。「他就摸我，扶我站起來。」(但8:18) 神的根基是穩固的，當我們裏頭有祂的忍耐，我們在等待時便會堅定。忍耐產生敬拜。有時在等待中讚美這最好的部分是在經驗「歡歡喜喜的忍耐寬容」(西1:11)。當你等待時，「但忍耐也當成功，使你們成全完備，毫無缺欠。」(雅1:4) 你也會得着大大的供應。

C.H.P.

February 22

“If you can” ? ... Everything is possible for him who believes. (Mark 9:23)

“How do I obtain the Lord’s help for my needs?” “You just have to believe that He’s done it and it’s done.” The greatest problem with most of us is, after asking Him to do it, we do not believe it is done. Instead, we keep trying to help Him, get others to help Him, and anxiously wait to see how He is going to work.

Faith adds its “Amen” to God’s “Yes” and then takes its hands off, leaving God to finish His work. The language of faith is, “Commit your way to the Lord; trust in him and he will do this” (Ps. 37:5).

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

二月二十二日

「你若能信，在信的人，凡事都能。」(可9:23)

「我如何才能得到主對我的幫助？」「你只要相信祂已作成時，它便作成了。」我們大多數人最大的問題就在我們求祂作時，不相信事就這樣成就。反而，我們仍嘗試來協助祂，找其他人來協助祂，焦急地等待看祂如何在工作。

信心向神的「是」加上「阿們」後便縮手，讓神完成祂的工作。信是「當將你的事交托耶和華，並倚靠祂，祂就必成全。」(詩37:5)

摘自《在地若天的日子》

Active faith gives thanks for a promise even though it is not yet performed, knowing that God's contracts are as good as cash.

Matthew Henry

活潑的信為着應許而感謝，雖則應許還未成就，因知道神的約章比現金更好。

馬太·亨利

February 23

And there came a lion. (1 Samuel 17:34 KJV)

The youthful David trusted God, through his faith in the Lord, defeated a lion and a bear and later overthrew the mighty Goliath. When the lion came to destroy his flock, it came as a wonderful opportunity for David. If he had faltered and failed, he would have missed God's opportunity for him and probably would never have been the Lord's chosen king of Israel.

The lion was God's opportunity in disguise. Every difficulty and every temptation that comes our way is God's opportunity. Yet the Shechinah glory of God was very evident underneath the covering. May the Lord open our eyes to see Him, even in temptations, trials, dangers, and misfortunes.

C. H. P.

February 24

Though John never performed a miraculous sign, all that John said about this man was true. (John 10:41)

John the Baptist never performed a miracle, but Jesus said of him, "Among those born of women there is no one greater" (Luke 7:28). His mission was to be "a witness to the light" (John 1:8), and that may be your mission and mine. John was content to be only a voice, if it caused people to think of Christ.

Be willing to be only a voice that is heard but not seen, or a mirror whose glass the eye cannot see because it is reflecting the brilliant glory of the Son. Be willing to be a breeze that arises just before daylight.

Do the most everyday and insignificant tasks knowing that God can see. If you live with difficult people, win them over through love. If you once made a great mistake in life, do not allow it to cloud the rest of your life, but by locking it secretly in your heart, make it yield strength and character.

We are doing more good than we know. The things we do today—sowing seeds or sharing simple truths of Christ—people will someday refer to as the first things that prompted them to think of Him. For my

二月二十三日

「有時來了獅子。」(撒上海 17:34)

年輕的大衛藉着信靠耶和華，戰勝獅子和熊，後來更打倒哥利亞。當獅子來摧毀他的羊群時，卻成為大衛的奇妙機會。若他踉蹌逃跑，他便會錯過了神給他的機會，也許永不能成為耶和華揀選為以色列的王了。

獅子是神偽裝的機遇。迎面而來的每個難處和試探都是神的機遇。然而在遮底下耶和華 (Shechinah) 的榮光就是那明證。願神開我們的眼來看見祂，那怕在試探、試煉、危險和不幸中。

C.H.P.

二月二十四日

「約翰一件神蹟沒有行過，但約翰指着這人所說的一切話都是真的。」(約10:41)

施洗約翰從沒行過神蹟，但主耶穌說「凡婦人所生的，沒有一個大過約翰。」(路7:28)他受託「為光作見證」(約1:8)，這也可以是你是我的使命。約翰甘於只作一把聲音，只要這能使人想到基督。

當樂意作可聽而不可見的聲音；或作一面眼不見反照神子的燦爛光輝玻璃的鏡子。當樂意作在日光未現之前吹來的微風。

作尋常最不起眼工作時當知神能看見。若你與難相處的人共處，用愛得着他們。若你犯下人生中重大錯誤，不要容許它如雲覆蓋你餘下的生命，卻要把它穩藏在你的心中，令它產生出能力和品格。

我們所作的比我們知道的更好。我們今天所作如播種或分享基督簡單真理的事，別人終有一日會看為第一樣喚起他們想到基督的事。

part, I will be satisfied not to have some great tombstone over my grave but just to know that common people will gather there once I am gone and say, "He was a good man. He never performed any miracles, but he told me about Christ, which led me to know Him for myself."

George Matheson

February 25

I will give you every place where you set your foot, as I promised. (Joshua 1:3)

All theirs on one condition: they must march across its length and breadth, measuring it off with their own feet. Yet they never marched across more than one third of the land.

In 2 Peter 1:4 we read, "He has given us his very great and precious promises." "All the land that you see I will give to you" (Gen. 13:15).

Arthur Tappan Pierson

February 26

My grace is sufficient for you. (2 Corinthians 12:9)

The other day I was riding home after a hard day's work. I was very tired and deeply depressed, when quickly, and as suddenly as a lightning bolt, the verse came to me: "My grace is sufficient for you." My response was to say, "Yes, Lord, I should think it is!" Then I burst out laughing.

I pictured a thirsty little fish who was concerned about drinking the river dry, with Father River saying, "Drink away, little fish; my stream is sufficient for you." I also envisioned a mouse afraid of starving after seven years of plenty, when Joseph says to him, "Cheer up, little mouse; my granaries are sufficient for you." Again, I imagined a man high on a mountain peak, saying to himself, "I breathe so many cubic feet of air every year, I am afraid I will deplete all the oxygen in the atmosphere." But the earth says to him, "Breathe away, filling your lungs forever; my atmosphere is sufficient for you."

O people of God, be great believers! Little faith will bring your souls to heaven, but great faith will bring heaven to your souls.

Charles H. Spurgeon

February 27

So Jacob was left alone, and a man wrestled with

於我來說，我不滿足於我的墳墓上有大墓碑，只要知道在我過身後有平凡人聚集在那兒說：「他是一個好人。他從未行過一件神蹟，但他告訴我關於基督的事，就此引領我自己來認識祂。」

喬治·馬得勝

二月二十五日

「凡你們腳掌所踏之地，我都.....賜給你們了。」(書1:3)

這為他們所屬的唯一條件是他們必須用他們的腳走過來量度其長闊。但他們從未走過那地超過三分之一。

在彼後 1:4 我們讀到：「祂已將又寶貴又極大的應許賜給我們。」
「凡你所看見的一切地，我都要賜給你。」(創 13:15)

亞瑟·塔斌·皮爾遜

二月二十六日

「我的恩典夠你用的。」(林後12:9)

經過一天辛勞工作後我踏單車回家，那時的我既疲倦又極度低落，車行甚速時「我的恩典夠你用的」這經文突然如閃電般射向我。我回應說：「是的，主啊，我應該這樣想的！」之後我爆出笑聲。

我想像河伯伯對一條憂慮會把河水喝乾的口渴小魚說：「即管喝吧，小魚兒，我的河水夠你用。」我也想像到一隻老鼠害怕在七個豐年後的饑荒，那時約瑟對牠說：「小老鼠，鼓起勁兒來，我的糧倉夠你用。」我也想像到一個站在高山之巔，自言自語的男子說：「我每年吸入那麼多立方呎的空氣，我怕我會耗盡大氣層中的氧氣。」但地球對他說：「即管吸吧，常充滿你的肺，我的空氣是夠你用的。」

神的子民啊，要作偉大的信徒！小信帶你的生命往天上去，但大信能帶天堂到你的生命來。

司布真

二月二十七日

「只剩下雅各一人。有一個人來和

him till daybreak. (Genesis 32:24)

To some they mean loneliness and grief, but to others they may mean rest and quiet. To be left alone without God would be too horrible for words, while being left alone with Him is a taste of heaven! And if His followers spent more time alone with Him, we would have spiritual giants again.

Our Master set an example for us. Remember how often He went to be alone with God? And there was a powerful purpose behind His command, “When you pray, go into your room, close the door and pray” (Matt. 6:6).

The greatest miracles of Elijah and Elisha took place when they were alone with God. Jacob was alone with God when he became a prince (see Gen. 32:28). In the same way, we too may become royalty and people who are “wondered at” (Zech. 3:8 KJV). Joshua was alone when the Lord came to him (see Josh. 1:1). Gideon and Jephthah were by themselves when commissioned to save Israel (see Judg. 6:11; 11:29). Moses was by himself at the burning bush (see Ex. 3:1-5). Cornelius was praying by himself when the Angel of God came to him (see Acts 10:1-4). No one was with Peter on the housetop when he was instructed to go to the Gentiles (see Acts 10:9-28). John the Baptist was alone in the wilderness (see Luke 1:80), and John the Beloved was alone on the island of Patmos when he was the closest to God (see Rev. 1:9).

Another wonderful result will be that people will see “no one except Jesus” (Matt. 17:8) in our lives.

February 28

Let us continually offer to God a sacrifice of praise. (Hebrews 13:15)

An inner-city missionary caught sight of earthly needs and suffering, amid saintly trust and peace. Calm, appealing eyes, etched in ebony, were set within the wrinkles of a weathered black face. On a bitterly cold night in February, she lay on a tattered bed, with no fire, no heat, and no light. Having had no breakfast, lunch, or dinner, she seemed to have nothing at all, except arthritis and faith in God. No one could have been further removed from comfortable circumstances, yet this favorite song of the dear lady played in the background:

“We are hard pressed on every side, but not crushed; perplexed, but not in despair; persecuted, but

他摔跤，直到黎明。」(創32:24)

某些人的孤單和憂傷於他人可以是休息和安靜。剩下一人而沒有神時恐怖到難以形容，若剩下一人而有祂同在，這是一嘗天福！祂的跟從者若多花時間與祂一起，我們便再有屬靈偉人了。

我們的主立下榜樣，記否祂常出去與神獨處？其實在祂命令背後有一強大目的：「你禱告的時候，要進你的內屋，關上門，禱告。」(太 6:6)

以利亞和以利沙的偉大神蹟是在他們與神單獨時發生的。雅各單獨與神一起時便成為一個王子(參看創 32:28)。同樣我們也可成為尊貴和「作預兆的」(亞 3:8)。約書亞單獨時耶和華來到他處(參書 1:1)。基甸和耶弗他獨處時被委派拯救以色列(參書 6:11)。摩西看見燒着的荊棘叢時只有他一人(參出 3:1-5)。哥尼流獨自禱告時神的天使來見他(參徒 10:1-4)。彼得在沒人同在屋頂時被打發到外邦人那處去(參徒 10:9-28)。施洗約翰獨自在曠野(參路 1:80)。主所愛的約翰在拔摩海島最親近神是都是一個人的(參啟 1:9)。

另一個奇妙的結果是人們在我們的生命中「不見一人，只見耶穌在那裏」(太 17:8)。

二月二十八日

「我們應當……常常以頌讚為祭獻給神。」(來13:15)

一個貧民區的傳教士看見一個在神聖的信靠和平安中有地上缺乏和苦難的人，平靜和懇求的雙眼深陷在黑皮膚中，安放於歷盡滄桑黑臉孔的皺褶內。在二月的寒夜她臥在破爛床上，沒有火、暖氣、燈光。未曾吃早午晚餐，除了關節炎和對神的信心外，她似乎身無分文。為此無人會再說要離開某某舒適環境的話了，然而背地播放着的是這親愛女士最喜愛的歌：

「我們四面受敵，卻不被困住；心裏作難，卻不至失望；遭逼

not abandoned; struck down, but not destroyed” (2 Cor. 4:8-9).

Laying on his deathbed, between groans Martin Luther preached, “These pains and troubles here are like the type that printers set. When we look at them, we see them backwards, and they seem to make no sense and have no meaning. But up there, when the Lord God prints out our life to come, we will find they make splendid reading.” Yet we do not have to wait until then. The apostle Paul, walking the deck of a ship on a raging sea, encouraged the frightened sailors, “Be of good cheer” (Acts 27:22 KJV). Paul, Martin Luther, and the dear black woman were all human sunflowers, seeking and seeing the Light in a world of darkness.

William C. Garnett

February 29

Put out into deep water. (Luke 5:4)

Our needs are to be met in the deep things of God. We are to sail into the deep of God’s Word, which the Holy Spirit will open to us with profound yet crystal-clear meaning. And the words we knew in the past will have an ocean of new meaning, which will render their original message very shallow.

“Put out into [the] deep” of the atonement. We must continue until the Spirit brings such understanding of Christ’s precious blood that it becomes an omnipotent balm, and food and medicine for our soul and body.

“Put out into [the] deep” of God’s purposes and His coming kingdom. We must carry on until the Lord’s coming and His millennial reign are before us, where we see eternity unfolding beyond the glorious gates, until our imagination is blinded by the brilliant light, and our heart flutters with an inexpressible anticipation of the joy of seeing Jesus and “the glory that will be revealed in us” (Rom. 8:18).

from Soul Food

The waters in Ezekiel’s vision were at first “coming out from under the threshold of the temple” (Ezek. 47:1). Then as a man went to measure it, he found it to be ankle-deep. Soon he measured and found the water was knee-deep. Again he measured and the water was to the waist. Next it was “a river that no one could cross” (Ezek. 47:5).

The Holy Spirit desires that our self be completely submerged—not merely ankle-deep, knee-deep,

迫，卻不被丟棄；打倒了，卻不至死亡。」(林後 4:8-9)

馬丁·路德在臨終前呻吟地說：「痛苦和困難就像凸字版一樣，看着他們只見其反面，似乎沒意思，毫無意義。但主神在上面將我們的生命印出來時，便發現他們成為華麗的讀物。」我們不需等到那時。使徒保羅在洶湧海上航行的船甲板上行走，鼓勵害怕的水手們說：「現在我還勸你們放心。」(徒 27:22) 保羅、馬丁·路德和那可貴黑人婦人全都是人類的向日葵，在黑暗世界中尋求望向那光。

威廉·C·耕力

二月二十九日

「把船開到水深之處。」(路5:4)

我們的需要惟有神深處的東西才滿足到。我們開船到神話語的深處，聖靈會向我們展示那深奧和清澈如水晶的意思。我們過去認識的經文會有如洋海般的新意思，反映他們原來的啟示十分顯淺。

把船開到贖罪的深處。我們定要繼續，直至聖靈帶來對基督寶血的理解，這血成為我們魂和身體無限權力的香膏、食物和藥物。

我們定須持續把船開到神旨意和祂再來之國的深處，直至主再來和祂千年國度就在我們眼前，在榮耀天門之後我們得見展示的永恆，直至我們的空想與榮耀的光輝相形失色，我們因得見耶穌那說不出來預期的喜樂和「將來要顯於我們的榮耀」(羅8:18)而忐忑不安。

摘自《靈魂的食物》

在以西結異象中的水開初是從「殿的門檻下有水往東流出。」(結47:1)之後他如同一個量度的人前行，發覺水深及踝。不久他量度，發覺水深及膝。再量時水已到腰。隨後「成為可湔的水，不可趟的河。」(結47:5)

聖靈渴想我們整個自己完全浸泡其中，不單及踝、及膝、及腰，

waist-deep, but self-deep. He wants us hidden and bathed under this life-giving stream.

J. Gresham Machen

March 1

Consider what God has done: Who can straighten what he has made crooked? (Ecclesiastes 7:13)

God often seems to place His children in places of deep difficulty, leading them into a corner from which there is no escape. He creates situations that human judgment, even if consulted, would never allow. Yet the cloudiness of the circumstance itself is used by Him to guide us to the other side. Perhaps this is where you find yourself even now.

Your situation is filled with uncertainty and is very serious, but it is perfectly right. The reason behind it will more than justify Him who brought you here, for it is a platform from which God will display His almighty grace and power.

He not only will deliver you but in doing so will impart a lesson that you will never forget. And in days to come, you will return to the truth of it through singing. You will be unable to ever thank God enough for doing exactly what He has done.

selected

March 2

Be ready in the morning, and then come up....Present yourself to me there on top of the mountain. No one is to come with you. (Exodus 34:2-3)

Meet with Him alone and regularly, having His Book of counsel open before you. Then face the ordinary, and the unique, responsibilities of each day with the renewed influence and control of His character over all your actions.

Those who have accomplished the most for God in this world are those who have been found on their knees early in the morning. For example, Matthew Henry would spend from four to eight o'clock each morning in his study. Then, after breakfast and a time of family prayer, he would return to his study until noon. After lunch, he would write till four p. m. and then spend the remainder of the day visiting friends.

Philip Doddridge referred to his Family Expositor as an example of the difference of rising at five o'clock, as opposed to seven. He realized that increasing his workday by twenty-five percent was the equivalent of adding ten work years to his life over a period of forty

且是整個人的深度。祂想我們埋藏和浸泡在這賜生命的泉水之下。

J·格雷沙母·麥真

三月一日

「你要察看神的作為，因神使為曲的，誰能變為直呢？」(傳7:13)

神似乎時常把祂的兒女放在極困難之境，領他們進入掘頭巷。祂製造的處境若由人來商議時是不容於他們之判斷的。但是環境本身的陰暗是被祂用來引導我們去到另一邊的，也許這就是你現今發現自己所在之地。

你的處境充滿不明朗，十分嚴峻，卻又是絕對正確的。背後的原因就是它會更加證明那位帶領你來到這裏的祂是對的，因這是一個神展示祂無比恩典和權能的平台。

祂不單必救贖你，且藉這樣作來同時給予你一永不會忘記的教訓。終有一日，你必邊唱邊回到事實的真相，你會發覺你為着祂正正所作的來感謝祂是從來不足夠的。

選

三月二日

「明日早晨，你要預備好了，上西乃山，在山頂上站在我面前。誰也不可和你一同上去。」(出34:2-3)

單獨和定時跟祂會面，把祂那本《忠告之書》展示在你面前，隨後才用祂的品格在你一切行動上的更新影響和控制下來面對那日常千篇一律和每天的職責。

在世上為神作工最多的人是那些一朝早跪在神面前的人。例如馬太·亨利每早花四至八小時在他的書房中，早餐後是家庭祈禱會的時刻，之後他便回書房直至午正。午餐後他會書寫直至下午四時，之後花那天餘下的時間來探訪朋友。

腓力·陶德瑞在他的《家庭用著解》一書中舉出五時起床相對於七時起床的分別，他明白到每個工作日增加百分之二十五等同於在過去四十年的生涯中增加他十年的工

years.

Adam Clarke's Commentary on the Bible was penned primarily in the early morning hours. Barnes' Notes, a popular and useful commentary by Albert Barnes, was also the fruit of the early morning. And Charles Simeon's Sketches were mostly written between four and eight a. m.

March 3

The spirit shrieked, convulsed him violently and came out. (Mark 9:26)

Evil never surrenders its grasp without a tremendous fight. We never arrive at any spiritual inheritance through the enjoyment of a picnic but always through the fierce conflicts of the battlefield. And it is the same in the deep recesses of the soul. Every human capacity that wins its spiritual freedom does so at the cost of blood. Satan is not put to flight by our courteous request. He completely blocks our way, and our progress must be recorded in blood and tears. When we are born again, it is not into a soft and protected nursery but into the open countryside, where we actually draw our strength from the distress of the storm. "We must go through many hardships to enter the kingdom of God" (Acts 14:22).

John Henry Jowett

March 4

Imitate those who through faith and patience inherit what has been promised. (Hebrews 6:12)

An old village blacksmith once said, "There is only one thing I fear: being thrown onto the scrap heap. You see, in order to strengthen a piece of steel, I must first temper it. I heat it, hammer it, and then quickly plunge it into a bucket of cold water. Very soon I know whether it will accept the tempering process or simply fall to pieces. If, after one or two tests, I see it will not allow itself to be tempered, I throw it onto the scrap heap, only to later sell it to the junkman for a few cents per pound.

"I realize the Lord tests me in the same way: through fire, water, and heavy blows of His hammer. If I am unwilling to withstand the test, or prove to be unfit for His tempering process, I am afraid He may throw me onto the scrap heap." When the fire in your life is the hottest, stand still, for "later on ... it produces a harvest" (Heb. 12:11) of blessings. Then we will be able to say with Job, "When he has tested me, I will come

作生命。

亞當·葛拉克的《聖經評論》早期是在朝早執筆的。阿爾拔·巴尼氏的《巴尼氏解經書》這本流行及有用的註釋書都是晨早的產物。而查理士·西緬的《小品集》大部分都在清晨四至八時寫成的。

三月三日

「那鬼喊叫，使孩子大大的抽了一陣瘋，就出來了。」(可 9:26)

未經巨大爭戰，魔鬼永不放棄所緊握的。我們永不能藉郊遊樂能得任何屬靈的產業，卻總是藉戰場上的兇猛爭鬥。在生命中深深的歇息亦一樣。每個能贏得屬靈自由的人類能奈同樣要付上血之代價。撒但不會因我們有禮貌請求而逃竄。他會全面擋住我們前路，我們進程的記錄必以血和淚寫成。我們重生進入的不是安穩受保護的育嬰室，而是敞開的鄉郊，在那裏我們實在地拿出勇力面對動亂而來的苦惱。

「我們進入神的國，必須經歷許多艱難。」(徒 14:22)

約翰·亨利·祖屈

三月四日

「總要效法那些憑信心和忍耐承受應許的人。」(來 6:12)

一年老鄉村鐵匠說：「我只害怕一事，就是被拋在廢鐵堆上。你知為了叫一塊鋼鐵堅強有力，定須鍛煉它。我燒它，鎚它，之後迅速地把它浸進冷水桶中。很快便知道究竟它要接受鍛煉過程還是落得破碎收場。若經過一兩次的試驗，見它不再容許自己再受鍛煉時，我便會把它拋在廢鐵堆上，往後只會每磅幾仙賣給拾廢鐵者了。」

「我知神用相同的方法試驗我：經過火、水和祂鎚子的重擊。我若不願經受試驗，或證明不適合祂鍛煉之工時，恐怕祂或會拋我在廢鐵堆上。」當你生命之火最熾熱時，為着「後來……結出平安的果子」(來12:11)的福來站穩。那麼我們便可與約伯同說：「祂試煉我之後

forth as gold” (Job 23:10).

selected

Sainthood finds its source in suffering. Remember, it requires eleven tons of pressure on a piano’s strings for it to be tuned. And God will tune you to perfect harmony with heaven’s theme if you will withstand the strain.

March 5

We have come to share in Christ if we hold firmly till the end the confidence we had at first. (Hebrews 3:14)

Often the last step is the winning step. In Pilgrim’s Progress the greatest number of dangers were lurking in the area closest to the gates of the Celestial City. It was in that region the Doubting Castle stood. And it was there the Enchanted Ground lured the tired traveler to fatal slumber. It is when heaven’s heights are in full view that the gates of hell are the most persistent and full of deadly peril. “Let us not become weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up” (Gal. 6:9). “Run in such a way as to get the prize” (1 Cor. 9:24).

The greatest challenge in receiving great things from God is holding on for the last half hour.

selected

March 6

We had hoped. (Luke 24:21)

I have always been so sorry that the two disciples walking with Jesus on the road to Emmaus did not say to Him, “We still hope” instead of “We had hoped.” The situation is very sad, because in their minds it is over.

Oh, if only they had said, “Everything has come against our hope, and it looks as if our trust were in vain. Yet we will not give up, because we believe we will see Him again.” Instead, they walked by His side, declaring their shattered faith. Jesus had to say to them, “How foolish you are, and how slow of heart to believe!” (Luke 24:25).

Are we not in danger of having these same words said to us? We can afford to lose every possession we have, except our faith in the God of truth and love. May we never express our faith, as these disciples did, in the past tense—“We had hoped.” Yet may we always say,

，我必如精金。」(伯23:10)

選

成聖源自受苦。謹記一條鋼琴弦線需要十一噸的拉力來調音。神必會把你完美地調校至與天上的主旋律和諧，只要你能經得起那拉力。

三月五日

「我們若將起初確實的信心堅持到底，就在基督裏有分了。」(來 3:14)

最後一步常是勝利的一步。在《天路歷程》中，大量的危險潛伏在最近天城門的區域，疑惑城堡矗立那處；迷人地就在那處引誘那些疲倦的旅行者作那鑄成不可挽回錯誤的打盹；就是當高天完全在望時，地獄之門還是最持久和充滿致命危險的。「我們行善，不可喪志。若不灰心，到了時候，就要收成。」(加6:9)「你們也當這樣跑，好叫你們得着獎賞。」(林前9:24)

從神處得着美物的最大挑戰就在最後半小時的堅持。

選

三月六日

「但我們素來所盼望……」(路 24:21)

我常為與耶穌同往以馬忤斯那兩門徒不跟主說「我們仍盼望」，卻說「我們素來盼望」而難過。這十分淒涼，因在他們心中一切已然過去。

只要他們說「事事都與我們所盼望的相違，看來我們的信都落空。然而我們不放棄，因我們相信必再次見祂。」可是祂在旁同行，披露他們支離破碎的信心。耶穌對他們說：「無知的人哪……你們的心，信得太遲鈍了。」(路 24:25)

我們不也落在對我們說相同話的危險中麼？我們經得起失去擁有一切，除了對真理和愛之神的信。但願我們永不用這兩門徒用過去式所說「我們素來所盼望」來表述信。

“I have hope.”

from Crumbs

March 7

We were harassed at every turn. (2 Corinthians 7:5)

Why is it that God leads us in this way, allowing such strong and constant pressure on us? One of His purposes is to show us His all-sufficient strength and grace more effectively than if we were free from difficulties and trials. “We have this treasure in jars of clay to show that this all-surpassing power is from God and not from us” (2 Cor. 4:7).

Another purpose is to bring us a greater awareness of our dependence upon Him.

This is exactly where Jesus Himself stood and where He desires us to stand.

They are God’s school of faith, and it is much better for us to learn to trust Him than to live a life of enjoyment. And once the lesson of faith has been learned, it is an everlasting possession and an eternal fortune gained. Yet without trust in God, even great riches will leave us in poverty.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

March 8

Do as you promised ... that your name will be great forever. (1 Chronicles 17:23-24)

Hardly any stance could be more completely beautiful, strong, or safe than that of putting your finger on a promise of God’s divine Word and then claiming it. Doing so requires no anguish, struggle, or wrestling but simply presenting the check and asking for cash.

F. B. Meyer

Every promise of Scripture is a letter from God, which we may plead before Him with this reasonable request: “Do as you promised.”

“Remember your word to your servant, for you have given me hope” (Ps. 119:49). This is a very common plea and is a double argument, for it is “your word.” “You have given me hope.”

Charles H. Spurgeon

Being fully persuaded that God had power to do what he had promised. Romans 4:21

It is the everlasting faithfulness of God that makes

總要說「我們有盼望。」

摘自《碎渣兒》

三月七日

「我們.....周圍遭患難。」(林後 7:5)

神容許我們受這麼強大和持續的壓力，其中一個目的就是向我們顯示祂全足的力量和恩典，使我們能綽綽有餘地脫離困難和試探。「我們有這寶貝放在瓦器裏，要顯明這莫大的能力，是出於神，不是出於我們。」(林後 4:7)

另一個目的是帶領我們更醒覺我們對祂的倚靠。

這就正正是耶穌自己所站的地位和祂渴望我們要站的地位。

試探是神教導信心的學校，學習信靠祂比有歡樂生活好得多。一旦學成信心的功課，便會永遠擁有，這也是一永恆福氣的得着。但若沒有信靠神，那怕是極大的財富也只會把我們留置在貧困中。

摘自《在地若天的日子》

三月八日

「照祢所說的.....願祢的名永遠堅立。」(代上 17:23-24)

沒有一個姿態比將你的手指指向神聖言上的應許來索求更完全美麗、強而有力和安全。這樣作並不需要痛苦、掙扎或搏鬥，而只是呈上支票來提取現金一般容易。

邁爾

聖經的每項應許都是神的一封信，我們可藉「照祢所說的」這合理請求來向祂祈求。

「求祢記念向祢僕人所應許的話，叫我有盼望。」(詩 119:49) 這尋常懇求有其相重論據，因這是「祢的話」，「祢叫我有盼望」。

司布真

「且滿心相信，神所應許的必能作成。」(羅 4:21)

是神永恆的信實使聖經的應許

a Bible promise “very great and precious” (2 Peter 1:4).
Gurnal

Every promise of God’s is built on four pillars. The first two are His justice and holiness, which will never allow Him to deceive us. The third is His grace or goodness, which will not allow Him to forget. And the fourth is His truth, which will not allow Him to change, which enables Him to accomplish what He has promised.

selected

March 9

Descend from the crest. (Song of Songs 4:8)

Bearing the burden of crushing weight actually gives Christians wings. This may sound like a contradiction in terms, but it is a blessed truth. While enduring a severe trial, David cried, “Oh, that I had the wings of a dove! I would fly away and be at rest” (Ps. 55:6). Yet before he finished his meditation, he seems to have realized that his wish for wings was attainable, for then he said, “Cast your cares on the Lord and he will sustain you” (Ps. 55:22).

The saints’ burdens are God-given, leading us to wait upon Him. And once we have done so, the burden is transformed into a pair of wings through the miracle of trust, and the one who was weighted down “will soar on wings like eagles” (Isa. 40:31).

from Sunday School Times

March 10

My righteous one will live by faith. (Hebrews 10:38)

A believer once related that it seemed as if God had totally withdrawn Himself from her. His mercy seemed completely gone. Her loneliness lasted for six weeks, until the heavenly Lover seemed to say to her, “You have looked for Me in the outside world of emotions, yet all the while I have been waiting inside for you. Meet Me now in the inner chamber of your spirit, for I am there.”

And though the bush before me does not seem to burn, it does burn. I will take the shoes from my feet, “for the place where [I am] standing is holy ground” (Ex. 3:5).

London Christian

Trust God’s Word and His power more than you

「又寶貴又極大」(彼後 1:4)。

居勞

每個神的應許都建築在四條柱石上。首兩條是祂的公義和聖潔，都不容祂欺騙我們。第三條是祂的恩典或稱為恩慈，這不容許祂來忘記。而第四條是祂的真實，這不容許祂來改變，這也叫祂能夠作成祂所應許的。

選

三月九日

「從.....山往下。」(歌 4:8)

背負沉重擔子實際上是給基督徒一雙翼，這可能聽起來自相矛盾，卻是蒙福的事實。大衛忍受劇烈的試煉時大聲叫喊說：「但願我有翅膀像鴿子，我就飛去得享安息。」(詩55:6)在他完成默想前，似乎所渴求雙翼的願望已成真，之後他說：「祢要把祢的重擔卸給耶和華，祂必撫養你。」(詩55:22)

聖徒的擔子是神所給，目的引領我們侍候祂。我們一旦這樣行，那擔子便藉信靠的神蹟而變成為一雙翼，使那曾經是過分擔憂的人「必如鷹展翅上騰」(賽40:31)。

摘自《主日學報》

三月十日

「義人必因信得生。」(來 10:38)

一個信徒有一次說到神似乎完全棄她於不顧，似乎完全失去祂的憐憫一般。她的孤單持續了六個星期，直至那天上的愛者似乎對她說：「你曾在感性的外在世界來尋找我，但我整段時候都在你裏頭等候着你呢。現在就在你靈裏的內室來與我相會吧，因我就在那裏。」

雖然在我前面的樹叢似乎不會燒着，但它真的是燒着的。我必會除掉我腳上的鞋，『因為我所站之地是聖地。』(出3:5)

倫敦基督徒

當信靠神的話和祂的權能多於

trust your own feelings and experiences. Remember, your Rock is Christ, and it is the sea that ebbs and flows with the tides, not Him.

Samuel Rutherford

Sail away! Spread your sail toward the storm and trust in Him who rules the raging seas. A brightly colored bird is safest when in flight. If its nest is near the ground or if it flies too low, it exposes itself to the hunter's net or trap. In the same way, if we cower in the lowlands of feelings and emotions, we will find ourselves entangled in a thousand nets of doubt, despair, temptation, and unbelief. "How useless to spread a net in full view of ALL THE BIRDS!" (Prov. 1:17). "Put your hope in God" (Ps. 42:5).

J. R. Macduff

When I cannot feel the faith of assurance, I live by the fact of God's faithfulness.

Matthew Henry

March 11

After the death of Moses the servant of the Lord, the Lord said to Joshua son of Nun, Moses' aide: "Moses my servant is dead. Now then, you and all these people, get ready to cross the Jordan River." (Joshua 1:1-2)

Weeping inconsolably beside a grave will never bring back the treasure of a lost love, nor can any blessing come from such great sadness. Sorrow causes deep scars, and indelibly writes its story on the suffering heart. We never completely recover from our greatest griefs and are never exactly the same after having passed through them. Yet sorrow that is endured in the right spirit impacts our growth favorably and brings us a greater sense of compassion for others. Indeed, those who have no scars of sorrow or suffering upon them are poor. "The joy set before" (Heb. 12:2) us should shine on our griefs just as the sun shines through the clouds, making them radiant. God has ordained our truest and richest comfort to be found by pressing on toward the goal. Sitting down and brooding over our sorrow deepens the darkness surrounding us, allowing it to creep into our heart. And soon our strength has changed to weakness. But if we will turn from the gloom and remain faithful to the calling of God, the light will shine again and we will grow stronger.

信靠你自己的感覺和經驗。謹記你的磐石是基督，潮汐漲退的是海潮而不是祂。

撒母耳·路德福

啟航吧！向風暴揚帆，信靠掌管怒海的祂。飛行中最鮮明顏色雀鳥最安全，若牠的巢接近地面，或牠飛得太低，便把自己暴露在獵人的網子或陷阱中。同樣，我們若在感覺和情感的低地中畏縮時，必發現身陷千百個疑慮、失望、試探和不信的網羅中，「好像飛鳥，網羅設在眼前仍不躲避。」(箴1:17)「應當仰望神。」(詩42:5)

J.R.麥道夫

當我不能感覺到確實的信時，我便以神信實這事實來活了。

馬太·亨利

三月十一日

「耶和華的僕人摩西死了以後，耶和華曉諭摩西的幫手，嫩的兒子約書亞，說：我的僕人摩西死了。現在你要起來，和眾百姓過這約旦河。」(書 1:1-2)

不受安慰地在墓旁哭泣不能把失去所愛的親人帶回來，不能從大憂傷中帶來任何祝福。憂傷造成深疤，在痛苦的心中書寫那擦洗不掉的故事。我們永不能經過最大的憂傷後回復原貌。但是以正確的靈來忍受的憂傷激起我們滿意的增長和帶給我們對他人更大的同情心。事實上那些沒有憂傷傷痕或沒有受過這樣苦的人是貧窮的。那擺在我們前面的喜樂(來12:2)應該如同太陽照透雲兒般照耀在我們的憂傷上，使他們發出光輝。神已命定我們藉向着目標前行來找到最真實和最豐富的安慰。坐下和孕育我們的憂傷加深圍繞我們的黑暗，容許它爬入我們的心，不久我們的力量便變成為軟弱了。但我們若從幽暗中轉出來，仍對神的呼召忠誠，那麼那光便會再次照耀，我們也會長得更強壯。

March 12

The Lord made an east wind blow across the land all that day and all that night. By morning the wind had brought the locusts. Pharaoh quickly summoned Moses and Aaron....And the Lord changed the wind to a very strong west wind, which caught up the locusts and carried them into the Red Sea. Not a locust was left anywhere in Egypt. (Exodus 10:13, 16, 19)

At first in front a raging sea defied Israel; on either side, mountains cut off any hope of escape; and above them, a hurricane seemed to blow. "The Israelites looked up, and there were the Egyptians, marching after them. They were terrified and cried out to the Lord" (Ex. 14:10).

Only when it seemed they were trapped for the enemy did the glorious triumph come. The stormy wind blew forward, beating back the waves. The vast multitude of Israelites marched ahead along the path of the deep sea floor—a path covered with God's protecting love. On either side were crystal walls of water, glowing in the light of the glory of the Lord, and high above them roared the thunder of the storm. And so it continued on through the night, until at dawn the next day, as the last of the Israelites set foot on shore, the work of the stormy wind was done.

Then Israel sang a song to the Lord of how the stormy wind fulfilled His word: "The enemy boasted, 'I will pursue, I will overtake them. I will divide the spoils....' But you blew with your breath, and the sea covered them. They sank like lead in the mighty waters" (Ex. 15:9-10).

Someday, through His great mercy, we too will stand on "a sea of glass," holding "harps given [to us] by God." Then we will sing "the song of Moses the servant of God and the song of the Lamb: 'Great and marvelous are your deeds, Lord God Almighty. Just and true are your ways, King of the ages'" (Rev. 15:2-3). Then we will know how the stormy winds have won our deliverance.

Mark Guy Pearse

March 13

Just and true are your ways, King of the ages. (Revelation 15:3)

Mrs. Charles H. Spurgeon suffered greatly with poor health for more than twenty-five years:

三月十二日

「那一晝一夜，耶和華使東風颳在埃及地上，到了早晨，東風把蝗蟲颳了來.....於是法老急忙召了摩西、亞倫來.....耶和華轉了極大的西風，把蝗蟲颳起，吹入紅海，在埃及的四境連一個也沒有留下。」(出10:13,16,19)

開初以色列前面是怒濤的抵擋，左右兩邊的高山截斷他們逃跑的希望，上方似乎有颶風在吹襲。「以色列人舉目看見埃及人趕來，就甚懼怕，向耶和華哀求。」(出14:10)

就在他們似乎被困時仇敵才昂然以得勝的姿態來到。那大風向前吹，擊退巨浪。那大群的以色列人向前在深深的河床——一條鋪滿神保護之愛的路徑上——操過去。兩旁都是明如水晶的水牆，在耶和華的榮耀光中發亮，在他們高高之上是暴風的雷吼。這樣持續整個晚上，直至第二天的黎明。當最後一個以色列人踏足上岸時，那大風的職責便完結。

之後以色列人向耶和華唱頌那大風如何成就祂的說話：「仇敵說：我要追趕，我要追上，我要分擄物.....祢叫風一吹，海就把他們淹沒，他們如鉛沉在大水之中。」(出15:9-10)

那一天我們藉着祂的大憐憫也會站在玻璃海上，拿着神的琴。「唱神僕人摩西的歌，和羔羊的歌，說：主神，全能者阿，祢的作為大哉，奇哉！萬世之王阿，祢的道途義哉，誠哉！」(啟15:2-3)之後我們便知道那大風如何曾贏取我們的拯救。

馬可·佳·皮爾遜

三月十三日

「萬國之王阿，祢的道途義哉，誠哉！」(啟15:3)

司布真太太苦苦忍受病痛已超過二十五年了。

“With a sorrowful heart I asked, ‘Why does the Lord deal with a child of His in this way? Why does He so often send such sharp and bitter pain to visit me? Why does He allow this lingering weakness to hinder the sweet service I long to render to His poor servants?’

“For a while silence reigned in the little room, being broken only by the crackling of an oak log burning in the fireplace. Suddenly I heard a sweet, soft sound: a faint, yet clear, musical note, like the tender trill of a robin beneath my window.

“‘It’s coming from the log on the fire!’ The fire was unshackling the imprisoned music from deep within the old oak’s heart!

“Maybe some of us are like this old oak log: cold, hard, unfeeling, and never singing any melodious sounds. It is the fires burning around us that release notes of trust in God and bring cheerful compliance with His will. As I thought of this, the fire burned, and my soul found sweet comfort in the parable so strangely revealed before me. Then, let the furnace be ‘heated seven times hotter than usual’ [Dan. 3:19].”

March 14

Moses approached the thick darkness where God was. (Exodus 20:21)

God still has His secrets—hidden from “the wise and learned” (Luke 10:21). Do not fear these unknown things, but be content to accept the things you cannot understand and to wait patiently.

Do not be afraid to enter the cloud descending on your life, for God is in it. And the other side is radiant with His glory. “Do not be surprised at the painful trial you are suffering, as though something strange were happening to you. But rejoice that you participate in the sufferings of Christ” (1 Peter 4:12-13). When you feel the most forsaken and lonely, God is near. He is in the darkest cloud. Forge ahead into the darkness without flinching, knowing that under the shelter of the cloud, God is waiting for you.

selected

March 15

Do not be afraid, O worm Jacob....I will make you into a threshing sledge, new and sharp, with many teeth. (Isaiah 41:14-15)

A worm is delicate and is easily bruised by a stone or crushed beneath a passing wheel. Yet a threshing tool with sharp teeth can cut through rock and not be

「我以憂傷的心來問：『為何主這樣對待祂兒女？常送來如此銳利和厲害的苦痛給我？容許這持續的軟弱來阻止我渴望託付給祂可憐眾僕人的甜美事奉？』」

「支配着這小房間的沉寂，被在火爐燒着的橡木的爆破聲所打破。突然之間我聽到一甜美、柔善的聲音：一把輕微卻是清晰如音符，像窗後支更鳥親切的啼叫。」

「『這是來自火中的橡木！』那火把那深藏在老橡木心中被囚禁的音樂釋放出來！」

「也許我們有人像那老橡木般冰硬、沒感覺和永不唱任何悅耳之音。是環繞我們燃燒的火釋放神裏頭的信實音符，歡愉地帶出祂旨意的應諾。火在燒時想及此，我的魂因着這樣奇妙地向我啟示的比喻而分外覺着安舒。就讓那火爐「燒熱，比尋常更加七倍。」（但3:19）

三月十四日

「摩西就挨近神所在的幽暗之中。」（出 20:21）

神仍有祂向那些「聰明通達人」（路 10:21）隱藏的秘密。不要害怕這些未知之事，但要滿足於接受你不明白的事和忍耐等候。

不要怕進入降在你生命的雲中，因神在其中。雲的另一邊散發光彩。「有火煉的試驗臨到你們，不要以為奇怪，（似乎是遭遇非常的事）倒要歡喜，因為你們是與基督一同受苦。」（彼前 4:12-13）當你感到最被遺棄和孤單時，神是近的。祂是在最黑暗的雲中。努力進入最黑暗中不要畏縮，當知道神在雲的蔭下正在等待着你呢。

選

三月十五日

「你這蟲雅各..... 不要害怕..... 我已使你成為有快齒打糧的新器具。」（賽 41:14-15）

蟲是柔弱的，和容易被石碰傷或被經過的輪子壓碎的。但是一件快齒打糧的新器具能割破石塊而不

broken, leaving its mark upon the rock. And almighty God can convert one into the other. He can take an individual or a nation, who has all the weakness of a worm, and through the energizing work of His own Spirit, endow that person or nation with strength enough to make a profound mark upon the history of their time.

Therefore a “worm” may take heart. Almighty God can make us stronger than our circumstances and can turn each situation to our good. In God’s strength we can make them all pay tribute to our soul. We can even take the darkest disappointment, break it open, and discover a precious jewel of grace inside.

John Henry Jowett

God is the God of the unsuccessful—the God of those who have failed. Heaven is being filled with earth’s broken lives, and there is no “bruised reed” (Isa. 42:3) that Christ cannot take and restore to a glorious place of blessing and beauty.

J. R. Miller

March 16

For our good. (Hebrews 12:10)

Gwen was an undisciplined and strong-willed girl, always accustomed to having her own way. One day she had a terrible accident that crippled her for life, leading her to become even more rebellious. Once while in a complaining mood, she was visited by a local “sky pilot,” or mountaineer missionary. He told her the following parable about the canyon:

“At first there were no canyons but only the vast, open prairie. One day the Master of the prairie, walking across His great grasslands, asked the prairie, ‘Where are your flowers?’ The prairie responded, ‘Master, I have no flower seeds.’”

The Master then spoke to the birds, and they brought seeds of every kind of flower, scattering them far and wide. When the Master saw the flowers, He was pleased. But He failed to see His favorites and asked the prairie. So once again He ordered the birds to bring all the seeds and spread them far and wide. But when the Master arrived, He still could not find the flowers he loved the most. The prairie cried sorrowfully, ‘O Master, I cannot keep the flowers. The winds sweep fiercely across me, and the sun beats down upon my breast, and they simply wither up and blow away.’ Then the Master spoke to the lightning,

至破損，且在石上留下痕跡。全能的神就能將前者變成後者，祂能將有全是蟲之軟弱的個人或國家，經過祂自己的靈的加力之工後，使那人或國家有足夠的能力來在他們的時代歷史中留下深遠的痕跡。

「蟲」也可振作，全能神能使我们比環境更強大，能使每個處境成為我們的益處。我們能以神的能力令環境向我們的魂致敬。我們甚至能將最黑暗的失望破開，從中發現珍貴如珠寶的恩典。

約翰·亨利·祖屈

神是不勝利之人的神，神作失敗之人的神。天堂住滿世上破碎的生命，沒有「壓傷的蘆葦」(賽42:3)基督不能取來回復至蒙福和美麗的榮美之境。

J.R.米勒

三月十六日

「是要我們得益處。」(來12:10)

不受約束和己意強的女孩關(Gwen)總習慣我行我素。有一日她遇上嚴重意外而終身跛癱，使她變得更反叛。有一當地的山間傳道團體「天路嚮導」的傳道人來探望她，告訴她峽谷的寓言：

「開初未有峽谷時只有又大又廣闊的草原。有一天草原的主人行經祂的大草地時，向草原問道：『你的花兒在那裏？』回答說：『我沒有花兒的種子。』」

於是主人對鳥兒說話，他們便帶來每種花兒的種子，播種既廣且遠。主人看見花兒時便高興。但祂不能見到祂最喜愛的。因此祂叫鳥兒再次帶來所有種子，種得既廣且遠。但當主人來到時，祂仍不能找着祂最愛的。草原憂傷地哭着說：『風兒猛烈地橫掃我，太陽重重打在我胸口上，那些種子這樣凋謝和吹走了。』於是主人向閃電說話，迅速霹靂一閃，那閃電將大草原的心臟破開。那大草原在痛苦中搖晃

and with one swift bolt, the lightning split the prairie through its heart. The prairie reeled and groaned in agony and for many days bitterly complained about its dark, jagged, and gaping wound. But the river poured its water through the chasm, bringing rich, dark soil with it. Once again the birds brought seeds and scattered them in the canyon. After a long time the rough rocks were adorned with soft mosses and trailing vines, and all the secluded cliffs were draped with clematis and columbine. Giant elms raised their huge limbs high into the sunlight, while at their feet small cedars and balsam firs clustered together. Everywhere violets, anemones, and maidenhair ferns grew and bloomed, until the canyon became the Master's favorite place for rest, peace, and joy."

Then the "sky pilot" said to her, "'The fruit [or "flowers"] of the Spirit [are] love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, ... gentleness' [Gal. 5:22-23], and some of these grow only in the canyon." Gwen softly asked, "Which are the canyon flowers?" The missionary answered, "Patience, kindness, and gentleness. Yet even though love, joy, and peace may bloom in the open spaces, the blossom is never as beautiful, or the perfume as fragrant, as when they are found blooming in the canyon."

Gwen sat very still for quite some time, and then longingly said with trembling lips, "There are no flowers in my canyon-only jagged rocks." The missionary lovingly responded, "Someday they will bloom, dear Gwen. The Master will find them, and we will see them, too."

March 17

Stay there until I tell you. (Matthew 2:13)

I'll stay where You've put me; I will, dear Lord,
Though I wanted so badly to go;
I was eager to march with the "rank and file,"
Yes, I wanted to lead them, You know.
I planned to keep step to the music loud,
To cheer when the banner unfurled,
To stand in the midst of the fight straight and
proud,
But I'll stay where You've put me.

I'll stay where You've put me; I'll work, dear Lord,
Though the field be narrow and small,
And the ground be neglected, and stones lie thick,

和呻吟，多日苦苦埋怨它那黑暗、凹凸不平和破裂的傷口。但河流傾注河水，流經峽縫，帶來肥沃、黑色的土壤。鳥兒再次帶來種子，播送在峽谷中，長時間後粗糙的石頭以柔軟的地衣和叢生的葡萄藤為裝飾，所有人跡罕至的懸崖披滿鐵線蓮和耬斗菜。巨大的榆樹向陽光舉起他們的巨肢，他們的脚下是細小的雪松和鳳仙花杉叢生。處處都有紫羅蘭、銀蓮花和掌葉鐵線蕨生長和盛放，直至峽谷成為主人最喜愛休憩、安息和歡樂之所。」

之後那天路嚮導對她說：「聖靈的果子（花兒）是仁愛、喜樂、和平、忍耐、恩慈、良善、信實、溫柔、節制。」（加5:22-23）有一些只在峽谷中生長。」關輕聲問：「哪些是峽谷的花兒？」答說：「忍耐、恩慈和良善。仁愛、喜樂與和平雖在開揚之處開花，但總不及所發現盛放在峽谷中的花兒那麼美麗，香氣那樣芬芳。」

關靜坐一會兒後，期待地口兒顫震地說：「在我峽谷不平的石上找不到花兒。」那傳道者慈愛地回答：「終有一天他們會開花的，親愛的關，主人會發現他們，我們也會見到他們。」

三月十七日

「住在那裏，等我吩咐你。」（太2:13）

親愛主，我安於祢的擺佈，
雖然我十分想離去，
我樂於與士兵一起步操前行，
祢知道我真想作他們的領頭人。
我想着隨着大聲的音樂來同步，
在旗幟展開時歡呼，
站在勇往直前的戰士當中，

但我安於祢擺放我之處。

親愛主，我安於在祢安放我處工作
雖然我的田地是狹窄和細小，
此地被人忽視，四圍滿佈厚石，

And there seems to be no life at all.
The field is Your own, only give me the seed,
I'll sow it with never a fear;
I'll till the dry soil while I wait for the rain,
And rejoice when the green blades appear;
I'll work where You've put me.

I'll stay where You've put me; I will, dear Lord;
I'll bear the day's burden and heat,
Always trusting You fully; when sunset has come
I'll lay stalks of grain at Your feet.
And then, when my earth work is ended and done,
In the light of eternity's glow,
Life's record all closed, I surely will find
It was better to stay than to go;
I'll stay where You've put me.

March 18

He answered nothing. (Mark 15:3 KJV)

There is no scene in all the Bible more majestic than our Savior remaining silent before the men who were reviling Him. With one quick burst of divine power, or one fiery word of rebuke, He could have caused His accusers to be laid prostrate at His feet. Yet He answered not one word, allowing them to say and do their very worst. He stood in THE POWER OF STILLNESS—God's holy silent Lamb.

There is a place of stillness that allows God the opportunity to work for us and gives us peace. It is a stillness that ceases our scheming, self-vindication, and the search for a temporary means to an end through our own wisdom and judgment. Instead, it lets God provide an answer, through His unfailing and faithful love, to the cruel blow we have suffered.

A. B. Simpson

I remember hearing Bishop Whipple of Minnesota, who was well known as "The Apostle of the Indians," voice these beautiful words: "For the last thirty years, I have looked for the face of Christ in the people with whom I have disagreed."

W. H. Griffith-Thomas

March 19

Dear friends, do not be surprised at the painful trial you are suffering....But rejoice that you participate in the sufferings of Christ. (1 Peter 4:12-13)

似乎沒有一點生命的跡象。
地是祢的，只要給我種子，
我會毫不懼怕地來播種，
我會耕作那乾土，等待下雨。
青葉初現帶來歡欣，
我會在祢放我在那兒工作，

親愛主，祢安於祢擺放我之處，
我會忍受白日的勞苦和炎熱，
總會完全相信祢。當日落時分，
我會臥在祢腳旁的禾捆。
當我日務工作時，
得見永恆的光輝，
生命卷宗全都完結，
我定必發現留下比前行更好，
我會留在祢放我在那處。

三月十八日

「祂甚麼都不回答。」(可 15:3)

在整本聖經中沒有一個場景比我們的救主在被人罵時保持無聲更有威儀。只要一記神能力的迸發，或者如火的一聲譴責，祂便能使指控祂的人跪倒在祂腳前。祂卻不答一言，容讓他們按他們最惡劣的情況來說和做，祂以無聲的權能來站住，祂是神聖沉默的羔羊。

沉默提供地方容許神來替我們作工和給我們平安。這是一停止我們的計策和自我辯解的沉默，它也會尋找一暫時的方法來結束我們一己的智慧和判斷。代之的是為着我們所受的殘忍擊打，它藉着不死和信實的愛來讓神提供答案。

宣信

我記得曾聽過被譽為「印度人的使徒」明尼蘇達州的威蒲主教說過這些美麗講說：「在最後的三十年，我從我不同意的人中來尋找基督的面孔。」

W.H.己力夫·多馬

三月十九日

「親愛的弟兄阿，有火煉的試驗臨到你們，不要以為奇怪，.....倒要歡喜，因為你們是與基督一同受苦。」(彼前 4:12-13)

Many hours of waiting were necessary to enrich David's harp with song. And hours of waiting in the wilderness will provide us with psalms of "thanksgiving and the sound of singing" (Isa. 51:3). The hearts of the discouraged here below will be lifted, and joy will be brought to our Father's heavenly home.

What was the preparation for Jesse's son, David, to compose songs unlike any others ever heard before on earth? It was the sinful persecution he endured at the hands of the wicked that brought forth his cries for God's help. Then David's faint hope in God's goodness blossomed into full songs of rejoicing, declaring the Lord's mighty deliverances and multiplied mercies. Every sorrow was yet another note from his harp, and every deliverance another theme of praise.

Waiting on God and abiding in His will is to know Him in "the fellowship of sharing in his sufferings" (Phil. 3:10) and "to be conformed to the likeness of his Son" (Rom. 8:29).

Anna Shipton

I thank Christ Jesus our Lord, who has given me strength, that he considered me faithful, appointing me to his service. 1 Timothy 1:12

March 20

Sorrowful, yet always rejoicing. (2 Corinthians 6:10)

A stoic person despises the shedding of tears, but a Christian is not forbidden to weep. Yet the soul may become silent from excessive grief, just as the quivering sheep may remain quiet beneath the scissors of the shearer. Or, when the heart is at the verge of breaking beneath the waves of a trial, the sufferer may seek relief by crying out with a loud voice. But there is something even better.

May it continue to be! Therefore, amid a multitude of trials, souls who love God will discover reasons for boundless, leaping joy. Even though "deep calls to deep" (Ps. 42:7), the clear cadence of the Lord's song will be heard. And during the most difficult hour that could ever enter a human life, it will be possible to bless the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ.

Not simply to endure or to choose God's will but to rejoice in it "with an inexpressible and glorious joy" (1 Peter 1:8).

from Tried by Fire

必需有長時間的等候來充實大衛的詩歌琴音。在曠野長時間的等候也會為我們提供「感謝和歌唱的聲音」(賽51:3)的詩篇。在日光之下心靈沮喪必會得着提升，也必會帶同喜樂到我們父的天家去。

耶西的兒子大衛準備甚麼來譜寫他不像別人在世上曾聽聞的歌曲呢？就是在他忍受惡人之手的邪惡迫害下使他向神呼求幫助。之後大衛對神美善的微弱盼望綻放成豐富的歡歌，宣告耶和華的大能拯救和多方的憐憫。每個憂傷都成為他豎琴的另一個琴音，每次的拯救都成為另一個讚美的主題。

等候神和貼近祂的旨意是「和祂一同受苦，效法祂的死」(腓3:10)和「效法祂兒子的模樣」(羅8:29)上認識基督。

安娜·薛頓

「我感謝那給我力量的，我們主基督耶穌，因祂以我有忠心，派我服事祂。」(提前1:12)

三月二十日

「似乎憂愁卻是常常快樂的。」(林後6:10)

一個禁欲主義者會輕視流淚，而一個基督徒是不禁止哭泣的。但人會因過分的憂傷而變得沉靜，如同那顫抖的羔羊在剪毛之人手下無聲。又或者在試煉波濤下心正面臨崩潰的邊緣時，那受苦者也許會藉大聲呼叫來尋求得減輕痛苦，但是還有比這更好的。

任讓情況如昔！因此，在眾多的試煉中，那些愛神之人必會發現無邊際躍動喜樂的原因。雖然「深淵就與深淵回應」(詩42:7)，但必得聽見耶和華歌曲清晰的抑揚節拍。最艱難時刻的經歷會進入人生，但它必會成為我們主耶穌基督之父神的讚美。

不單忍受和選上神旨意，且要以「說不出來，滿有榮光的大喜樂」(彼前1:8)來歡呼。

摘自《火中的試煉》

March 21

According to your faith will it be done to you.
(Matthew 9:29)

Let us remember that no earthly circumstances can hinder the fulfillment of God's Word. We must look steadfastly at His immutable Word and not at the uncertainty of this everchanging world. God desires for us to believe His Word without other evidence, and then He is ready to do for us "according to [our] faith."

When once His Word is past,
When He has said, "I will," [Heb. 13:5 KJV]
The thing will come at last;
God keeps His promise still. [See 2 Cor. 1:20.]

The prayers of the Pentecostal era were prayed with such simple faith that they were like cashing a check.

Robert Anderson

And God said....And it was so. Genesis 1:9

March 22

After forty years had passed, an angel appeared to Moses in the flames of a burning bush in the desert near Mount Sinai....Then the Lord said to him," ... I have indeed seen the oppression of my people in Egypt. I have heard their groaning and have come down to set them free. Now come, I will send you back to Egypt." (Acts 7:30, 33-34)

Forty years was a long time to wait in preparation for a great mission. Yet when God delays, He is not inactive. This is when He prepares His instruments and matures our strength. Then at the appointed time we will rise up and be equal to our task. Even Jesus of Nazareth had thirty years of privacy, growing in wisdom before He began His work.

John Henry Jowett

God is never in a hurry. He spends years preparing those He plans to greatly use, and never thinks of the days of preparation as being too long or boring.

Joseph endured a long trial, and God often has to burn the lessons he learned into the depths of our being, using the fires of prolonged pain. "He will sit as a refiner and purifier of silver" (Mal. 3:3), yet He knows

三月二十一日

「照着你們的信給你們成全了吧。」
(太 9:29)

讓我們謹記沒有地上的環境能牽制神說話的成就。我們定須堅定注目在祂永不改變的話語，而不在這常改變世界的不肯定上。神渴望我們在沒其他證據下相信祂的話，那麼祂準備好「按着我們的信心」來作工。

一旦祂的說話說罷，
祂既已說「我總」(來 13:5)，
事必最終得成。
神仍信守祂的承諾。[參林後 1:20]

五旬節時代的祈禱是藉着像兌現一張現金支票般單純的信。

羅拔·安德遜

「神說.....事就這樣成了。」(創 1:9)

三月二十二日

「過了四十年，在西乃山的曠野，有一位天使，從荊棘火焰中，向摩西顯現.....主對他說.....我的百姓在埃及所受的困苦，我實在看見了。他們悲歎的聲音，我也聽見了。我下來要救他們，你來，我要差你往埃及去。」(徒 7:30,33-34)

預備一重大任命的等四十年等待時間很長。神遲疑時並非毫無活動，這時祂預備祂的器皿和使我們力量成熟。時間一到我們必在勝任職責下來興起。甚至拿撒勒的耶穌也有三十年長的隱居，好叫祂在開始工作前智慧增長。

約翰·亨利·佐維

神永不趕忙。祂花上以年計的時間來準備祂計劃大用之人，永不會以為準備的年日是太長或沉悶。

約瑟經歷長長的試煉，神常將他所學到的教訓用持久痛苦之火來烙在我們生命的深處。「祂必坐下如煉淨銀子的。」(瑪 3:3)但祂知道

the specific amount of time that will be needed.

Today we may be unable to see the final outcome of the beautiful plan that God has hidden “in the shadow of his hand” (Isa. 49:2). It may be concealed for a very long time, but our faith may rest in the assurance that God is still seated on His throne. Because of this assurance, we can calmly await the time when, in heavenly delight, we will say, “All things [have] work[ed] together for good” (Rom. 8:28 KJV).

selected

March 23

Some of the plunder taken in battle they dedicated for the repair of the temple of the Lord. (1 Chronicles 26:27)

Someday we will see that “the plunder taken in battle” from our trials was simply preparing us to become like Great-heart in Pilgrim’s Progress, so we too could lead our fellow pilgrims triumphantly through trials to the city of the King. But may we never forget that the source of learning to help others must be the experience of victorious suffering. Whining and complaining about our pain never does anyone any good.

Paul never carried the gloom of a cemetery around with him, but a chorus of victorious praise. The more difficult his trial, the more he trusted and rejoiced, shouting from the very altar of sacrifice. He said, “Even if I am being poured out like a drink offering on the sacrifice and service coming from your faith, I am glad and rejoice with all of you” (Phil. 2:17). Lord, help me today to draw strength from everything that comes to me!

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

March 24

Then Jacob prayed, “O God of my father Abraham, God of my father Isaac, O Lord, who said to me, ‘Go back to your country and your relatives, and I will make you prosper.’ ... Save me, I pray.” (Genesis 32:9, 11)

Jacob began by quoting God’s promise twice and by saying, “Who said to me” and “You have said” (v. 12). See how he has God in his grasp! God places Himself within our reach through His promises, and when we can actually say to Him, “You have said,” He cannot say no. God must do as He has said.

from Practical Portions for the Prayer-Life

所需時間的多少。

今日我們也許看不見「藏在祂手蔭之下」(賽 49:2) 美麗計劃的最終成果，也許會隱藏時間非常長，但我們該安心信靠那仍坐在祂寶座上的神。這確信叫我們能安靜等候那時候的來到，那時我們會用屬天的喜悅來說：「萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處。」(羅 8:28)

選

三月二十三日

「他們將爭戰時所奪的財物分別為聖，以備修造耶和華的殿。」(代上 26:27)

終有一日我們看見從試煉中「爭戰時所奪的財物」不過是預備我們成為像在《天路歷程》中的「無畏」，因此我們也能帶領我們同行的天路客成功地勝過試誘而來到王的城。但讓我們永不要忘記學習幫助他人的源頭定必是得勝苦痛的經歷。為痛楚而哀訴和埋怨永不會對任何人有益。

保羅從沒把墳墓的悲哀隨身，只有得勝讚美的合唱歌。他的試探越艱苦，便越發信靠和歡欣，在祭壇那處歡呼：「我以你們的信心為供獻的祭物。我若被澆奠在其上，也是喜樂，並且與你們眾人一同喜樂。」(腓 2:17) 主啊，今天幫助我從臨我的每件事上領受力量！

摘自《在地若天的日子》

三月二十四日

「雅各說：耶和華我祖亞伯拉罕的神，我父親以撒的神阿，祢曾對我說：回你本地本族去，我要厚待你……求祢救我……」(創 32:9,11)

雅各以「祢曾對我說」和「祢曾說」(創 32:12) 兩次引用神的應許！神將自己放在我們可觸到祂應許的範圍內，當我們真能對祂說「祢曾對我說」時，祂不能說不。神定必會照祂所曾說的來作。

摘自《祈禱生活的實際部分》

Jesus desires that we would be very specific in our requests, asking for something definite. “What do you want me to do for you?” (Matt. 20:32) is the question He asks everyone who comes to Him during trials and affliction.

selected

March 25

Without faith it is impossible to please God, because anyone who comes to him must believe that he exists and that he rewards those who earnestly seek him. (Hebrews 11:6)

Arriving at “their wits’ end” (Ps. 107:27) of desperation was the beginning of God’s power.

Remember the promise made to a couple “as good as dead,” that their descendants would be “as numerous as the stars in the sky and as countless as the sand on the seashore” (Heb. 11:12). Read once again the story of the Red Sea deliverance, and the story of how “the priests who carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord stood firm on dry ground in the middle of the Jordan” (Josh. 3:17). Study once more the prayers of Asa, Jehoshaphat, and Hezekiah when they were severely troubled, not knowing what to do. Go over the history of Nehemiah, Daniel, Hosea, and Habakkuk. Stand with awe in the darkness of Gethsemane, and linger by the tomb in Joseph of Arimathea’s garden through those difficult days. Call to account the witnesses of the early church, and ask the apostles to relate the story of their desperate days.

There is not a more heroic example of desperate faith than the story of the three Hebrew young men Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. Their situation was desperate, but they bravely answered, “If we are thrown into the blazing furnace, the God we serve is able to save us from it, and he will rescue us from your hand, O king. But even if he does not, we want you to know, O king, that we will not serve your gods or worship the image of gold you have set up” (Dan. 3:17-18). I especially like the words “But even if he does not”!

“If it be possible... nevertheless...” (Matt. 26:39 KJV). Our Lord’s soul was overwhelmed by deep darkness. To trust meant experiencing anguish to the point of blood, and darkness to the very depths of hell— Nevertheless! Nevertheless! Find a hymnal and sing your favorite hymn of desperate faith.

S. Chadwick

耶穌渴望我們作出請求時要具體，祈求的東西要明確。當試煉和痛苦來到祂處的人時祂會問他們：「要我為你們作甚麼？」(太20:32)

選

三月二十五日

「人非有信就不能得神的喜悅，因為到神面前來的人，必須信有神，且信祂賞賜那尋求祂的人。」(來 11:6)

來到「他們的智無法可施」(詩 107:27) 的絕境是神能力的開始。

謹記向「彷彿已死的人」的夫婦所作之應許，說他們的後裔將會「如同天上的星那樣眾多，海邊的沙那樣無數」(來 11:12)；再次讀紅海得拯救的故事，和「抬耶和華約櫃的祭司在約但河中的旱地上站定」(書 3:17) 的故事；再次研讀亞撒、約沙法和希西家的祈禱，他們都在極度的困境中，不知如何是好；再次讀尼希米、但以理、何西阿和哈巴谷的歷史；驚懼站在客西馬尼的黑暗中，在那些困難的日子於亞利馬太的約瑟園子中的墳墓徘徊，呼喚早期教會的見證人，叫使徒來述說他們嚴峻日子的故事。

沒有信心嚴峻考驗的英雄事蹟及得上沙得拉、米煞、亞伯尼歌這三個希伯來少年人的故事。他們的處境嚴峻，但他們大膽地回答說：「即便如此，我們所事奉的神能將我們從烈火的窖中救出來。王阿，祂也必救我們脫離你的手。即或不然，王阿，你當知道我們決不事奉你的神，也不敬拜你所立的金像。」(但 3:17-18) 我尤其喜愛「即或不然」這句。

「倘若可行.....只要.....」(太 26:39)。我們的主的生命是被深深黑暗覆蓋，信靠神意味經歷痛苦至流血的地步，經歷地獄深處的黑暗，只要！只要！找一本聖詩集，唱一首你最喜愛絕對信心之歌。

S.赤域

March 26

Lift up your eyes from where you are and look north and south, east and west. All the land that you see I will give to you. (Genesis 13:14-15)

Everything you can comprehend through faith's vision belongs to you. Then draw closer to Him, and with your Bible before you, and your soul completely open to the power of the Spirit, allow your entire being to receive the baptism of His presence. As He opens your understanding, enabling you to see His fullness, believe He has it all for you. Accept for yourself all the promises of His Word, all the desires He awakens within you, and all the possibilities of what you could become as a follower of Jesus. All the land you see is given to you.

selected

They left and found things just as Jesus had told them. Luke 22:13

March 27

I consider that our present sufferings are not worth comparing with the glory that will be revealed in us. (Romans 8:18)

The bridegroom, a very wealthy young man of high social standing, had been blinded by an accident at the age of ten. In spite of his blindness, he had graduated from the university with honors and had now won the heart of his beautiful bride, although he had never looked upon her face. Shortly before his marriage he underwent a new round of treatments by specialists, and the result was ready to be revealed on the day of his wedding.

As she neared the altar, while the soft strains of the wedding march floated through the church, she saw an unusual group. There before her stood the groom, his father, and the doctor. The doctor was in the process of cutting away the last bandage.

Once the bandage was removed, the groom took a step forward, Recovering in an instant his steadiness and demeanor, and with a dignity and joy never before seen on his face, he stepped forward to meet his bride. They looked into each other's eyes, and it seemed as if his gaze would never wander from her face.

"At last!" she said. "At last," he echoed solemnly, bowing his head. It was a scene with great dramatic

三月二十六日

「從你所在的地方，你舉目向東西南北觀看。凡你所看見的一切地，我都要賜給你和你的後裔。」(創 13:14-15)

每一樣你能藉信心的異象領悟的東西都屬你。那麼就近祂去，帶同你的聖經，將你的生命完全向聖靈的能力敞開，容許你整個人接受祂同在的浸洗。當祂開啟你的領悟，能夠看見祂的豐盛時，相信祂全都給你。作為跟隨耶穌的人，接受所有祂聖經中的應許，所有祂在你裏頭喚醒的渴望，和所有你能變成為的一切可能。你所看見的一切地土都是賜給你的。

選

「他們去了，所遇見的，正如耶穌所說的。」(路 22:13)

三月二十七日

「我想現在的苦楚，若比起將來要顯於我們的榮耀，就不足介意了。」(羅 8:18)

有社會高地位和富有年輕的新郎在十歲時因意外而瞎眼。雖然瞎眼，但他已大學畢業，取得榮譽學位，如今贏得美麗新娘的芳心，然而他未曾見過她的面容。在婚禮前不久他進行新一輪的專家診治，而結果已準備好就在他結婚當日發表。

當她走近壇前時，結婚進行曲的悠揚歌曲在教堂內迴盪，她看見一群不尋常的人。在她前面站着的是新郎、他的父親和醫生。那醫生在進行剪開最後一片綳帶的步驟。

當綳帶一移除，新郎踏步向前。瞬間的復原使他臉上現出從未有過帶着端莊和喜樂的鎮定和淡定，他步前來見他的新娘。他們四目交投，就像他的注目永不會離開她的面龐一樣。

她說：「終於！」他低頭莊嚴地應聲說：「終於！」這場面那麼

power, as well as one of great joy. Yet as beautiful as this story is, it is but a mere suggestion of what will actually take place in heaven when Christians, who have been walking through this world of trial and sorrow, “shall see [HIM] face to face” (1 Cor. 13:12).

selected

March 28

As soon as the priests who carry the ark of the Lord—the Lord of all the earth—set foot in the Jordan, its waters flowing downstream will be cut off and stand up in a heap. (Joshua 3:13)

Oh, for the kind of faith that will move ahead, leaving God to fulfill His promise when He sees fit! Fellow Levites, let us shoulder our load, without looking as though we were carrying God’s coffin. It is the ark of the living God! Sing as you march toward the flood!

Thomas Champness

One of the distinguishing marks of the Holy Spirit in the New Testament church was the spirit of boldness. One of the great essential qualities of the kind of faith that will attempt great things for God and expect great things from God is holy boldness and daring. When dealing with a supernatural Being and taking things from Him that are humanly impossible, it is actually easier for us to take a lot than it is to take a little. And it is easier to stand in a place of bold trust than in a place where we cautiously and timidly cling to the shore.

Like wise sailors living a life of faith, let us launch our ships into the deep. We will find that all things are “possible with God” (Luke 18:27), and “everything is possible for him who believes” (Mark 9:23).

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

March 29

See how the lilies of the field grow. (Matthew 6:28)

Many years ago there was a monk who needed olive oil, so he planted an olive tree sapling. After he finished planting it, he prayed, “Lord, my tree needs rain so its tender roots may drink and grow. Send gentle showers.” And the Lord sent gentle showers. Then the monk prayed, “Lord, my tree needs sun. Please send it sun.” And the sun shone, gilding the once-dripping clouds. “Now send frost, dear Lord, to strengthen its branches,” cried the monk. And soon the

大大激動人心和極大喜樂。這故事的美麗，叫我們聯想到真會發生在天上的事情，就是曾在這試探和憂傷的世上行走的基督徒，「到那時，就要面對面了。」(林前13:12)

選

三月二十八日

「等到抬普天下主耶和華約櫃的祭司把腳站在約但河水裏，約但河的水，就是從上往下流的水，必然斷絕，立起成壘。」(書 3:13)

向前行的信心讓神在合適時成就祂的應許！利未人同伴啊，讓我們肩擔起擔子，不要看我們像抬神的棺木一樣。它是永生神的約櫃！你們操往大水時一起高唱吧！

多馬·杉尼士

新約教會中聖靈其中一個可識別的標誌就是祂是勇敢的靈。其中一類有偉大顯著質素的信心就是會為神來嘗試作大事和期待從神來的大事的神聖大膽和果敢的信心。人類與超自然的一位有交往和從祂得着事物是不可能的，事實上對於我們來說多取比起少取更容易。站在果敢信靠之地比起謹慎和畏縮地在貼岸之地更容易。

讓我們像過信心生活的聰明水手把船開往水深之處，必發現所有事物「在神卻能」(路18:27)，和「在信的人，凡事都能。」(可9:23)

摘自《在地若天的日子》

三月二十九日

「你想野地裏的百合花，怎麼長起來，」(太 6:28)

多年前有一修士需要橄欖油，因此他種植橄欖樹苗。當他種植完畢便祈禱說：「主啊，我的樹需飲用雨水來使它柔弱的根生長，送來微雨吧。主便送來微雨。之後修士祈禱說：「主啊，它需要太陽，請送來太陽。」太陽便照耀，把從前的雨雲鑲上金邊。修士呼求：「恩主，如今送來霜雪增強它的枝梗吧

little tree was covered in sparkling frost, but by evening it had died.

Then the monk sought out a brother monk in his cell and told him of his strange experience. After hearing the story, the other monk said, "I also have planted a little tree. See how it is thriving! But I entrust my tree to its God. He who made it knows better than a man like me what it needs. I gave God no constraints or conditions, except to pray, 'Lord, send what it needs—whether that be a storm or sunshine, wind, rain, or frost. You made it, and You know best what it needs.'"

March 30

But now, all you who light fires and provide yourselves with flaming torches, go, walk in the light of your fires and of the torches you have set ablaze. This is what you shall receive from my hand: You will lie down in torment. (Isaiah 50:11)

A fire that is surrounding itself with sparks means that when we are in darkness, the temptation is to find our own way without trusting in the Lord and relying upon Him.

Remember, it is better to walk in the dark with God than to walk alone in the light.

from The Still Small Voice

"Not what I will, but what you will" (Mark 14:36).

Stephen Merritt

March 31

The wind was against it. (Mathew 14:24)

The storms of sorrow through bereavement are intense, but they are one of the Father's ways of driving me to Himself. His purpose is to softly and tenderly speak to my heart in the secret, hidden place of His presence. There is a certain glory of the Master that can only be seen when the wind is contrary and my ship is being tossed by the waves.

Jesus Christ is not my security against the storms of life, but He is my perfect security in the storms. He has never promised me an easy passage, only a safe landing.

April 1

Though he slay me, yet will I hope in him. (Job

。) 不久這小樹蓋滿閃亮的霜雪，卻在黃昏死去。

之後修士在小修道院中找着一個弟兄，告訴他這奇怪經歷。聽罷故事，第二個修士說：「我也曾種植過一棵小樹，看它如今如何茂盛！不同的是我把它交託神，祂比我這人更認識它的需要。我沒有給神約束或條件，惟有祈禱說：「主，送來它所需的，無論是暴風、陽光、風、雨、或霜雪。造它的祢最知道它的需要。」

三月三十日

「凡你們點火用火把圍繞自己的，可以行在你們的火焰裏，並你們所點的火把中，這是我手所定的。你們必躺在悲慘之中。」(賽50:11)

有火星圍繞的火焰說到當他們在黑暗中時，有試探來到叫他們不依靠神卻倚賴自己來找自己的出路。

謹記，在黑暗中與神同行是好在光明中的獨行。

摘自《那溫柔的微聲》

「不要從我的意思，只要從祢的意思。」(可14:36)

史提芬·馬力

三月三十一日

「因風不順，被浪搖撼。」(太14:24)

喪親之痛的憂傷風暴是強烈的，但他們是天父其中一種方法來驅策我們更走向祂。祂的目的就是在我心中——神同在的秘密隱蔽處——輕聲柔和地訴說。船在逆風中被浪濤顛簸時才能得見主確有的榮耀。

耶穌基督不叫我們免於風暴，祂乃作我們風暴中的完美保障。祂從沒應許容易的路，只應許平安到埗。

四月一日

「祂必殺我。我雖無指望，然而

13:15)

Because I know whom I have believed. (2 Timothy 1:12)

An old seaman once said, "In fierce storms we must do one thing, for there is only one way to survive: we must put the ship in a certain position and keep her there."

Sometimes, like Paul, you cannot see the sun or the stars to help you navigate when the storm is bearing down on you. This is when you can do only one thing, for there is only one way. Reason cannot help you, past experiences will shed no light, and even prayer will bring no consolation. Only one course remains: you must put your soul in one position and keep it there.

You must anchor yourself steadfastly upon the Lord. And then, come what may—whether wind, waves, rough seas, thunder, lightning, jagged rocks, or roaring breakers—you must lash yourself to the helm, firmly holding your confidence in God's faithfulness, His covenant promises, and His everlasting love in Christ Jesus.

Richard Fuller

April 2

They looked ... and there was the glory of the Lord appearing in the cloud. (Exodus 16:10)

One day in autumn, while on the open prairie, I saw an eagle mortally wounded by a rifle shot. With his eyes still gleaming like small circles of light, he slowly turned his head, giving one last searching and longing look toward the sky. He had often swept those starry spaces with his wonderful wings. The beautiful sky was the home of his heart. It was the eagle's domain. It was there he had displayed his splendid strength a thousand times. In those lofty heights, he had played with the lightning and raced the wind. And now, far below his home, the eagle lay dying. He faced death because—just once—he forgot and flew too low.

My soul is that eagle. This is not its home. It must never lose its skyward look. I must keep faith, I must keep hope, I must keep courage, I must keep Christ. It would be better to crawl immediately from the battlefield than to not be brave. There is no time for my soul to retreat. Keep your skyward look, my soul; keep your skyward look!

April 3

我.....。」(伯 13:15)

「因為知道我所信的是誰。」(提後 1:12)

一個年老海員說：「在暴風中有一事我們必要作，就是那唯一叫我們得存活的方法：我們定須把船開到某位置和停留在那兒。」

有時你會像保羅般在暴風雨向你逼來時，看不見助你導航的太陽或星星。這時你能作的只有一件事，因為只得一條路可走。理性不能給你幫助，過往的經驗不能奏效，甚至祈禱也不能帶來慰藉時，剩下的路只有一條：定須將你的生命放在一個位置和留在那兒。

你定須把你自己牢牢拋錨在主那裏，之後無論甚麼要來到，也許是風、浪、怒濤、行雷、閃電、巉岩或是咆哮的碎浪，你定必要把自己綁於舵輪，緊緊信靠神的信實、祂約上的應許和祂在基督耶穌裏永遠的愛。

李察·富拿

四月二日

「他們向曠野觀看，不料，耶和華的榮光在雲中顯現。」(出 16:10)

在秋天的某一日，正在廣闊的大草原上我看見一隻受致命槍傷的鷹。兩眼仍閃亮像小光圈的牠慢慢地轉過頭來，作其最後向天銳利和熱切的一望。牠曾常振翅穿越星空天際，美麗天空是牠心中的家，是那鷹的版圖，那裏是牠曾千次展示牠顯赫力量之所，牠在那巍峨的高處曾以閃電為玩物和與風兒競賽。但如今那鷹在牠家下面極低之處臥着等死。牠之所以面對死亡是因牠只一次的善忘而飛得太低之故。

我就是那隻鷹，這不是牠的家，牠永不可失掉牠向天的仰望。我定必要持守信心，持守盼望，持守勇氣，持守基督。從戰場上立即爬走總好過不勇敢。我的生命不容有後退的時間。生命啊，持守你仰天之望；持守你仰天之望！

四月三日

Glorify ye the Lord in the fires. (Isaiah 24:15 KJV)

It is precisely there, in the heat of the fire, we are to glorify Him. We do this by exercising perfect faith in His goodness and love that has permitted this trial to come upon us. Even more, we are to believe that out of the fire will arise something more worthy of praise to Him than had we never experienced it.

To go through some fires will take great faith, for little faith will fail. We must win the victory in the furnace.

Margaret Bottome

The three men who were thrown into the fiery furnace came out just as they went in—except for the ropes that had bound them. How often God removes our shackles in the furnace of affliction!

These three men walked through the fire unhurt—their skin was not even blistered. Not only had the fire “not harmed their bodies, nor was a hair of their heads singed; their robes were not scorched, and there was no smell of fire on them” (Dan. 3:27). This is the way Christians should come out of the furnace of fiery trials—liberated from their shackles but untouched by the flames. Triumphant over them in it. Colossians 2:15 KJV

Margaret Bottome

Isn't there something captivating about the sight of a person burdened with many trials, yet who is as lighthearted as the sound of a bell? Isn't there something contagious and valiant in seeing others who are greatly tempted but are “more than conquerors” (Rom. 8:37)? Isn't it heartening to see a fellow traveler whose body is broken, yet who retains the splendor of unbroken patience?

John Henry Jowett

April 4

Elisha prayed, “O Lord, open his eyes so he may see.” (2 Kings 6:17)

Once our eyes are opened by God, we will see all the events of our lives, whether great or small, joyful or sad, as a “chariot” for our souls. Everything that comes to us becomes a chariot the moment we treat it as such. On the other hand, even the smallest trial may become an object crushing everything in its path into

「在火中榮耀耶和華的名。」(賽24:15 英皇欽定本)

我們正正在火的熱力那裏榮耀神。我們能這樣作是藉着運用對以善良和慈愛來容許這試煉臨到我們之神的信心。尤有進者，我們相信從未經歷過火煉不會比從火中出來所冒起更值得讚美神。

要用大信心才能經過火煉，因為小信心只會誤事。我們在火窖中定必得勝。

瑪嘉烈·博滕美

那三個被拋進火窖的人，除了所捆綁的繩子外，出來時與進去時無異。神多時在火窖的苦難中移除我們的桎梏！

這三個人在火中行走，沒有受傷，他們的皮膚甚至沒有灼傷。那火不單止「無力傷他們的身體，頭髮也沒有燒焦，衣裳也沒有變色，並沒有火燎的氣味。」(但3:27)基督徒應這樣從火焰試煉的火窖中出來，從桎梏中得釋，火卻燒不到他們。「在其中誇勝。」(西2:15英皇欽定本)

瑪嘉烈·博滕美

當我們得見有人背負很多試煉的重擔卻仍然像鐘聲般心情愉快時，不是總吸引住我們麼？當有人抵受着重大的試探卻能「得勝有餘」(羅8:37)時，不也見到其感染力和英勇麼？見到一旅者身心疲憊，卻仍維持着那未渙散忍耐之光輝的不是叫人振奮麼？

約翰·亨利·祖屈

四月四日

「以利沙禱告說：耶和華阿，求祢開這少年人的眼目，使他能看見。」(王下 6:17)

我們的眼目一旦為神所開，必得見生命大小和悲喜的事乃我們生命的火車。臨到我們的每樣東西在我們以它為火車一刻便成為火車。另一方面，我們若容許那怕最細小的試煉也可成為路徑上把每事物壓

misery and despair if we allow it.

The difference then becomes a choice we make. It all depends not on the events themselves but on how we view them. If we simply lie down, allowing them to roll over and crush us, they become an uncontrollable car of destruction. Yet if we climb into them, as riding in a car of victory, they become the chariots of God to triumphantly take us onward and upward.

Hannah Whitall Smith

We need to better understand these attacks of the Enemy on our spirit and how to resist them. If he can dislodge us from our proper position, he then seeks to “wear out the saints of the most High” (Dan. 7:25 KJV) through a prolonged siege, until we finally, out of sheer weakness, surrender all hope of victory.

April 5

Go inside and shut the door behind you and your sons. (2 Kings 4:4)

The widow and her two sons were to be alone with God. They were not dealing with the laws of nature, human government, the church, or the priesthood. Nor were they even dealing with God’s great prophet, Elisha.

This is an ingredient in God’s plan of dealing with us. We are to enter a secret chamber of isolation in prayer and faith that is very fruitful. At certain times and places, God will build a mysterious wall around us. He will take away all the supports we customarily lean upon, and will remove our ordinary ways of doing things. God will close us off to something divine, completely new and unexpected, and that cannot be understood by examining our previous circumstances. We will be in a place where we do not know what is happening, where God is cutting the cloth of our lives by a new pattern, and thus where He causes us to look to Him.

from Soul Food

April 6

I will stand at my watch and station myself on the ramparts; I will look to see what he will say to me. (Habakkuk 2:1)

There is an old saying: “They who watch for the providence of God will never lack the providence of God to watch for.” And we could turn the saying around as well and say, “They who never watch for the

碎成為痛苦和絕望的東西。

那麼我們的選擇有着差別。取決的全不在事件本身，而是我們如何看他們。我們若臥下，容許他們碾壓我們，這便成為不可控制的車毀人亡。但我們若爬在他們身上，如同坐上勝利之車，他們成為神的火車，帶我們勝利地往前往上。

漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

我們需更認識敵人對我們靈的攻擊和如何作出抵擋。若他在合適的地方攻擊我們時，他就是尋求「折磨至高者的聖民」(但7:25)，是藉着不斷的圍攻，直至我們最後全然疲累，放棄所有爭勝的希望。

四月五日

「回到家裏，關上門，你和你兒子在裏面……」(王下 4:4)

那個寡婦和她兩個兒子孤獨地與神在一起。他們不是要與自然律、人類政權、教會或祭司交往，甚至他們也不是與神偉大的先知以利沙交往。

這是神處理我們之計劃的要素。我們藉祈禱和果實纍纍的信心來到一隔離的密室，在某時某地神必會建立一道神奇的牆圍繞我們。祂會取走所有我們素來倚凭的支持，除去我們平常行事的方法。神會關上我們的門，只開通能接觸到神聖的、純新並想不到的、和以檢驗我們先前處境的方法都不能明白的東西。我們來到一處是我們不知何事在發生中，那處神把我們生命的布料裁剪成新的款式，因此祂使我們在那裏來仰望祂。

摘自《靈魂的食物》

四月六日

「我要站在守望所，立在望樓上觀看，看耶和華對我說甚麼話。」(哈 2:1)

古語云：「那些等候神供應的人永不會缺乏所等候的神之供應。」我們也能改動這說法：「那些不等候神供應的人永不能得着要等候的

providence of God will never have the providence of God to watch for.”

We need to be more businesslike and use common sense with God in claiming His promises.

Unfortunately, a great many people also play at praying. Our heavenly Father desires us to transact real business with Him in our praying.

Charles H. Spurgeon

Your hope will not be cut off. Proverbs 23:18

April 7

Their strength is to sit still. (Isaiah 30:7 KJV)

Inner stillness is an absolute necessity to truly knowing God. I remember learning this during a time of great crisis in my life. It seemed as if I would fall to pieces due to my inner turmoil. Then suddenly “a still small voice” (1 Kings 19:12 KJV) whispered in the depths of my soul, “Be still, and know that I am God” (Ps. 46:10). The words were spoken with power and I obeyed. I composed myself, bringing my body to complete stillness, and forced my troubled spirit into quietness. Only then, while looking up and waiting, did I know that it was God who had spoken. He was in the midst of my crisis and my helplessness, and I rested in Him.

Hannah Whitall Smith

April 8

That is why, for Christ’s sake, I delight in weaknesses, in insults, in hardships, in persecutions, in difficulties. For when I am weak, then I am strong. (2 Corinthians 12:10)

The literal translation of this verse is as follows: “Therefore I take pleasure in being without strength, being insulted, experiencing emergencies, and being chased and forced into a corner for Christ’s sake; for when I am without strength, I am dynamite.”

The secret of knowing God’s complete sufficiency is in coming to the end of everything in ourselves and our circumstances.

A. B. Simpson

George Matheson, the well-known blind preacher of Scotland, once said, “My dear God, I have never thanked You for my thorns. I have thanked you a

神之供應。」

在向神索求祂的應許時我們需要更有條不紊和運用常理。

不幸地，有很多人在祈禱時抱着玩耍的心態，我們的天父渴望我們在祈禱中處理真正的事務。

司布真

「你的指望也不至斷絕。」(箴 23:18)

四月七日

「他們的力量就是坐而不動。」(賽 30:7 英皇欽定本)

在真正認識神上絕對需要內裏的寧靜。我還記得在我人生的重大危機之時，我似乎因我內裏的騷動而裂成碎片。那時忽然有一「微小的聲音」(王上19:12)在我靈魂的深處來低訴：「要休息，要知道我是神。」(詩46:10)我因這些說話說得那麼有力而遵從。我叫自己鎮定，叫身體完全靜止下來，強逼我煩躁的靈歸於平靜。

漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

四月八日

「我為基督的緣故，就以軟弱、凌辱、急難、逼迫、困苦為可喜樂的。因我甚麼時候軟弱，甚麼時候就剛強了。」(林後 12:10)

這節經文是這樣說的：「因此我以為基督的緣故而失去能力、被凌辱、經歷危險、被追殺和困逼死胡同為可喜樂的；因為我失去能力時，我成為炸藥。」

認識神完美供應的秘訣到頭來叫我們自己和我們的環境上凡事得供應。

宣信

著明的蘇格蘭瞎眼傳道者喬治·馬得勝曾說：「我親愛的神啊，我從未為着荊棘感謝祢。我曾為玫

thousand times for my roses but not once for my thorns. I have always looked forward to the place where I will be rewarded for my cross, but I have never thought of my cross as a present glory itself.

April 9

Everything is against me! (Genesis 42:36)

All things God works for the good of those who love him. (Romans 8:28)

“How is the power produced?” “It simply is generated by the turning of those wheels and the friction they create. The rubbing produces the electric current.”

In a similar way, when God desires to create more power in your life, He creates more friction. He uses this pressure to generate spiritual power. Some people cannot handle it, and run from the pressure instead of receiving the power and using it to rise above the painful experience that produced it.

Let us thank Him for both the weights and the wings He produces. And realizing we are divinely propelled, let us press on with faith and patience in our high and heavenly calling.

A. B. Simpson

April 10

Tell me what charges you have against me. (Job 10:2)

Do you not know that your faith never appears as great in the warm summer weather as it does during a cold winter? Your love is all too often like a firefly, showing very little light except when surrounded by darkness. And hope is like the stars—unseen in the sunshine of prosperity and only discovered during a night of adversity. Afflictions are often the dark settings God uses to mount the jewels of His children's gifts, causing them to shine even brighter.

You can depend upon the fact that God often sends trials so our gifts may be discovered and so we may be certain of their existence. And there is more than just discovering our gifts—we experience real growth in grace as another result of our trials being sanctified by Him.

God trains His soldiers not in tents of ease and luxury but by causing them to endure lengthy marches and difficult service. He makes them wade across streams, swim through rivers, climb mountains, and

瑰感謝祢一千次，卻沒有一次為荊棘。我總期待因我的十字架而得賞賜的地方，卻從未曾想到我的十字架本身就是我現今的榮耀。」

四月九日

「這些事都歸到我身上了。」(創 42:36)

「我們曉得萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處。」(羅 8:28)

「能力是如何產生的呢？」「只要轉動這些輪軸，能力便從他們所製造的阻力而產生的。」

同樣地，當神想在你的生命上製造更多能力時，祂便會先造出更多的阻力。祂用這壓力來產生屬靈的能量。有人不能掌握這個，便逃避壓力，卻不去利用這痛苦經歷所產生的能力來凌駕在痛苦之上。

讓我們感謝祂同時給我們重物和雙翼。既明白到我們負有神聖的驅動使命，就讓我們用信前進，在我們上面和屬天的呼召上堅忍。

宣信

四月十日

「要指示我，祢為何與我爭辯？」(伯 10:2)

你豈不知你在暖暖夏日中的信永不能像在寒冷冬天般那麼大麼？你的愛太常像螢火蟲，若非在黑暗環境中就都只是微弱的光。你的盼望像星星，在順境的陽光中看不見，惟有在逆境的晚上才被發現。苦惱常是神用來為祂的孩子的恩賜上鑲嵌珠寶的黑暗裝置，使他們的恩賜能以發出更燦爛的光輝。

你可藉神常差來的試煉叫我們的恩賜得以展現這事實來叫我們確定這些恩賜是存在的。這不單是恩賜的展現，我們且得以經驗恩典中真正成長的另一個結果，就是說因着試煉我們靠神得以成聖。

神鍛鍊祂士兵不在舒適豪華的帳篷裏，而是使他們忍受長期的步操和艱苦的兵役。祂使他們負着背包跋涉溪澗，游過河流，攀山，走

walk many tiring miles with heavy backpacks.

Charles H. Spurgeon

Being left alone by Satan is not evidence of being blessed.

April 11

What I tell you in the dark, speak in the daylight; what is whispered in your ear, proclaim from the roofs. (Matthew 10:27)

It is there He tells us His secrets—great and wonderful, eternal and infinite. He causes our eyes, blinded by the glare of things on earth, to behold the heavenly constellations. And our ears suddenly detect even the whisper of His voice, which has been so often drowned out by the turmoil of earth's loud cries.

We are not to linger in the darkness or stay in the closet. Soon we will be summoned to take our position in the turmoil and the storms of life. And when that moment comes, we are to speak and proclaim what we have learned.

This gives new meaning to suffering, the saddest part of which is often the apparent feeling of uselessness it causes. Why is the 'expensive perfume'(John 12:3) of my soul being wasted?" These are the desperate cries of the sufferer, but God has a purpose in all of it. He takes His children to higher levels of fellowship so they may hear Him speaking "face to face, as a man speaks with his friend" (Ex. 33:11), and then deliver the message to those at the foot of the mountain. Were the forty days Moses spent on the mountain wasted? What about the time Elijah spent at Mount Horeb or the years Paul spent in Arabia?

There is no shortcut to a life of faith, which is an absolute necessity for a holy and victorious life. We must have periods of lonely meditation and fellowship with God. Our souls must have times of fellowship with Him on the mountain and experience valleys of quiet rest in the shadow of a great rock.

F. B. Meyer

April 12

Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit in the desert, where for forty days he was tempted by the devil. (Luke 4:1-2)

Jesus was filled with the Holy Spirit and yet was tempted. The strongest force of temptation often

過很多不知幾多哩疲憊的路程。

司布真

被撒但撇在一旁不理不證明你正蒙福。

四月十一日

「我在暗中告訴你們的，你們要在明處說出來；你們耳中所聽的，要在房上宣揚出來。」(太 10:27)

神在黑暗中告訴你的秘密大而且奇、永恆和無限。祂使我們被地上事物的光華所弄眩的眼睛上望天際星座，我們的耳突然得察覺甚至祂聲音的細語，就是那一向常常被地上大呼喧嚷所淹沒之聲。

我們不是要逗留在黑暗中或在密室裏，不久我們必要被召喚來到人生中喧嚷和暴風中的位置，那時我們就要將我們所學會的說出來和宣傳出來。

那最叫人憂傷的部分常是那似乎無用的感覺，叫所忍受的苦難加上新意義。為何我生命中那『極貴的真哪噠香膏』(約12:3)被糟蹋？」這些是受苦者悲觀失望之呼喊，但神在這一切上有祂的旨意，祂領祂的孩子進入更高層次的相交，叫他們聽到祂「面對面說話，好像人與朋友說話一般」(出33:11)，好叫之後傳遞這信息給山腳的人。摩西在山上的四十日、以利亞在何烈山上所花的時日和保羅在阿拉伯的年日是否白費？

信心的生命沒有捷徑，神聖和勝利的生活絕對需要。我們必須有單獨默想和與神相交的時刻，我們的靈魂必須有與祂在山上相交和在谷中大石蔭下安靜憩息的經歷。

邁爾

四月十二日

「耶穌被聖靈充滿，從約但河回來，聖靈將他引到曠野，四十天受魔鬼的試探。」(路 4:1-2)

耶穌被聖靈充滿，但仍受試探。最強力的試探往往在人最親近神

comes upon a person when he is closest to God.

Why is it that very few people have had as great a conflict with the Devil as Martin Luther had? It is because Martin Luther was shaking the very kingdom of hell itself. And remember the tremendous struggles John Bunyan had!

When a person has the fullness of the Spirit of God, he will experience great conflicts with the Tempter. God allows temptation because it does for us what storms do for oak trees, rooting us deeper, and it does for us what heat does for paint on porcelain, giving us long-lasting endurance.

You will never fully realize the level of strength of your grasp on Christ, or His grasp on you, until the Devil uses all his force to attract you to himself. It is then you will feel the tug of Christ's right hand.

selected

April 13

The hand of the Lord was upon me there, and he said to me, "Get up and go out to the plain, and there I will speak to you." (Ezekiel 3:22)

From the apostle Paul's being sent into the Arabian wilderness for three years—during which time he must have been overflowing with the Good News—down to the present day, it seems those who will be used will have a time of waiting.

Once when I thought the door was being thrown open for me to enter the literary field with a great opportunity, it was just as quickly shut. My doctor stepped in and simply said, "Never! You must choose between writing and living, for you cannot do both." The year was 1860, and I did not come out of my shell of isolation with my book Ministry of Song until 1869. By then I saw the distinct wisdom of having been kept waiting for nine years in the shade.

God provides resting places as well as working places. So rest and be thankful when He brings you, tired and weary, to streams along the way.

April 14

The Lord himself will come down from heaven, with a loud command, with the voice of the archangel and with the trumpet call of God, and the dead in Christ will rise first. After that, we who are still alive and are left will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. And so we will be with the Lord forever. (1 Thessalonians 4:16-17)

的時候來到。

為何如此少人曾經歷像馬丁·路德所經歷與魔鬼的衝突呢？這是因為馬丁·路德所搖動的是地獄國度本身。謹記約翰·本仁所有的驚人掙扎！

當人被神的靈充滿時，便經歷與那試誘者的大衝突。神容許試探來到，因它給我們的就像風暴給與橡樹的，使我們生根更深，試探為我們作的就如像熱力為瓷器上的漆油所作的，給我們持久的忍耐。

你永不能完全明白緊握基督或祂緊握你的是甚麼力量級別，除非魔鬼用盡氣力把你吸引歸他，那時你才能感受到基督右手的力度。

選

四月十三日

「耶和華的手在那裏降在我身上。祂對我說：你起來往平原去，我要在那裏和你說話。」(結 3:22)

從使徒保羅被差往阿拉伯曠野三年一事上我們得知，其間他定必溢滿那好消息，一直湧流至今日，看來那些被神使用的人必定要有等待的時刻。

有一次我想進入寫作圈子，巨大機會之門為我大開時，卻同時關得很快。我的醫生步前直接了當說：「寫作或生存二擇其一，你永不能兩者兼得。」那時是1860年，不到1869年，我也不能在孤獨的沉默甲殼中出來寫我那本《歌聲的職事》一書。那時我才見到我在陰暗中等待的這九年的獨特智慧。

神給安息之所，也給工作之所。當祂把你從疲倦和困乏中領到途邊溪水時，感恩來安息吧，

四月十四日

「因為主必親自從天降臨，有呼叫的聲音，和天使長的聲音，又有神的號吹響。那在基督裏死了的人必先復活。以後我們這活着還存留的人，必和他們一同被提到雲裏，在空中與主相遇。這樣，我們就要和主永遠同在。」(帖前 4:16-17)

It was “very early in the morning” (Luke 24:1), “while it was still dark” (John 20:1), that Jesus rose from the dead. His rising did not break the slumbering of the city.

“You who dwell in the dust, wake up and shout for joy” (Isa. 26:19).

Oh, how great the contrast between these blessings and the dark night through which they have just passed! They will shake off the dirt of earth that once held them, flinging mortality aside, and will rise with glorified bodies “to meet the Lord in the air.” The light of “the bright Morning Star” (Rev. 22:16) will guide them upward along a brand-new path. The beams of that Star of the Morning will, like the star of Bethlehem, direct them to the presence of the King. “Weeping may remain for a night, but rejoicing comes in the morning” (Ps. 30:5).

Horatius Bonar

“I am coming soon. Amen. Come, Lord Jesus”.
Revelation 22:20

A soldier once said, “When I die, do not play taps over my grave. Instead, play reveille, the morning call, the summons to arise.”

April 15

I trust in your word. (Psalm 119:42)

God delights in causing us to exercise our faith. He does so to bless us individually, to bless the church at large, and as a witness to unbelievers. Yet we tend to retreat from the exercising of our faith instead of welcoming it. When trials come, our response should be, “My heavenly Father has placed this cup of trials into my hands so I may later have something pleasant.”

Trials are the food of faith. Oh, may we leave ourselves in the hands of our heavenly Father! It is the joy of His heart to do good to all His children. Yet trials and difficulties are not the only way faith is exercised and thereby increased. Reading the Scriptures also acquaints us with God as He has revealed Himself in them.

George Mueller

April 16

By faith Abraham, when called to go to a place he would later receive as his inheritance, obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was

耶穌從死裏復活時在「黎明的時候」(路24:1)，「天還黑的時候」(約20:1)，沒有破壞城市的熟睡。

「睡在塵埃的阿，要醒起歌唱。」(賽26:19)

噢，這些恩福和他們剛從其中出來的黑夜形成何等大的對比！他們必會抖脫曾埋藏他們的泥塵，把死亡摔在一旁，以榮耀的身體來復活，「在空中與主相遇」。「明亮的晨星」(啟22:16)的光彩會引導他們往上走那純新的路徑；晨星的光輝必會像伯利恆的星一樣指引他們去到王的所在。「一宿雖然有哭泣，早晨便必歡呼。」(詩30:5)

可拉蒂斯·邦拿

「我必快來。阿們。主耶穌阿，我願祢來。」(啟22:20)

有士兵說：「我死時，在我的墳前不要吹吃飯號，反要吹奏起床號，那早晨的召喚，起來的召喚。」

四月十五日

「我倚靠祢的話。」(詩 119:42)

神樂於叫我們運用信，為的是祝福個別的人，祝福全體教會，也作為未信者的見證。然而我們都傾向於在運用信心上退縮而不是欣然運用。當試煉來臨時，我們的反應該是：「我的天父已把這試煉的杯放在我手中，因此我稍後可因而得着一些叫我歡快的東西了。」

試煉是信心的食物。噢，讓我們把自己放在我們天父的手中！神為祂所有孩子得福來作祂心中所樂意的。然而試煉和困難不是叫人運用和增加信心的唯一方法，讀經也能使我們熟識神，因為祂曾在聖經中彰顯祂自己。

慕勒

四月十六日

「亞伯拉罕因着信，蒙召的時候，就遵命出去，往將來要得為業的地方去。出去的時候，還不知往哪裏

going. (Hebrews 11:8)

O glorious faith! Your works and possibilities are these: contentment to set sail with the orders still sealed, due to unwavering confidence in the wisdom of the Lord High Admiral; and a willingness to get up, leave everything, and follow Christ, because of the joyful assurance that earth's best does not compare with heaven's least.

F. B. Meyer

Your Guide will not keep to any beaten path. He will lead you through ways you would never have dreamed your eyes would see. He knows no fear, and He expects you to fear nothing while He is with you.

April 17

The hand of the Lord has done this. (Job 12:9)

A number of years ago the most magnificent diamond in the history of the world was found in an African mine. It was then presented to the king of England to embellish his crown of state. The king sent it to Amsterdam to be cut by an expert stonecutter. He took this gem of priceless value and cut a notch in it. Then he struck it one hard time with his hammer, and the majestic jewel fell into his hand, broken in two. When he struck that blow, he did the one thing that would bring that gem to its most perfect shape, radiance, and jeweled splendor. The blow that seemed to be the ruin of the majestic precious stone was actually its perfect redemption, for from the halves were fashioned two magnificent gems.

Sometimes, in the same way, God lets a stinging blow fall on your life. You bleed, feeling the pain, and your soul cries out in agony. At first you think the blow is an appalling mistake. But it is not, for you are the most precious jewel in the world to God. And He is the most skilled stonecutter in the universe.

J. H. M.

April 18

He will do this. (Psalm 37:5)

God showed me that self-effort always hinders His work. He also revealed that when I prayed and had confident trust in Him for something, He simply wanted me to wait in an attitude of praise and do only what He told me. Sitting still, doing nothing except trusting in the Lord, causes a feeling of uncertainty, and there is often a tremendous temptation to take the battle into

去。」(來 11:8)

光榮的信啊！你的工作和可能就是這些：在命令仍然密封下便安心於啟航，因着對主那最高艦隊司令之智慧的信任毫無動搖；和樂於撇下一切來動身跟隨基督，因着歡欣地確信世上的最好也不足與天上最小的來比較。

邁爾

你的引導者不走平路，祂會領你走你從未想過，眼睛從未見過的路。祂不知恐懼為何物，祂也期待你在祂同在時無所懼怕。

四月十七日

「耶和華的手做成。」(伯 12:9)

多年前在非洲的礦坑中找到一顆世上最大顆的鑽石，它被獻給英皇來潤色他寶座的皇冠。英皇把它送到阿姆斯特丹的一個寶石切割專家。他在這無價之寶石上劃上一道缺口，之後他用鎚子重力一擊，這皇家的寶石跌在他手中，分為兩件。當他施以一擊時，所作的給那寶石帶來最完美的形態，光芒和珠寶的輝煌。那記似乎摧毀那尊貴寶石的一擊事實上是它完全的解救，把這兩半塑造成絕頂的寶石。

同樣神有時容讓刺痛的一擊落在你的生命中。你流血、感到痛楚和靈魂在痛苦中呻吟。開初你以為那一擊極之錯誤。其實不然，因於神你是世上最貴重的珠寶，神亦是宇宙中最純熟的寶石切割師。

J.H.M.

四月十八日

「祂就必成全。」(詩 37:5)

神叫我看見一己之力常是阻礙祂的工作。祂也啟示說當我作了祈禱，堅定相信祂會作事時，祂只想我用讚美的態度來等待，和只作祂叫我作的事。不動地坐着，除了信靠神之外甚麼都不作，不至產生不肯定的感覺，因為總常有用我們自

our own hands.

C. H. P.

Spiritual forces cannot work while we are trusting earthly forces.

Often we fail to give God an opportunity to work, not realizing that it takes time for Him to answer prayer.

J. H. M.

April 19

Stand firm and you will see the deliverance the Lord will bring you today. (Exodus 14:13)

The Lord's divine decree has commanded me to go from "strength to strength" (Ps. 84:7). Therefore I will, and neither death nor hell will turn me from my course. And if for a season He calls me to "stand firm," I will acknowledge it as time to renew my strength for greater strides in the future.

Impatience will come, crying, "Get up and do something! To 'stand firm' and wait is sheer idleness." Why is it I think I must be doing something right now instead of looking to the Lord? He will not only do something—He will do everything.

Arrogance will come, boasting, "If the sea is blocking your way, march right into it and expect a miracle." Yet true faith never listens to arrogance, impatience, cowardice, or despair but only hears God saying, "Stand firm." And then it stands as immovable as a rock.

It will not be long until God will say to me, as distinctly as He told Moses to tell the children of Israel, "Move on" (Ex. 14:15).

Charles H. Spurgeon

April 20

"Not by might nor by power, but by my Spirit," says the Lord Almighty. (Zechariah 4:6)

A boy on a bicycle was pedaling uphill against the wind, a streetcar, also going up the hill, approached him. It was not traveling too fast for the boy to grab hold of a rail at the rear. He went up the hill as effortlessly as a bird gliding through the sky.

I am like that boy on the bicycle in my weariness and weakness. I am pedaling uphill against all kinds of opposition and am almost worn out with the task. But nearby there is great power available—the strength of

己的手來爭戰的巨大試誘。

C.H.P.

當我們信靠屬地的力量時，屬靈的力量是不能生效的。

我們時常沒有給神機會來工作，因我們不明白神需要時間來應允禱告。

J.H.M.

四月十九日

「只管站住，看耶和華今天向你們所要施行的救恩。」(出 14:13)

神的聖言曾命令我要「力上加力」(詩84:7)來行走，我必會這樣，無論死亡或陰間也不能叫我偏離我的路。若有一日神召我來「站住」時，我以此為力量得更新來大步邁向未來的時刻。

急躁會來大叫說：「起來作一點事吧！『站住』和等候是全然懶散的。」為何我定要在這一刻作一點事而不是仰望主呢？祂不單止作一點事，祂必會作每一件事。

傲慢會來自誇說：「若有海擋隔你前路，就操過去，期待一個神蹟吧。」然而真正的信心不會聽命於傲慢、急躁、懦弱和失望，卻只會聽神說的「站住」。之後便如不移動的石頭般站住。

不多久神便會對我說話，如同祂明確叫摩西告訴以色列的子民「往前走」(出14:15)一般。

司布真

四月二十日

「不是倚靠勢力，不是倚靠才能，乃是倚靠我的靈方能成事。」(亞 4:6)

一個男孩逆風地踏車上山，一輛也是上坡的有軌電車駛近他。那男孩不用行太快便抓着電車尾部的橫檔，他不費吹灰之力來上山，如同一隻在空中滑翔的鳥兒一般。

我就像那個疲倦和軟弱地踏單車的男孩。我正在面對各種各樣的阻力下踏車上坡，幾乎因這任務而虛脫。但有一可用的大力量就在附

the Lord Jesus. All I must do is get in touch with Him and maintain communication with Him. And even if I grab hold with only one little finger of faith, it will be enough to make His power mine to accomplish the act of service that now overwhelms me.”

from The Life of Fuller Purpose

April 21

He did not waver ... regarding the promise ... , being fully persuaded that God had power to do what he had promised. (Romans 4:20-21)

Scripture tells us that Abraham, “without weakening in his faith, ... faced the fact that his body was as good as dead” (v. 19). He was not discouraged, because he was not looking at himself but at almighty God. “He did not waver ... regarding the promise” but stood straight, not bending beneath the staggering load of God’s blessing. Instead of growing weak, his faith grew stronger, exhibiting more power, even as more difficulties became apparent. Abraham glorified God for His complete sufficiency and was “fully persuaded that God had power to do what he had promised.”

He is the God of limitless resources—the only limit comes from us. Our requests, our thoughts, and our prayers are too small, and our expectations are too low. God is trying to raise our vision to a higher level, call us to have greater expectations, and thereby bring us to greater appropriation. Shall we continue living in a way that mocks His will and denies His Word?

El Shaddai—our almighty God is “able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within us” (Eph. 3:20).

A. B. Simpson

April 22

He knows the way that I take. (Job 23:10)

“He knows the way that I take”—this way of trials and tears, however winding, hidden, or tangled.” ! When the “furnace [is] heated seven times hotter than usual” (Dan. 3:19), I can know He still lights my way. There is an almighty Guide who knows and directs my steps, whether they lead to the bitter water at the well of Marah or to the joy and refreshment of the oasis at Elim (see Ex. 15:23, 27).

The way is dark to the Egyptians yet has its own pillar of cloud and fire for God’s Israel. The furnace may be hot, but not only can I trust the hand that lights the

近，就是主耶穌的力量。我定須作的就是與祂保持接觸，維持與祂的聯繫。就算我緊握的只是一小指頭的信，這信已足夠使祂的力量叫我完成所作如今壓住我的事奉。」

摘自《更豐盛旨意的生命》

四月二十一日

「總沒有因不信，心裏起疑惑……且滿心相信，神所應許的必能作成。」 (羅 4:20-21)

聖經告訴我們亞伯拉罕「雖然想到自己的身體如同已死……他的信心還是不軟弱」(羅4:19)。他沒有沮喪，因他看的不是自己而是全能的神。他在「沒有因不信……且滿心相信神所應許」下站穩，不屈身於神驚人數量的恩福。困難越多越發明顯，他信心不止不變弱，反越發堅強，顯出更大能力。亞伯拉罕在祂完全的豐足上和「滿心相信神所應許的必能作成」下來榮耀神。

祂是無限資源的神，唯一的限制來自我們。我們的懇求、思想和祈禱都太渺小，想望也太低下。神嘗試提升我們的目光往更高層次，召喚我們有更大的期望，來帶給我們更大的享用。我們還要活在無視祂旨意和摒棄祂說話的方式中麼？

全能神 (El Shaddai) 「能照着運行在我們心裏的大力，充充足足的成就一切超過我們所求所想的。」 (弗3:20)

宣信

四月二十二日

「祂知道我所行的路。」(伯 23:10)

「我所行的路」雖滿有試煉和眼淚，雖彎曲、隱蔽或糾結，但「祂知道」。當「窯燒熱比尋常更加七倍」(但 3:19) 時我知祂仍會叫我路途輕省。有全能的引導者知道和指揮我的步履，無論是領到馬拉井旁的苦水，還是以琳棕樹的歡快和身心恢復那裏去 (參出 15:23,27)。

埃及人那邊的雲柱黑暗，以色列民那邊卻是火柱。火窯也許熱，但我不單信靠那點火的手，且確定

fire, I can also have the assurance the fire will not consume but only refine. And when the refining process is complete, not a moment too soon or too late, “I will come forth as gold” (Job 23:10).

When I feel God is the farthest away, He is often the nearest to me. “When my spirit grows faint within me, it is you who know my way” (Ps. 142:3).

Thus, seeing God in everything, Job could say, “The Lord gave and the Lord has taken away; may the name of the Lord be praised” (Job 1:21). Yet his faith reached its zenith when this once powerful prince of the desert “sat among the ashes” (Job 2:8) and still could say, “Though he slay me, yet will I hope in him” (Job 13:15).

J. R. Macduff

April 23

Though I walk in the midst of trouble, you preserve my life. (Psalm 138:7)

And once we have called on God during our time of trouble, pleaded His promise of deliverance but not received it, and continued to be oppressed by the Enemy until we are in the very thick of the battle—or the “center of trouble”—others may tell us, “Don’t bother the teacher any more” (Luke 8:49).

When Martha said, “Lord, ... if you had been here, my brother would not have died” (John 11:21), Jesus countered her lack of hope with His greater promise, “Your brother will rise again” (John 11:23). And when we walk “in the center of trouble” and are tempted to think, like Martha, that we are past the point of ever being delivered, our Lord also answers us with a promise from His Word: “Though I walk in the midst of trouble, you preserve my life.”

The times we continue to walk in seemingly utter hopelessness are the very times He will “stretch out [His] hand against the anger of [our] foes” (Ps. 138:7). He will bring our trouble to completion, causing the Enemy’s attack to cease and to fail.

Aphra White

April 24

Faith is being ... certain of what we do not see. (Hebrews 11:1)

There are some letters on my desk that I wrote weeks ago, but I have yet to mail them because of my uncertainty over the address or the contents. Those letters have not done any good for me or anyone else

那火不會耗盡，能煉淨我。當那火煉過程完成時，一刻不太早也不太遲，「我必如精金」(伯 23:10)。

當我感到神離我最遠時，祂常最近。「我的靈在我裏面發昏的時候，祢知道我的道路。」(詩 142:3)

凡事見到神的約伯能說「賞賜的是耶和華，收取的也是耶和華。耶和華的名是應當稱頌的。」(伯 1:21)然而當這從前是沙漠有權勢的王子「坐在爐灰中」(伯 2:8)時，信心去到頂峰的他仍能說「祂雖殺我，我卻仍指望祂。」(伯 13:15)

J.R.麥道夫

四月二十三日

「我雖行在患難中，祢必將我救活。」(詩 138:7)

我們在困難中呼求神，懇求祂釋放的應許卻得不着時，持續被仇敵所壓逼直至我們進入最劇烈的戰爭中或稱為「患難的中心」時，有人或會叫我們「不要勞動夫子」(路8:49)了。

當馬大說：「主阿，你若早在這裏，我兄弟必不死」(約11:21)時，耶穌用更大的應許「你兄弟必然復活」(約11:23)填補她所缺欠的盼望。當我們步入「患難的中心」，落在像馬大的試探，以為得解救的時機已過去，我們的主也會用祂話語的應許來回答我們：「我雖行在患難中，祢必將我救活。」

我們繼續行在似乎是絕對無望的時刻正正是祂向「仇敵發怒.....伸手抵擋他們」(詩138:7)之時。祂必會領我們直至困難結束，叫仇敵的攻擊停止和傾倒。

亞發·威特

四月二十四日

「信.....是未見之事的確據。」(來 11:1)

在我桌上有幾封信是幾星期前寫的，但仍未寄出，因為我不確定地址或內容。那些信件於我或任何人到這地步仍毫無益處，他們永不

at this point. And they never will accomplish anything until I let go of them, trusting them to the postal service.

Psalm 37:5 is a great confirmation of this: "Commit your way to the Lord; trust in him and he will do this."

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

Dr. Payson, while still a young man, once wrote to an elderly mother who was extremely worried and burdened over the condition of her son. He wrote:

You are worrying too much about him. Once you have prayed for him, as you have done, and committed him to God, you should not continue to be anxious. God's command, "Do not be anxious about anything" (Phil. 4:6), is unlimited, and so is the verse, "Cast all your anxiety on him" (1 Peter 5:7).

April 25

Mary Magdalene and the other Mary were sitting there opposite the tomb. (Matthew 27:61)

Grief is ignorant and does not even care to learn. When the grieving women "were sitting there opposite the tomb," did they see the triumph of the next two thousand years?

The Christ you and I know today came from their loss. Countless mourning hearts have since seen resurrection in the midst of their grief, and yet these sorrowing women watched at the beginning of this result and saw nothing. What they regarded as the end of life was actually the preparation for coronation, for Christ remained silent that He might live again with tenfold power.

April 26

I consider everything a loss compared to the surpassing greatness of knowing Christ Jesus my Lord. (Philippians 3:8)

Light is always costly and comes at the expense of that which produces it. An unlit candle does not shine, for burning must come before the light. And we can be of little use to others without a cost to ourselves. Burning suggests suffering, and we try to avoid pain.

We tend to feel we are doing the greatest good in the world when we are strong and fit for active duty and when our hearts and hands are busy with kind acts of service. Therefore when we are set aside to suffer,

能達到目的，除非我放手，把他們交托給郵政服務。

詩37:5大大證實「當將你的事交托耶和華，並倚靠祂，祂就必成全。」

摘自《在地若天的日子》

皮爾遜博士還年輕時，有一次寫信給一位為她兒子的情況極之擔心和煩惱的年老母親。他寫道：

你過分擔憂他了。你一如既往為他祈了禱，把他交托給神後，你不應繼續憂慮了。神命令的「應當一無掛慮」（腓4:6）是無限制的，以下的經文也是一樣：「將一切的憂慮卸給神。」（彼前5:7）。

四月二十五日

「有抹大拉的馬利亞，和那個馬利亞在那裏，對着墳墓坐着。」（太27:61）

憂傷是無知，甚至無心學習。當那些憂傷的婦人們「坐在墳墓對面」時，她們見否隨後二千年的勝利？

你和我今天認識的基督是從她們的失敗而來的。無數悲傷的心靈從此見到在他們憂傷中的復活，然而在這結果的初期這些看望的憂傷婦人一無所見。他們所以為人生的終結事實上乃是加冕的準備，因為基督在祂將會以十倍能力的復活上仍然保持沉靜。

四月二十六日

「我以認識我主基督耶穌為至寶。我為祂已經丟棄萬事，看作糞土，為要得着基督。」（腓 3:8）

光是要付出的，要付代價才能製造出來。一支未點着的洋燭不會照亮，因光亮之先必有燃點。若我們沒付上代價，別人得益便少。燃燒意味受苦，我們卻避免受苦。

當我們身體強壯，勝任活躍的職責，我們的心和手正忙於服事的善舉時，我們傾向於感到我們在上所作的是最好的。因此當我們被

when we are sick, when we are consumed with pain, and when all our activities have been stopped, we feel we are no longer of any use and are accomplishing nothing.

Yet if we will be patient and submissive, it is almost certain we will be a greater blessing to the world around us during our time of suffering and pain than we were when we thought we were doing our greatest work. Then we are burning, and shining brightly as a result of the fire.

from Evening Thoughts

April 27

I am the Living One; I was dead, and behold I am alive for ever and ever! (Revelation 1:18)

Flowers! Easter lilies! Speak to me this morning the same sweet lesson of immortality you have been speaking to so many sorrowing souls for years. Wise old Book! Let me read again in your pages the steady assurance that “to die is gain” (Phil. 1:21).

Trees, blossoms, and birds; and seas, skies, and winds—whisper it, sound it anew, sing it, echo it, let it beat and resonate through every atom and particle on earth, and let the air be filled with it.

A well-known preacher was once in his study writing an Easter sermon when this thought gripped him: “My Lord is living!” With excitement he jumped up, paced the floor, and began repeating to himself, “Christ is alive. His body is warm. He is not the great ‘I was’ but the great ‘I am.’” Christ is not only a fact but a living fact. He is the glorious truth of Easter Day!

Abbott Benjamin Vaughan

April 28

When they cried out to the Lord, he raised up for them a deliverer, Othniel ... , Caleb’s younger brother, who saved them. The Spirit of the Lord came upon him. (Judges 3:9-10)

The day is coming when, like Othniel, we will also judge the nations and will rule and reign with Christ on earth during His millennial kingdom. But before that glorious day, we must allow God to prepare us, as He did Othniel at Kiriath Sepher (see Judg. 1:11-13). We must allow God to work amid our present trials and in the little victories, the future significance of which we can only imagine. Yet we can be sure that if the Holy

放置一旁來受苦時，當我們害病時，當我們衰萎於痛苦中，和當我們所有的活動停止了時，我們感到我們不再有用，一事無成。

然而我們若忍耐和順服，幾乎可肯定的，在我們受苦和悲痛之時比起我們以為在作最偉大的工作之時更能為環繞我們的世人帶來更大的祝福。之後我們在燃燒，因着火的緣故能光亮地照耀。

摘自《黃昏默想》

四月二十七日

「又是那存活的。我曾死過，現在又活了，直活到永永遠遠。」(啟1:18)

復活節的百合花向我訴說多年來向眾多憂傷生命述說的相同不死甜美教訓。古舊智慧的書啊！讓我再次在你的書頁中閱讀「死了就有益處」(腓1:21)的堅定確據。

樹木、花兒、雀鳥、海洋、天空和風兒細訴，從新宣告，唱頌，重覆它，讓它藉地上的每個原子和粒來拍打和共鳴，讓空氣充滿它。

有一次一知名傳道者編寫復活節講章時，「我主活着」這思想反覆出現！他興奮跳起，踱步，自言自語說：「基督活着，祂的身體暖和，祂不是『我曾是』，而是『我是』。」基督不止是事實，更是活潑的事實，是復活日的榮耀真理！

阿博特·便雅憫·華庚

四月二十八日

「以色列人呼求耶和華的時候，耶和華就為他們興起一位拯救者救他們，就是迦勒兄弟基納斯的兒子俄陀聶。耶和華的靈降在他身上。」(士3:9-10)

那日我們會像俄陀聶般審判列國，與基督在地上千禧年國度審判和管治。在這榮耀日之先，我們須讓神鍛鍊我們，如同俄陀聶在基列西弗(參士11:11-13)一般。我們須在今天的試煉和那些微不足道的得勝上容讓神作工，我們只能幻想其將來的重要性。我們能確定的是只

Spirit has His way with us, the Lord of heaven and earth has also prepared for us a throne.

A. B. Simpson

April 29

Elijah was a man just like us. He prayed earnestly. (James 5:17)

The literal meaning of this in the Greek is magnificent: instead of saying, “earnestly,” it says, “He prayed in prayer.” In other words, “He kept on praying.”

After Elijah had called down fire from heaven to defeat the prophets of Baal, rain was needed for God’s prophecy to be fulfilled. And the man who could command fire from heaven could bring rain using the same methods. We are told, “Elijah ... bent down to the ground and put his face between his knees” (1 Kings 18:42), shutting out all sights and sounds. He put himself in a position, beneath his robe, to neither see nor hear what was happening.

Six times Elijah told his servant, “Go back.” Each time the servant returned saying, “Nothing!” Yet “the seventh time the servant reported, ‘A cloud as small as a man’s hand is rising from the sea’” (1 Kings 18:44). What a fitting description, for a man’s hand had been raised in prayer to God before the rains came. And the rains came so fast and furiously that Elijah warned Ahab to “go down before the rain stops you.”

Arthur Tappan Pierson

April 30

The cows that were ugly and gaunt ate up the seven sleek, fat cows.... The thin heads of grain swallowed up the seven healthy, full heads. (Genesis 41:4, 7)

It is possible for the best years of our life, the best experiences we have enjoyed, the best victories we have won, and the best service we have rendered, to be swallowed up by times of failure, defeat, dishonor, and uselessness in God’s kingdom. Some people whose lives offered exceptional promise and achievement have come to such an end.

Maintaining this “fresh touch with God,” by abiding in Christ, will be the only thing to keep the “ugly and gaunt ... cows” and the “thin heads of grain” from consuming my life.

from Messages for the Morning Watch

要聖靈與我們一起，天地的主亦早已為我們預備一個寶座了。

宣信

四月二十九日

「以利亞與我們是一樣性情的人，他懇切禱告。」(雅 5:17)

這句經文的字面意思是深遠的。它說到的「懇切」是說「他禱告完又禱告。」換句話說，「他不斷禱告」。

當以利亞吩咐火從天降下來打敗巴力的先知後，亦需要降雨來叫神的預言應驗。那個能命令火從天降下的，也能用同樣的方法來帶來雨水。我們得知「以利亞.....屈身在地，將臉伏在兩膝之中。」(王上 18:42) 不讓所有視線和聲音進來。他的姿勢是將臉伏在兩膝之中，不去看或聽所發生的事。

之後以利亞六次告訴僕人：「上去。」每次僕人回來時都說：「沒有甚麼。」但「第七次僕人說：我看見有一小片雲從海裏上來。」(王上 18:44) 這是何等適切的描述，因在雨來到有人舉手禱告神。雨來得的急速和洶湧以致以利亞警告亞哈「下去，免得被雨阻擋。」

亞瑟·塔斌·皮爾遜

四月三十日

「這又醜陋又乾瘦的七隻母牛吃盡了那又美好又肥壯的七隻母牛。.....這細弱的穗子吞了那七個又肥大又飽滿的穗子。」(創 41:4,7)

我們人生中最好的年月、我們曾享受的最好經驗、我們贏取最佳的勝利和我們作的最佳服事，都有可能被神國中的失敗、挫折、耻辱和無用所吞噬。有生命呈現異常的希望和成就的人，到頭來卻落得這樣的下場。

唯一能叫那「又醜陋又乾瘦的七隻母牛和細弱的穗子」不致消耗我的生命可作的事是藉住在神裏面來保持這「與神新鮮的接觸」。

摘自《晨更的信息》

May 1

God, who does not lie, promised. (Titus 1:2)

Faith is recognizing God's promise as an actual fact, believing it is true, rejoicing in the knowledge of that truth, and then simply resting because God said it.

Faith turns a promise into a prophecy, because "God ... does not lie.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

I often hear people praying for more faith. What they are wanting is their faith to be changed to sight.

Faith does not say, "I see this is good for me; therefore God must have sent it." Instead, faith declares, "God sent it; therefore it must be good for me."

Faith, when walking through the dark with God, only asks Him to hold his hand more tightly.

Phillips Brooks

May 2

The Lord has established his throne in heaven, and his kingdom rules over all. (Psalm 103:19)

I imagined an angel handing me a key to the winds. So I hurried high into the hills to the source of the winds and stood amid the caves. I proclaimed, "I will do away with the terrible east wind—it will never plague us again!"

Then looking around me, I asked myself, "What should I put in its place?" I thought of the warm southerly wind and how pleasant it must be to newborn lambs and new flowers and plants of all kinds. But as I put the key in the door, it began to burn my hand. I cried aloud, "What am I doing? Who knows what damage I may cause? How do I know what the fields want and need? Ten thousand problems may result from this foolish wish of mine!"

Bewildered and ashamed, I looked up and asked the Lord to send His angel to take away the key. Then I promised I would never ask for it again. To my amazement, the Lord Himself came and stood by me. He stretched out His hand to take the key, and as I placed it there, I saw it touch that sacred scar.

I asked, "Do you keep the key to the winds?" "I do, my child, my 'kingdom rules over all'."

"If you rule 'over all,'" I questioned, "is it safe to complain about anything?" Then He tenderly laid His hand upon me to say, "My dear child, your only safety

五月一日

「那無謊言的神.....應許.....」(多1:2)

信認定神的應許是事實，相信是真實的。認識這真實而歡欣，單單因神這樣說而安息。

信把應許變成為預言，因為「神是無謊言的神」。

摘自《在地若天的生活》

我常聽到人祈求更多的信，他們所缺乏的是改變成為可見的信。

信不會說「我看見這於我有益，因此神必須將它送來。」反而信宣告說「神把它送來，因此它必是於我有益的。」

當與神在黑暗中行走時，信只會求神更緊緊地握着他的手。

腓力斯·布魯克

五月二日

「耶和華在天上立定寶座，祂的國統管萬有。」(詩103:19)

我幻想一個天使交給我一把風的鎖匙。於是我慌忙走上高山，來到風的來源之處，站在山洞之間。我宣告：「我必會除去那可怖的東風，它不能再折磨我們了！」

當我轉動鎖匙時，我自問：「我該用甚麼取代它？」我想到暖暖的南風，初生的羊羔、各種簇新花兒和植物必令人何等歡快！當我把鎖匙放進那門時，它開始燒灼我的手，我大聲喊叫：「我在作甚麼？我會造成甚麼破壞？我怎知田野想要和需要甚麼？我這愚昧思想會帶來千萬個問題呢！」

我狼狽和羞愧地上望叫主派祂的天使取走那鎖匙，之後我承諾永不會祈求這個。使我驚異的是主親自站在我跟前，祂伸出祂的手接去那鎖匙。當我把它放在那裏時，我看見它觸碰到那神聖的傷痕。

我問：「是祢保管風兒鎖匙？」「是的孩子。我的國統管萬有。」

我問說：「祢若『統管萬有』，那麼任何事上的埋怨是否穩妥？」祂便溫柔地把手按着我說：「我

comes from loving, trusting, and praising Me through everything.”

Mark Guy Pearse

May 3

Everyone who calls on the name of the Lord will be saved. (Joel 2:32)

So why don't I call on His name? Why do I run to this person or that person, when God is so near and will hear my faintest call? Why do I sit down to plot my own course and make my own plans? Why don't I immediately place myself and my burden on the Lord?

Why don't I run directly to the living God? Instead, I look in vain for deliverance everywhere else, but with God I will find it. With Him I have His royal promise: “[I] will be saved.”

Charles H. Spurgeon

May 4

He wounds, but He also binds up; He injures, but His hands also heal. (Job 5:18)

The Ministry of Great Sorrow

As we walk beside the hills that have been so violently shaken by a severe earthquake, we realize that times of complete calm follow those of destruction. In fact, pools of clear, still water lie in the valley beneath the fallen rocks of those hills as water lilies reflect their beauty to the sky. The reeds along the streams whisper in the wind, and the village rises once again, forgetting the graves of the past. And the church steeple, still bright after weathering the storm, proclaims a renewed prayer for protection from Him who holds the corners of the earth in His hands and gives strength to the hills.

John Ruskin

May 5

As they began to sing and praise, the Lord set ambushes against the men ... who were invading Judah, and they were defeated. (2 Chronicles 20:22)

Oh, if only we would worry less about our problems and sing and praise more! There are thousands of things that shackle us that could be turned into instruments of music, if we just knew how to do it. How different their lives would be, and how much more joyful, if they would stop indulging in self-centered and inward thinking and instead would

親愛的孩子啊，你的穩妥獨獨來自凡事上愛我、信靠我和讚美我。」

馬可·基·皮爾斯

五月三日

「到那時候，凡求告耶和華名的就必得救。」(珥 2:32)

你何不求告祂的名？神既這麼相近來聽我最微弱的呼喚，為何我仍要走向這人那人？為何我要坐下來計劃我一己的行程和作出我一己的計劃？我何不立時把我自己和我的擔子放在主身上呢？

我何不直接跑向永生神？我望向別處來尋找釋放都是枉然，而在神處我必找得着。有了祂我便得着君尊的應許：我「就必得救」。

司布真

五月四日

「因為祂打破，又纏裹；祂擊傷，用手醫治。」(伯 5:18)

極度憂傷的使命

當我在被嚴重地震強烈搖晃蹂躪的山邊走過時，我看見破壞時刻過後是完全平靜的一刻。事實上，清澈靜止的池水在那些山頭滾石下的山谷中，如同水中百合向天反照他們的美麗。沿着溪流的蘆葦在風中低語，村落再次冒起，忘記了過去的死氣沉沉。教堂的尖頂在度過風暴後仍然閃亮，發出一更新的祈禱，求握持地之四角在手中之神的保護，和把力量賜給山嶺。

約翰·甩士堅

五月五日

「眾人方唱歌讚美的時候，耶和華就派伏兵擊殺那來攻擊猶大人的人，他們就被打敗了。」(代下 20:22)

噢，但願我們少些擔心我們的困難，多點來讚美！雖然有成千上萬的事情難阻着我們，但只要我們知道怎樣作，他們都可以成為發音樂的樂器。他們若能停止矯縱他們的自我中心和內裏思想，反而把每天週遭的事帶到神面前，為這些事

daily lift their experiences to God, praising Him for them.

It is easier to sing your worries away than to reason them away. Why not sing in the morning?

Oh, that we might sing morning and evening, offering up song after song of continual praise throughout our day!

selected

May 6

The secret of the Lord is with them that fear him.
(Psalm 25:14 KJV)

There are certain secrets of God's providence He allows His children to learn. Often, however, His dealings with them appear to be harsh and hidden. Yet faith looks deeper and says, "This is God's secret. You are looking only on the outside, but I look deeper and see the hidden meaning."

Remember, diamonds are found in the rough. And when the tabernacle was built in the wilderness, there was nothing ornate about its outward appearance.

Dear friend, God may send you some valuable gifts wrapped in unattractive paper.

A. B. Simpson

A person who has Christ as his Master is the master of every circumstance. Are your circumstances pressing in on you? Do not push away, for they are the Potter's hands. And you will learn to master them not by stopping their progress but by enduring their discipline. Your circumstances are not only shaping you into a vessel of beauty and honor but also providing you with resources of great value.

May 7

Jesus told his disciples a parable to show them that they should always pray and not give up. (Luke 18:1)

The failure to persevere is the most common problem in prayer and intercession.

Giving up is admitting failure and defeat. Defeat then leads to discouragement and doubt in the power of prayer, and that is fatal to the success of a person's prayer life.

Pray until what you pray for has been accomplished or until you have complete assurance in your heart that it will be. Only when one of these two conditions has been met is it safe to stop persisting in prayer, for prayer not only is calling upon God but is

情來讚美神時，他們的生命會是何等不同，會如何更加喜樂！

用歌聲唱走你的憂慮比用理性更容易。何不在早晨唱這歌呢？

噢，我們可以在早上和黃昏來唱歌，獻上一首又一首的歌，整天來不斷讚美。

選

五月六日

「耶和華與敬畏祂的人親密。」(詩25:14)

神容許祂的孩子來學習祂某些秘密的旨意。但是祂對他們的作為經常是嚴苛和隱藏的。然而看得更深的信心說：「這是神的秘密，你只看在表面，但我看得更深，也見到隱藏的意思。」

謹記，鑽石被發現時是粗糙的；當會幕在曠野中豎立時，在它外觀上是毫無裝飾的。

親愛的朋友啊，神可能送你的貴重禮物是包在不吸引紙張中的。

宣信

一個有基督作主的人是每個處境的主人。你的環境是否困擾你？不要推開他們，因為他們是在窯匠手中。你必定要學會控制他們，不是藉停止他們來到，而是藉忍受他們的鍛鍊。你的環境不只塑造你成為美麗和尊貴的器皿，且把重大價值的恩源任讓你來支取。

五月七日

「耶穌設一個比喻，是要人常常禱告，不可灰心。」(路18:1)

祈禱和代求上最常見的問題就是不能堅持。

放棄是承認失效和失敗。失敗之後引至沮喪和懷疑祈禱的權力，這就是人祈禱生活成功的成敗關鍵。

祈禱直至你所祈禱的已經得成就，或直至你在心中已完全確定這事必會成就為止。只要符合這兩個情況的其中一個才可安心不再繼續祈禱了，因為祈禱不單是求告神，

also a battle with Satan.

In the first instance, we stop because we actually see the answer. In the second, we stop because we believe, and faith in our hearts is as trustworthy as the sight of our eyes, for it is “faith from God” (Eph. 6:23) and the “faith of God” (Rom. 3:3 KJV) that we have within us.

from The Practice of Prayer

May 8

Walking around in the fire. (Daniel 3:25)

When Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego were thrown into the furnace, the fire was one of the streets they traveled to their destination. The comfort we have from Christ’s revealed truth is not that it teaches us freedom from sorrow but that it teaches us freedom through sorrow.

O dear God, when darkness overshadows me, teach me that I am merely traveling through a tunnel. It will then be enough for me to know that someday it will be all right.

Someday I will stand at the top of the Mount of Olives and experience the height of resurrection glory. But heavenly Father, I want more—I want Calvary to lead up to it. I want to know that the shadows of darkness are the shade on a road—the road leading to Your heavenly house. Teach me that the reason I must climb the hill is because Your house is there! Knowing this, I will not be hurt by sorrow, if I will only walk in the fire.

George Matheson

May 9

Abraham remained standing before the Lord. (Genesis 18:22)

The person whose faith has been severely tested yet who has come through the battle victoriously is the person to whom even greater tests will come. The finest jewels are those that are the most carefully cut and polished, and the most precious metals are put through the hottest fires. You can be sure Abraham would never have been called the Father of Faith had he not been tested to the utmost.

Read Genesis 22. In verse 2 God said to Abraham, “Take your son, your only son, Isaac, whom you love, and ... sacrifice him.”

And once Abraham’s faith had victoriously endured its greatest test, the Angel of the Lord spoke

且也是與撒但的一場爭戰。

首個情況的停止是因我們實在看見了回應。第二個情況的停止是因我們相信，我們心中的信有如同眼見的確實，因為這是「從神來的信」(弗6:23)和我們在裏頭擁有的「神的信」(羅3:3)。

摘自《實踐祈禱》

五月八日

「在火中遊行。」(但 3:25)

當沙得拉、米煞和亞伯尼歌被拋進火窑時，那火是他們走往目的地的其中一條街道。我們有來自基督所彰顯真理的安慰不是在於它教導我們如何免於憂傷，而是它教導我們如何在憂傷中自由。

親愛的神啊，當黑暗遮蔽我時，讓我知道我只是走經一隧道。這認知對我來說已足夠，因為終有一日便會平安度過。

終有一日我會站在橄欖山巔經歷復活榮耀的高峯。天父啊，我想得更多，我想得引路至此的加略山，我想認識黑暗的陰影乃路蔭，這路引往祢天家去。教導我我定須往山上爬的原因，因為祢的家就在那裏！認識這個叫我不再因憂悶而受傷害，只要我能在火中遊行。

喬治·馬得勝

五月九日

「亞伯拉罕仍舊站在耶和華面前。」(創 18:22)

那些經歷爭戰勝利，信心受嚴厲考驗的人，更嚴厲的試煉在等待着他們。最完美的珠子是經過最仔細的切割和打磨的；最貴重的金屬是被放進最熱之火的。你也能肯定亞伯拉罕未經歷最極度的試煉是永不被稱為信心之父的。

在創 22:2 神對亞伯拉罕說：「帶着你的兒子，就是你獨生的兒子，你所愛的以撒.....獻為燔祭。」

亞伯拉罕的信勝利地耐得住其最嚴峻的試煉時，主的天使對他

to him and said, "Now I know that you fear God" (Gen. 22:12). The Lord said to him, in effect, "Because you have trusted me through this great trial, I will trust you, and you will forever be 'my friend' [Isa. 41:8]." The Lord promised Abraham, "I will surely bless you ... and through your offspring all nations on earth will be blessed, because you have obeyed me" (Gen. 22:17-18).

It is true, and always will be, that "those who have faith are blessed along with Abraham, the man of faith" (Gal. 3:9).

selected

May 10

I would have despaired unless I had believed that I would see the goodness of the Lord.... Wait for the Lord; be strong, and let your heart take courage. (Psalm 27:13-14 NASB)

What have you done in the past when you felt weak physically? You could not do anything. You ceased from doing. In your weakness, you leaned on the shoulder of a strong loved one. You leaned completely on someone else and rested, becoming still, and trusting in another's strength.

It is the same when you are tempted to despair under spiritual afflictions. Once you have come close to the point of despair, God's message is not, "Be strong and courageous" (Josh. 1:6), for He knows that your strength and courage have run away. Instead, He says sweetly, "Be still, and know that I am God" (Ps. 46:10).

Hudson Taylor was so weak and feeble in the last few months of his life that he told a friend, "I am so weak I cannot write. I cannot read my Bible. I cannot even pray. All I can do is lie still in the arms of God as a little child, trusting Him." This wonderful man of God, who had great spiritual power, came to the point of physical suffering and weakness where all he could do was lie still and trust.

May 11

We went through fire and water, but you brought us to a place of abundance. (Psalm 66:12)

This peace, born of conflict, is not like the ominous lull before the storm but like the serenity and the quietness following the storm, with its fresh, purified air.

The person who may appear to be blessed, having

說：「現在我知道你是敬畏神的了。」(創 22:12) 因此主對他說：「因你藉這大試煉來信靠我，所以我必信任你，你必永遠作『我的朋友』。」(賽 41:8) 主應許亞伯拉罕：「我必賜大福給你.....，並且地上萬國都必因你的後裔得福，因為你聽從了我的話。」(創 22:17-18)

「那以信為本的人，和有信心的亞伯拉罕一同得福」(加 3:9) 是真的，也總會是真的。

選

五月十日

「我若不信在活人之地得見耶和華的恩惠，就早已喪膽了。要等候耶和華。當壯膽，堅固你的心。」(詩 27:13-14)

當你過往感到身體軟弱時你會作甚麼？你任何事也不能作，你工作停頓，在軟弱中你凭向一強壯愛你之人。你完全凭向某人來安息，信靠別人的力量下變得靜止。

你在屬靈困苦下面對喪膽的試探時亦是一樣。一旦喪膽臨近時，神的信息不是「當剛強壯膽」(書 1:6)，因祂知道你的力量和勇氣都已失去；祂反會親切地說：「要休息，要知道我是神。」(詩 46:10)

戴德生在他生命最後幾個月時體弱無力，他告訴朋友說：「我軟弱到不能書寫，讀經，祈禱。我所能作的就像一小孩般靜靜地臥在神的膀臂中，信靠祂。」這個屬神有偉大屬靈能力的偉人來到他身體的痛苦和軟弱之境，他在這裏所能作的就是靜靜安躺和信靠。

五月十一日

「祢使人坐車輓我們的頭；我們經過水火，祢卻使我們到豐富之地。」(詩 66:12)

這出於衝突的安息不像是風暴前的可怕沉靜暫息，而是像風暴後帶着清新淨化空氣的平靜安寧。

未曾經歷憂傷的人看來蒙福，

been untouched by sorrow, is typically not one who is strong and at peace. His qualities have never been tested, and he does not know how he would handle even a mild setback. But once the initial shock is over and we are able to look up and say, "It is the Lord" (John 21:7), faith begins to lift our shattered hopes once more and securely binds them to the feet of God. And the final result is confidence, safety, and peace.

selected

May 12

Everything is possible for him who believes. (Mark 9:23)

Genuine moral fiber is developed by enduring the discipline of faith. When you have made your request to God, and the answer still has not come, keep on believing His Word! Never be swayed from it by what you may see or feel. Then as you stand firm, your power and experience is being developed, strengthened, and deepened. When you remain unswayed from your stance of faith, even in view of supposed contradictions to God's Word, you grow stronger on every front.

God will often purposely delay in giving you His answer, and in fact the delay is just as much an answer to your prayer as is the fulfillment when it comes. He worked this way in the lives of all the great Bible characters. Abraham, Moses, and Elijah were not great in the beginning but made great through the discipline of their faith.

It was not the prison life with its hard beds or poor food that tried Joseph but "the word of the Lord."

selected

May 13

We do not know what we ought to pray for. (Romans 8:26)

We pray for patience, and our Father sends demanding people our way who test us to the limit, "because ... suffering produces perseverance" (Rom. 5:3). We pray for a submissive spirit, and God sends suffering again, for we learn to be obedient in the same way Christ "learned obedience from what he suffered" (Heb. 5:8).

We pray to be unselfish, and God gives us opportunities to sacrifice by placing other people's needs first and by laying down our lives for other

其實不是堅強和安息的人。前者的素質未經試驗，他也甚至不知道能否處理一輕微的挫折。一旦開初的動盪過去了，我們便能夠上望而說：「是主。」(約 21:7)，信心開始再一次提起我們破滅了的寄望，把寄望牢牢地繫在神的腳那裏。結局是確信、穩妥和平安。

選

五月十二日

「在信的人，凡事都能。」(可9:23)

真正的屬靈素質是經過忍受信心的操練而產生的，當你向神作了請求後，答應仍未來到時，你要持續相信祂的話！不要因所見或所感而偏離這個。你當站穩時，你的力量和經驗是在形成、加力和進深中。當你在信的姿態上保持不動搖時，就算見着與神的話本來的意思相矛盾時，你在每條戰線上仍會越發強壯。

神常故意給你遲來的垂聽，而事實上那遲延就與禱告蒙垂聽無異，如同垂聽的成就來到一樣。祂以這方法來在所有聖經偉大人物中來作工。亞伯拉罕、摩西和以利亞開初並不偉大，而是藉信心的操練來成為偉大的。

原來試煉約瑟的不是囚牢生涯、硬床或差劣食物，而是「耶和華的話」(詩105:19)。

選

五月十三日

「我們本不曉得當怎樣禱告。」(羅 8:26)

我們祈求忍耐，我們的父就在我們的路上差來斤斤計較的人試煉我們到極點，「因為.....患難生忍耐」(羅 5:3)。我們祈求順服的靈時，神會再次差來苦難，因我們是以基督「所受的苦難學了順從」(來 5:8)這相同方法來學習順服的。

我們祈求不自私，神就給我們機會來奉獻，是將他人的需要放在首先的位置，也是將我們的生命為

believers. We pray for strength and humility, and “a messenger of Satan” (2 Cor. 12:7) comes to torment us until we lie on the ground pleading for it to be withdrawn.

We pray to the Lord, as His apostles did, saying, “Increase our faith!” (Luke 17:5). Then our money seems to take wings and fly away; our children become critically ill; an employee becomes careless, slow, and wasteful; or some other new trial comes upon us, requiring more faith than we have ever before experienced.

We pray for a Christlike life that exhibits the humility of a lamb. Then we are asked to perform some lowly task, or we are unjustly accused and given no opportunity to explain, for “he was led like a lamb to the slaughter, and ... did not open his mouth” (Isa. 53:7).

We pray for gentleness and quickly face a storm of temptation to be harsh and irritable. We pray for quietness, and suddenly every nerve is stressed to its limit with tremendous tension so that we may learn that when He sends His peace, no one can disturb it.

We pray for love for others, and God sends unique suffering by sending people our way who are difficult to love and who say things that get on our nerves and tear at our heart. He does this because “love is patient, love is kind....It is not rude, ... it is not easily angered....It always protects, always trusts, always hopes, always perseveres. Love never fails.” (1 Cor. 13:4-5, 7-8).

Yes, we pray to be like Jesus, and God’s answer is: “I have tested you in the furnace of affliction” (Isa. 48:10); “Will your courage endure or your hands be strong?” (Ezek. 22:14); “Can you drink the cup?” (Matt. 20:22).

The way to peace and victory is to accept every circumstance and every trial as being straight from the hand of our loving Father; to live “with Him in the heavenly realms” (Eph. 2:6), above the clouds, in the very presence of His throne; and to look down from glory on our circumstances as being lovingly and divinely appointed.

selected

May 14

On that very day Abraham [did] ... as God told him. (Genesis 17:23)

其他信徒而放下犧牲的。我們祈求力量和謙讓，就有「撒但的差役」(林後 12:7) 來折磨我們，直至我們臥在地上祈求除去它為止。

我們如同使徒所作的祈禱求主說：「加增我們的信心」(路 17:5)，之後我們的金錢似乎不翼而飛，我們的兒女忽然患急病，同事變得大意、手脚慢和浪費，又或者一些新的試煉來到我們處，需要的信心比我們之前曾經歷的更大。

我們祈求像基督的生命來彰顯羔羊的謙卑，之後我們被要求作一些低下的工作，或我們遭受不公平的指控，也不給機會來解釋，因為「祂像羊羔被牽到宰殺之地，祂也是這樣不開口。」(賽 53:7)

我們祈求溫柔時，很快便要面對既嚴厲又急躁的狂風試探。我們祈求安靜，突然每條神經都被拉扯至其極限，以致我們因而學會安靜，就在祂送來平安之時，這平安是沒有人能攪擾的。

我們祈求愛人，神便差來很難去愛的人這獨特的痛苦，所說的東西觸動我們的神經和催起我們心中的眼淚。祂這樣作因「愛是恒久忍耐，又有恩慈.....不張狂.....不輕易發怒，不計算人的惡.....凡事包容，凡事相信，凡事盼望，凡事忍耐。愛是永不止息。」(林前 13:4-5,7-8)

我們祈求像耶穌，神答說：「我熬煉你.....在苦難的爐中。」(賽 48:10)「你的心還能忍受麼？你的手還能有力麼？」(結 22:14)「我將要喝的杯，你們能喝麼？」(太 20:22)

和平與得勝之路是直接接受來自愛我們之父的手的每個處境和每個試煉，活出「與基督耶穌一同復活，一同坐在天上」(弗 2:6)的生命，就在祂寶座前，在我們用愛和神聖旨意所指定的處境的榮耀中下望。

選

五月十四日

「正當那日，亞伯拉罕遵着神的命。」(創17:23)

The only way to be obedient is to obey instantly—"On that very day," as Abraham did.

What a pity it is how we rob ourselves, as well as God and others, by our procrastination! Remember, "On that very day" is the Genesis way of saying, "Do it now!"

from Messages for the Morning Watch

Martin Luther once said, "A true believer will crucify, or put to death, the question, 'Why?' He will simply obey without questioning." And I refuse to be one of those people who "unless ... [I] see miraculous signs and wonders ... will never believe" (John 4:48). I will obey without questioning.

May 15

Men see not the bright light which is in the clouds. (Job 37:21 KJV)

The unchanging blue of a beautiful, sunlit sky still does not compare to the glory of changing clouds.

There is never a cloud without its "bright light." God has told us, "I have set my rainbow in the clouds" (Gen. 9:13).

O dear child of God! If only you could see your sorrows and troubles from above instead of seeing them from earth. If you would look down on them from where you are seated "with Christ ... in the heavenly realms" (Eph. 2:6), you would know the beauty of the rainbow of colors they reflect to the hosts of heaven. You would also see the "bright light" of Christ's face and would finally be content to see those clouds cast their deep shadows over the mountain slopes of your life. Remember, clouds are always moving ahead of God's cleansing wind.

selected

May 16

Do not be afraid, Daniel. Since the first day that you set your mind to gain understanding and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard, and I have come in response to them. But the prince of the Persian kingdom resisted me twenty-one days. (Daniel 10:12-13)

Daniel had fasted and prayed for twenty-one difficult days. As far as we can tell from the biblical account, the difficulty came not because Daniel was not a good person nor because his prayer was not right but because of a special attack from Satan.

唯一的順服是即時的順服，如同亞伯拉罕的「正當那日」一樣。

我們因這樣的耽誤而使我們自己、神和他人有所失落是何等可悲！謹記：「正當那日」在創世記的說法就是「事就這樣成了」。

摘自《晨更信息》

馬丁·路德曾說：「真信徒肯釘十字架，或交付死地，絕對順而不問『為甚麼』。」有人「若不看見神蹟奇事.....總是不信。」(約4:48)，我拒絕作他們當中的一個，我們當毫無疑問下來順服。

五月十五日

「現在有雲遮蔽，人不得見穹蒼的光亮。」(伯37:21)

不變蔚藍晴天的美麗總不能與雲彩變幻之榮耀相比較。

沒有一朵雲是沒有「光亮」的。神曾告訴我們：「我把虹放在雲彩中」(創9:13)。

神親愛的孩子啊！只要你不要從地往上看他們，而是從上面來看你的憂傷和困難，只要你從「與基督耶穌一同復活，一同坐在天上」(弗2:6)那兒往下望，你便會見到反照天上星辰之七色彩虹的美麗。你也得見基督臉上的「榮光」，至終樂見那些雲彩把他們深深的陰影遮蓋你人生的山坡。謹記，雲兒總在神清洗的風前移行。

選

五月十六日

「但以理阿，不要懼怕。因為從你第一日專心求明白將來的事，又在你神面前刻苦己心，你的言語已蒙應允。我是因你的言語而來。但波斯國的魔君攔阻我二十一日。」(但10:12-13)

但以理禁食祈禱了困難的二十一日，就聖經的記述叫我們知道，問題不是因但以理不夠好或他的禱告不正確，而是因為來自撒但的特別攻擊。

The Lord had sent His angelic messenger to tell Daniel that his prayer was answered the moment he began to pray, but the good angel was hindered by an evil angel who met him along the way and wrestled with him. This conflict occurred in the heavens, yet Daniel experienced the same kind of conflict here on earth as he agonized in prayer.

“Our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, ... and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms” (Eph. 6:12).

from a sermon

Hell works the hardest on God's saints. The most worthy souls will be tested with the most pressure and the highest heat, but heaven will not desert them.

William L. Watkinson

May 17

After forty years had passed, an angel appeared to Moses... in the desert....Then the Lord said to him, “Now come, I will send you back to Egypt.” (Acts 7:30, 33-34)

Often the Lord calls us aside from our work for a season and asks us to be still and learn before we go out again to minister. And the hours spent waiting are not lost time.

An ancient knight once realized, as he was fleeing from his enemies, that his horse needed a shoe replaced. The prudent course of action seemed to be to hurry on without delay. Yet higher wisdom told him to stop for a few minutes at the blacksmith's along the road. Although he heard the galloping hooves of the enemies' horses close behind, he waited until his steed was reshod before continuing his escape. Just as the enemy appeared, only a hundred yards away, he jumped into the saddle and dashed away with the swiftness of the wind. Then he knew his stopping had actually hastened his escape.

Quite often God will ask us to wait before we go, so we may fully recover from our last mission before entering the next stage of our journey and work.

from Days of Heaven upon Earth

May 18

We were under great pressure, ... so that we despaired even of life.... But this happened that we

主差派了祂報信的天使來告訴但以理說他的禱告就在他開始禱告一刻便已蒙垂聽，但那好天使被那壞天使所阻礙，是在路上遇見來與他爭戰的。這爭戰發生在天上，然而但以理在地上的痛苦祈禱中經歷相同的爭戰。

「因我們並不是與屬血氣的爭戰，乃是與那些執政的，掌權的，.....以及天空屬靈氣的惡魔爭戰。」
(弗6:12)

摘自一篇講道

地獄盡最大的力度來在神聖徒的身上作工。最有價值的生命將會接受最大的壓力和最高熱度的試煉，但天上是不會撇棄他們的。

威廉·L·屈健臣

五月十七日

「過了四十年，在西乃山的曠野，有一位天使.....向摩西顯現。.....主對他說.....你來，我要差你往埃及去。」(徒7:30,33-34)

神常召我們離開我們的工作一段時期，要我們安靜，在我們再次出去事奉前有所學習。用在等待的時間不是浪費的。

古時有一個武士在一次逃避敵人時，發現他的馬需要更換馬蹄鐵。萬全之策似乎是要立即趕路，一點也不能遲疑。然而一個更高的智慧告訴他要在沿路上的鐵匠那裏停留幾分鐘。雖然聽到敵人馬蹄奔跑聲逼近，但他一直等待直至他的駿馬在繼續逃亡前安好蹄鐵。就在敵人出現眼前，只有一百碼外時，他跳上馬鞍，如一陣風般飛快疾衝遠去。之後他知道他的停下來事實上加速了他的逃竄。

神常要我們在前行之先等待，叫我們進入下一個行程和工作這最後任命之先得着完全的恢復。

摘自《在地若天的日子》

五月十八日

「我們從前在亞西亞遭遇苦難，被壓太重，力不能勝，甚至連活命的

might not rely on ourselves but on God, who raises the dead. (2 Corinthians 1:8-9)

The pressure of difficult times makes us value life. Every time our life is spared and given back to us after a trial, it is like a new beginning. And the pressure we endure helps us to understand the trials of others, equipping us to help them and to sympathize with them.

A man or woman who has experienced great suffering will never do this is very tender and gentle, and understand what suffering really means. This is what Paul meant when he said, “Death is at work in us” (2 Cor. 4:12). Trials and difficult times are needed to press us forward.

A. B. Simpson

May 19

Before he had finished praying, Rebekah came out with her jar on her shoulder....Then the man bowed down and worshiped the Lord, saying, “Praise be to the Lord, ... who has not abandoned his kindness and faithfulness.” (Genesis 24:15, 26-27)

“Before he had finished praying...” This is because Christ has pledged in His Word, “My Father will give you whatever you ask in my name” (John 16:23). When you ask in faith and in Christ’s name—that is, in oneness with Him and His will—it will be given you” (John 15:7).

Since God’s Word cannot fail, whenever we meet these simple conditions, the answer to our prayer has already been granted and is complete in heaven as we pray, even though it may not be revealed on earth until much later. Therefore it is wise to close every prayer with praise to God for the answer He has already given.

“Praise be to the Lord, ... who has not abandoned his kindness and faithfulness.” (See Dan. 9:20-27; 10:12.)

from Messages for the Morning Watch

May 20

Shall I not drink the cup the Father has given me? (John 18:11)

God is a thousand times more meticulous with us than even an artist is with his canvas. Using many brush strokes of sorrow, and circumstances of various colors, He paints us into the highest and best image He

指望都絕了。自己心裏也斷定是必死的，叫我們不靠自己，只靠叫死人復活的神。」(林後 1:8-9)

在困難時期的壓力使我們珍愛生命。每次我們生命得倖存，在試煉後給回我們生命時，這就像一個新的開始。我們所忍受的壓力幫助我們明白別人的試煉，裝備我們幫助他們和同情他們。

那些經歷過大痛苦的男女十分慈悲和溫馴，並明白痛苦的真正意思。這也是保羅說到「死是在我們身上發動」(林後 4:12) 的意思。試煉和困難時刻是需要用來推壓我們向前。

宣信

五月十九日

「話還沒有說完，不料，利百加肩頭上扛着水瓶出來。.....那人就低頭向耶和華下拜，說：耶和華.....神是應當稱頌的，因祂不斷地以慈愛誠實待我主人。」(創 24:15,26-27)

「話還沒有說完」，這是因基督在祂的話語中曾保證說：「你們若向父求甚麼，祂必因我的名，賜給你們。」(約 16:23) 當你用信奉基督的名祈求，與祂和祂的旨意合一時，「就給你們成就。」(約 15:7)

神的話既永不會落空，因此每當我們遇着這些尋常的情況時，我們祈禱的蒙垂聽早已賜下，和當我們祈禱時天上已然成就，雖則在地上也許要遲很多才得揭示。因此以神早已賜下垂聽來讚美神來結束每個祈禱是聰明的。

「神是應當稱頌的，因祂不斷的以慈愛誠實.....。」(參看但 9:20-27;10:12)

摘自《晨更的信息》

五月二十日

「我父所給我的那杯，我豈可不喝呢？」(約18:11)

神對我們的細緻比起畫家對他的畫布多一千倍。祂按祂的想像用很多憂傷的筆觸和不同顏色的情景來把我們繪畫成最高和最佳的形像

visualizes, if we will only receive His bitter gifts of myrrh in the right spirit.

Yet when our cup of sorrows is taken away and the lessons in it are suppressed or go unheeded, we do more damage to our soul than could ever be repaired. No human heart can imagine the incomparable love God expresses in His gift of myrrh. However, this great gift that our soul should receive is allowed to pass by us because of our sleepy indifference, and ultimately nothing comes of it.

Tauler

May 21

I remembered my songs in the night. (Psalm 77:6)

A little bird that will never sing the song its owner desires to hear while its cage is full of light, until its cage is covered and the sunlight is shut out.

Many people never learning to sing until the shadows of darkness fall. We need to remember: it was on that Bethlehem night the song of angels was heard; and it was “at midnight the cry rang out: ‘Here’s the bridegroom! Come out to meet him!’” (Matt. 25:6).

It is indeed extremely doubtful that a person’s soul can really know the love of God in its richness and in its comforting, satisfying completeness until the skies are dark and threatening. Light emerges from darkness, and morning is born from the womb of night.

The world’s supply of rose oil comes from the Balkan Mountains. The roses had to be gathered during the darkest hours, with the pickers starting at one o’clock and finishing by two. Actual scientific tests had proved that a full forty percent of the fragrance of the roses disappeared in the light of day.

Malcolm J. McLeod

May 22

Commit your way to the Lord; trust in him and he will do this. (Psalm 37:5)

The literal meaning of this verse is: “Roll your way onto Jehovah and trust upon Him, and He works.”

When does He work? “He works” now. We act as if God does not immediately accept our trust in Him and thereby delays accomplishing what we ask Him to do. We fail to understand that “He works” as we commit. “He works” now!

Our expectation that He will work is the very thing enabling the Holy Spirit to accomplish what we have “rolled” onto Him.

，只要我們用正確的靈來接受從神而來苦如沒藥的恩賜。

憂傷的杯被移除，訓誡被抑制或不加理會，對我們生命所造成的損害多於從來所能修補的。沒有一顆人心能想透神賜下祂沒藥恩賜所表達不可比擬的愛。但我們生命所該收到的這偉大恩賜若容許在我們處經過時，必是因為我們的懶散不在乎，因而最終一無所得了。

陀拉

五月二十一日

「我想起我夜間的歌曲。」(詩 77:6)

小鳥在充滿光的籠中永不會唱主人喜愛之歌，除非牠的籠子被蓋上，阻隔陽光。

很多人永學不會歌唱，除非黑蔭降臨。我們需要謹記：伯利恆晚上天使歌聲高唱；到「半夜有人喊着說：新郎來了，你們出來迎接他。」(太 25:6)

人的魂能真認識神的豐富和其中的安慰和完全的滿足實在極度令人懷疑，除非天空是黑暗和預示凶兆時。亮光是從黑暗中射出的，早晨亦是從夜晚的胎中生出來的。

世上玫瑰油的供應都來自巴爾幹山脈的。玫瑰花是在最黑暗的鐘數收集的，採摘者在一時動工，二時完成。已有確實的科學測試證明在日光之下所收集的玫瑰有足足百分之四十的香味會消失。

馬爾科姆·J·麥利奧德

五月二十二日

「當將你的事交托耶和華，並倚靠祂，祂就必成全。」(詩 37:5)

本節原文說：往耶和華那處滾去和倚靠祂，祂必會成全。

祂何時成全呢？現在。是我們以為神不立時接納我們對祂的信靠來延遲我們向祂所求之事的成就。我們不明瞭祂是在我們交托時便成全。

我們期待祂必成全正正是促使聖靈來把我們向祂滾動去的東西作成。

I cry out to God Most High, to God, who fulfills his purpose for me. Psalm 57:2

One beautiful old translation of this verse says, "He will perform the cause I hold in my hand." "I hold in my hand" —my work today, this concern that is beyond my control, this task in which I have greatly overestimated my own abilities—this is what I may "cry out" for Him to do "for me," with the calm assurance He will perform it. "The wise and what they do are in God's hands" (Eccl. 9:1).

Frances Ridley Havergal

The Lord will follow through on His covenant promises. Whatever He takes and holds in His hand He will accomplish. Therefore His past mercies are guarantees for the future, and worthy reasons for continuing to cry out to Him.

Charles H. Spurgeon

May 23

They were at their wits' end. Then they cried out to the Lord in their trouble, and he brought them out of their distress. (Psalm 107:27-28)

*Are you standing at "Wits' End Corner,"
Christian, with troubled brow?
Are you thinking of what is before you,
And all you are bearing now?
Does all the world seem against you,
And you in the battle alone?
Remember—at "Wits' End Corner"
Is just where God's power is shown.*

*Are you standing at "Wits' End Corner,"
Blinded with wearying pain,
Feeling you cannot endure it,
You cannot bear the strain,
Bruised through the constant suffering,
Dizzy, and dazed, and numb?
Remember—at "Wits' End Corner"
Is where Jesus loves to come.*

*Are you standing at "Wits' End Corner"?
Your work before you spread,
All lying begun, unfinished,
And pressing on heart and head,*

「我要求告至高的神，就是為我成全諸事的神。」(詩 57:2)

這節經文有一個美麗翻譯：「祂必作成握在我手中的。」「握在我手中」的正是我今天的工作，在我控制之外，大大超乎我一己的能力，就此我「求告」祂來「為我」作工，實在確知祂必會成全。「義人和智慧人，並他們的作為，都在神手中。」(傳 9:1)

弗朗西斯·里德利·海弗格爾

主會在祂應許的約上跟進到底，祂拿來握在手上的任何東西祂必會成全。祂過去的憐憫是未來的保證，也成為繼續求告祂的有力原因。

司布真

五月二十三日

「他們的智慧無法可施。於是，他們在苦難中哀求耶和華，祂從他們的禍患中領出他們來。」(詩 107:27-28)

基督徒啊你是否面帶愁容站在無計可施的死角？

你是否想着在你面前的東西和你現今所肩負的一切東西？

是否整個世界在反對你，你是否孤軍作戰？

謹記，無計可施的死角就是神權能顯現之處。

你是否正站在無計可施的死角，被厭煩的痛苦所遮蔽，

感到你不能再忍受，不能再經得起那拉扯之力，

被恆常的痛苦所損傷而發僵，迷茫和麻木？

謹記，無計可施的死角就是耶穌喜歡來到之處。

你是否站在無計可施的死角？你的工作在你面前展現，

所有開始了的，未完成的工作都壓在心上和思想上，

*Longing for strength to do it,
Stretching out trembling hands?
Remember—at “Wits’ End Corner”
The Burden-Bearer stands.*

*Are you standing at “Wits’ End Corner” ?
Then you’re just in the very spot
To learn the wondrous resources
Of Him who fails you not:
No doubt to a brighter pathway
Your footsteps will soon be moved,
But only at “Wits’ End Corner”
Is the “God who is able” proved.*

Antoinette Wilson

Do not get discouraged—it may be the last key
on the ring that opens the door.

Stansifer

May 24

*Sarah became pregnant and bore a son to Abraham
in his old age, at the very time God had promised him.
(Genesis 21:2)*

The plans of the Lord stand firm forever, the
purposes of his heart through all generations” (Ps.
33:11). His timing is precise, for He does things “at
the very time” He has set.

If God had told Abraham while he was in Haran
that he would have to wait thirty years before holding
his promised child in his arms, his heart might have
failed him. So God, as an act of His gracious love, hid
from Abraham the number of weary years he would
be required to wait. Only as the time was approaching,
with but a few months left to wait, did God reveal His
promise: “At the appointed time next year ... Sarah
will have a son” (Gen. 18:14). The “appointed time”
came at last, and soon the joyous laughter that filled
the patriarch’s home caused the now elderly couple to
forget their long and tiring wait.

And soon “your grief will turn to joy” (John
16:20).

selected

May 25

I endure everything for the sake of the elect, that
they too may obtain the salvation that is in Christ Jesus,
with eternal glory. (2 Timothy 2:10)

No one lives to himself, and Job’s story is like yours

渴求能力來完成他們，伸出顫
抖的雙手？

謹記站在無計可施死角的是那
背負重擔者。

你是否站在無計可施的死角？
那麼你的所在

正正是學習那位不會誤你事者
的奇妙恩源：

對那條更光明的路徑深信不
疑，你的步履不久會被移動，

但只有在無計可施的死角才證
明「神是能夠的」。

安東尼迪·威爾遜

不要沮喪，這鎖匙圈的最後一
條可能就是開啟這扇門的那一條。

史坦薛化

五月二十四日

「當亞伯拉罕年老的時候，撒拉懷
了孕。到神所說的日期，就給亞伯
拉罕生了一個兒子。」(創21:2)

「耶和華的籌算永遠立定，祂
心中的思念萬代常存。」(詩33:11)
祂的定時是精確的，因為祂是在
「所說的日期」來作工的。

神若事先在哈蘭告訴亞伯拉罕
他要等待三十年才得抱所應許的孩
子在臂彎時，他的心也許會叫他卻
步。因此神向亞伯拉罕隱瞞他需要
等候長長疲憊之年數，此舉出於神
恩典之愛。時日來到，剩下幾個等
待月分時，神才向他顯明祂的應許
：「到了日期，明年這時候.....撒拉
必生一個兒子。」(創18:14)「所
說的日期」最終來到，歡聲充滿這
族長家庭，如今使那對年長的夫婦
忘記了他們長年厭倦的等待。

不久「你們的憂愁，要變為喜
樂。」(約16:20)

選

五月二十五日

「我為選民凡事忍耐，叫他們也
可以得着那在基督耶穌裏的救恩
，和永遠的榮耀。」(提後2:10)

無人為己而活，你我雖活像

and mine, only his was written for all to see.

We never know the trials that await us in the days ahead. We may not be able to see the light through our struggles, but we can believe that those days, as in the life of Job, will be the most significant we are called upon to live.

Robert Collyer

Who has not learned that our most sorrowful days are frequently our best? The days when our face is full of smiles and we skip easily through the soft meadow God has adorned with spring flowers, the capacity of our heart is often wasted.

Jesus said, "Blessed are those who mourn" (Matt. 5:4). Stars shine the brightest during the long dark night of winter. And the gentian wildflowers display their fairest blooms among the nearly inaccessible heights of mountain snow and ice.

Only those who have known sorrow can fully appreciate the great tenderness of the "man of sorrows" (Isa. 53:3).

selected

May 26

Spring up, O well! Sing about it. (Numbers 21:17)

The children of Israel had been traveling over the desert's barren sands, and they were desperate for water. Then God spoke to Moses and said, "Gather the people together and I will give them water" (v. 16).

The people then gathered around with their rods. As they had dug the well in the desert, they had tapped the stream that ran below and that had been unseen for a very long time.

Our praise will bring forth "water ... in the wilderness and streams in the desert" (Isa. 35:6), while complaining will only bring judgment. Even prayer by itself may fail to reach the fountain of blessings.

selected

May 27

Bring them here to me. (Matthew 14:18)

Do you find yourself at this very moment surrounded with needs, and nearly overwhelmed with difficulties, trials, and emergencies? Each of these is God's way of providing vessels for the Holy Spirit to fill.

"Bring them here to me." Firmly hold the vessels before Him, in faith and in prayer. Remain still before

約伯，只有他是給世人看的。

我們不知將要臨到我們的是甚麼試煉，也不得見掙扎過後的光明，但我們可以相信那些如同約伯生命所度過的日子必會是我們被呼召來活的最重要日子。

羅拔·柯利亞

有誰不知道我們最哀傷的日子常是最好的日子？我們臉上充滿笑容，在神用春天花兒裝飾的柔軟草坪上輕鬆蹦跳的日子常叫我們將心中所乘載的都浪費掉。

耶穌說：「哀慟的人有福了，因為他們必得安慰。」（太5:4）星星在最長冬夜才照耀得最光亮。野生龍膽花在人跡罕至的冰雪高山上才有最美麗的綻放。

只有那些知曉甚麼是憂傷的人才能完全體會「憂傷之子」（賽53:3）的偉大溫柔。

選

五月二十六日

「井阿，湧上水來！你們要向這井歌唱。」（民21:17）

以色列子民走過了荒蕪的沙漠，他們都極度口渴。之後神對摩西說：「招聚百姓，我好給他們水喝。」（民21:16）

人們帶同他們的杖來聚集，當他們在沙漠中掘井時，他們已開啟了在下面流動之溪水的水龍頭，這水是他們長久以來未曾看到的。

我們的讚美帶來「在曠野必有水發出，在沙漠必有河湧流」（賽35:6），而埋怨只會帶來審判。就算祈禱本身也不能到達恩典之泉。

選

五月二十七日

「拿過來給我。」（太14:18）

你是不是就在這刻發覺你被缺乏所環繞，幾乎被困難、試煉和突變事故所淹沒？這每一項都是神用來讓聖靈注滿你器皿的方法。

「拿過來給我。」用信和祈禱牢牢地拿着器皿到祂跟前。在祂面

Him, and stop your own restless working until He begins to work. Do nothing that He Himself has not commanded you to do. Allow God time to work and He surely will. Then the very trials that threatened to overcome you with discouragement and disaster will become God's opportunity to reveal His grace and glory in your life, in ways you have never known before.

A. B. Simpson

My God will meet all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus. Philippians 4:19

He who did not spare his own Son, but gave him up for us all—how will he not also, along with him, graciously give us all things? Romans 8:32

May 28

"I will not let you go unless you bless me." ... Then he blessed him there. (Genesis 32:26, 29)

Jacob won the victory and the blessing here not by wrestling but by clinging. His hip was out of joint and he could struggle no longer, but he would not let go. Unable to wrestle further, he locked his arms around the neck of his mysterious opponent, helplessly resting all his weight upon him, until he won at last.

We too will not win the victory in prayer until we cease our struggling. We must give up our own will and throw our arms around our Father's neck in clinging faith.

Strong-willed violence on our part will never prevail with Him. What wins blessings and victories is the strength of clinging faith.

It is not applying pressure or insisting upon our own will that brings victory. It is won when humility and trust unite in saying, "Not my will, but yours be done" (Luke 22:42).

We are strong with God only to the degree that self is conquered and is dead.

J. R. Miller

Charles H. Usher's little boy, Frank, was very ill, and the doctors held out little hope of his recovery. He realized he could not live much longer without a quick turn for the better. He said to the Lord, 'Oh, God, I have spent much time in prayer for my son, and yet he is no

前站穩，停止你一己不得安息的工作，直至祂開始動工。在祂沒有親自命令你作的事上不要動手。給神時間來工作，祂也肯定作成。之後那威脅着要用沮喪和不幸來壓倒你的試煉必會變成為神的機會來在你的生命中彰顯祂的恩慈，是用你先前從不認識的方法。

宣信

「我的神必照祂榮耀的豐富，在基督耶穌裏，使你們一切所需用的都充足。」(腓 4:19)

「神既不愛惜自己的兒子為我們眾人捨了，豈不也把萬物和祂一同白白的賜給我們麼？」(羅 8:32)

五月二十八日

「你不給我祝福，我就不容你去。.....於是那裏給雅各祝福。」(創 32:26,29)

雅各的得勝和得着祝福非因摔跤，而是纏磨。他的大腿窩脫臼不能再掙扎了，但他不放手。不能再摔跤的他用他雙臂來鎖着那神秘對手的頸，無助地將一身重量沉贅於他身上，直至得着最終勝利。

我們也不能在禱告中得勝，除非我們停止掙扎。我們定須放棄一己的意願，用纏繞的信來將我們的手臂環繞着天父的頸項。

我們方面暴烈的頑強意志永不能勝過祂。能夠贏取祝福和勝利的是那纏磨信心的力量。

不是施壓或堅持一己意志帶來勝利，是當謙卑和信靠同心說「然而不要成就我的意思，只要成就祢的意思」(路 22:42)時才能。

我們在神面前的強壯就只在乎我們自我被征服和死亡的程度。

J.R.米勒

查理斯·H·亞瑟的小兒子法蘭克病重，醫生們認定他痊愈的希望極微。在毫無轉機下明白到他不能久活，他對主說：『神啊，我已替兒子禱告多時，然而沒有好轉，

better. I will now leave him to You and give myself to prayer for others. If it is Your will to take him, I choose Your will—I surrender him entirely to You. '

His wife also handed him over to God. Two days later a godly man came to visit us. He had been very interested in their son Frank and had prayed often for him. He told them, 'God has given me faith to believe that your son will recover. Do you have that faith?'

'I have surrendered him to God, but I will now go again to Him regarding my son.' He did just that and while in prayer discovered he had faith for his recovery. From that time forward he began to get better. He then realized that it was the 'wrestling' of his prayers that had hindered God's answer, and that if he had continued to wrestle, being unwilling to surrender him to God, he would probably not be here today.

O dear child of God, if you want God to answer your prayers, you must be prepared to "walk in the footsteps of the faith that our father Abraham had" (Rom. 4:12), even to the mountain of sacrifice.

May 29

I have called you friends. (John 15:15)

Years ago there was an old German professor whose beautiful life was a wonder to his students. Some of them were determined to learn the secret of it, so one night they sent someone to hide in the study where the professor spent his evenings.

It was quite late when the teacher finally came. He was very tired but sat down and spent one hour with his Bible. Then he bowed his head in silent prayer, and finally closing the Book of books, he said, "Well, Lord Jesus, we still have the same old relationship."

"To know Christ" (Phil. 3:10) is life's greatest achievement. At all costs, every Christian should strive to "have the same old relationship" with Him.

The reality of knowing Jesus comes as a result of hidden prayer, and personal Bible study that is devotional and consistent in nature. Christ becomes more real to those who persist in cultivating His presence.

May 30

No one could learn the song except the 144, 000 who had been redeemed from the earth. (Revelation 14:3)

Even in heaven there will be a song that will only

我如今把他交給祢，從此為別人祈禱。若祢定旨意接他去，我選擇祢的旨意，我把他完全交給祢。』」

太太也把他交託給神。兩日後有虔誠人探望我們，他向來記掛他們的兒子，常為他祈禱。他告訴他們：『神已給我相信你們兒子會痊愈的信心，你們有否這信心？』」

「我已把他交托給神，但我如今會為着我的兒子再次到祂跟前。」當他作這個時，在禱告中發現在他的痊愈上有信心了。從那時開始他開始好轉。他才明白到是他摔跤的祈禱阻礙神的垂聽，他若繼續摔跤，不願意把他交托給神，他也許今天已不在了。

神所愛的孩子啊，你若想神垂聽你的祈禱，定須準備「按我們的祖宗亞伯拉罕.....信之蹤跡去行」（羅4:12），那怕是往山去獻祭。

五月二十九日

「以後.....我乃稱你們為朋友。」（約15:15）

多年前一個年老德國教授的學生視他的美麗生命為不可思議。有些學生決定去弄清其秘密，便在某夜派人躲藏在他書房中，就是教授往常度過黃昏的那處。

當老師進來時已是夜深時分，他雖十分疲倦，但仍坐下花一小時在他的聖經上。之後低頭來靜禱，最後合上那本書中之書，說：「主耶穌啊，我們的關係依然。」

「認識基督」（腓3:10）是生命上最大得着。每個基督徒該不惜代價努力得着與祂「關係依然」。

真能認識耶穌是來自隱藏禱告和存誠心和持續態度的個人讀經的結果。基督於那些堅持追求祂同在的人是更為真確的。

五月三十日

「除了從地上買來的那十四萬四千人以外，沒有人能學這歌。」（啟14:3）

在天上也只有那些「從地上買

be sung by those “who had been redeemed from the earth.” It is undoubtedly a song of triumph—a hymn of victory to the Christ who set us free. Yet the sense of triumph and freedom will be born from the memory of our past bondage. Only the children of the Cross will be equipped to learn the song.

In this life you are receiving a music lesson from your Father. Your Father is training you for a part the angels cannot sing, and His conservatory is the school of sorrows. He sends sorrow to educate you, thereby providing you with the proper training for His heavenly choir.

In the darkest night He is composing your song. In the valley He is tuning your voice. In the storm clouds He is deepening your range. In the rain showers He is sweetening your melody. In the cold He is giving your notes expression. And as you pass at times from hope to fear, He is perfecting the message of your lyrics.

George Matheson

May 31

You will come to the grave in full vigor, like sheaves gathered in season. (Job 5:26)

When the sun finally drops below the horizon in the early evening, evidence of its work remains for some time. The skies continue to glow for a full hour after its departure. In the same way, when a good or a great person's life comes to its final sunset, the skies of this world are illuminated until long after he is out of view. Such a person does not die from this world, for when he departs he leaves much of himself behind—and being dead, he still speaks.

Henry Ward Beecher

When Victor Hugo was more than eighty years old, he expressed his faith in this beautiful way: “Within my soul I feel the evidence of my future life. I am like a forest that has been cut down more than once, yet the new growth has more life than ever. I am always rising toward the sky, with the sun shining down on my head. The earth provides abundant sap for me, but heaven lights my way to worlds unknown.

“Why is my soul becoming brighter as my body begins to fail? Winter may be filling my head, but an eternal spring rises from my heart. At this late hour of my life, I smell the fragrance of lilacs, violets, and roses, just as I did when I was twenty. And the closer I

來」的才能唱這首歌。毫無疑問這是一首勝利之歌，一首讚美基督釋放我們之勝利的詩歌。然而凱旋和自由的意味產生自我們過往被束縛的記憶。只有十字架上的子民會被裝備好來學唱這歌。

你這生是要接受來自你天父的音樂訓練。你的天父正訓練你天使們都唱不到的部分，祂的學院是憂傷的學校。祂差來憂傷是來教育你，為的是給你提供正確的訓練來成為祂天上合唱團的一員。

祂在最黝黑的晚上為你譜寫歌兒，在幽谷中調校你的聲音，在暴風的雨雲中擴闊你的音域，在雨露中潤飾你的旋律，在寒冷中為你的音符加強表達力。當你有時從盼望中急轉成為驚恐時，祂為你的歌詞內容改良至力臻完美。

喬治·馬得勝

五月三十一日

「你必壽高年邁才歸墳墓，好像禾捆到時收藏。」（伯5:26）

當太陽終於在暮初降至水平線時，它工作的果效仍會維持一段時間，在它離去後天空仍繼續放光一整小時；同樣地當一個善良偉人的生命至終日落時，這世界的天空仍會被照亮，直至他的踪影消失久已。這樣的人不是從這世上死去，因為當他離去時，他把自己很多東西都留下了。雖死，仍在說話。

亨利·華德·比查

當維克多·雨果八十多歲時以這美麗的方式表述他的信心：「在我的靈魂中有我未來生命的明證。我就像一個曾被人砍伐多次的森林，然而新生的生命比以往更多。我常升高天，太陽在我頭下照耀，地土給我提供樹液，但天上的亮光照明我往不知世界的路徑。」

「為甚麼我的身體開始衰敗時我的生命更光亮？儘管我滿頭冬天，但永恆的春天從我心中升起。在這年暮中，我聞到了丁香、紫羅蘭和玫瑰的芬芳，就與我二十歲時無異

come to the end of my journey, the more clearly I hear the immortal symphonies of eternal worlds inviting me to come. It is awe-inspiring yet profoundly simple.”

June 1

He said, “This is the resting place, let the weary rest”; and, “This is the place of repose” —but they would not listen. (Isaiah 28:12)

Why do you worry? What possible use does your worrying serve? Be quiet, dear soul—God is the Master!

Do you think all the commotion and the uproar of this life is evidence that God has left His throne? He has not! His mighty steeds rush furiously ahead, and His chariots are the storms themselves. But the horses have bridles, and it is God who holds the reins, guiding the chariots as He wills!

Our God Jehovah is still the Master! Believe this and you will have peace. “Don’t be afraid” (Matt. 14:27).

Charles H. Spurgeon

Don’t give in to despair. It is a dangerous temptation, because our Adversary has refined it to the point that it is quite subtle. Hopelessness constricts and withers the heart, rendering it unable to sense God’s blessings and grace. It also causes you to exaggerate the adversities of life and makes your burdens seem too heavy for you to bear. Yet God’s plans for you, and His ways of bringing about His plans, are infinitely wise.

Madame Guyon

June 2

Against all hope, Abraham in hope believed....Without weakening in his faith. (Romans 4:18-19)

That great man of faith George Mueller once made to a gentleman who had asked him the best way to have strong faith: “The only way to know strong faith is to endure great trials. I have learned my faith by standing firm through severe testings.”

If you are enduring great afflictions right now, you are at the source of the strongest faith. God will teach you during these dark hours to have the most powerful bond to His throne you could ever know, if you will only submit.

“Don’t be afraid; just believe” (Mark 5:36). “When I am afraid, I will trust in you” (Ps. 56:3). Then you will

。我越來到旅程的盡頭，越發清晰得聽邀請我去到永恆世界的不朽樂章，這令人敬畏卻極之顯淺。」

六月一日

「祂曾對他們說：你們要使疲乏人得安息，這樣才得安息，才得舒暢。他們卻不肯聽。」(賽 28:12)

你為何憂慮呢？你的憂慮能提供甚麼可能的用處麼？親愛的魂啊，要安靜，神才是主！

你是否以生命中的一切騷動和喧鬧為神離開祂寶座的證據？祂沒有離開！祂剛毅的駿馬猛烈衝前，祂的戰車本身就是暴風。但這些馬匹是有轡頭的，握住韁繩的是神，祂的旨意引導着戰車前行！

我們的神耶和華仍然是主！相信這個能使你有平安。「不要怕。」(太 14:27)

司布真

不要讓步給絕望，這是危險的試誘，因為我們的仇敵把它美化得頗為微妙。無望使人心受阻礙和畏縮，作出不能感受神的祝福和恩典的表現。這也使你誇大人生的不幸和令你的重擔看似太重而叫你無法承當。然而神為你而作的計劃和引來祂計劃的方法都是絕頂智慧的。

蓋恩夫人

六月二日

「他在無可指望的時候，因信仍有指望.....他的信心還是不軟弱。」(羅 4:18-19)

信心偉人喬治·慕勒向一個上流人士問及如何得着強大信心之法而作的陳述：「唯一認識強大信心的方法是要忍受大試煉。我是在嚴峻試煉中站穩來學習信心的。」

你若在此時忍受着極大的痛苦，你是來到最強大之信的源頭。神必會在這黑暗時刻中教導你得着你從未能認識與祂寶座最強而有力的結連，條件是你只要降服。

「不要怕，只要信。」(可 5:36)「我懼怕的時候要倚靠祢。」(

be able to thank God for His school of sorrow that became for you the school of faith.

A. B. Simpson

God's greatest gifts come through great pain. For the temple of God to be built, David had to bear intense afflictions. And for the gospel of grace to be extricated from Jewish tradition, Paul's life had to be one long agony.

June 3

Let us go over to the other side. (Mark 4:35)

Even though we follow Christ's command, we should not expect to escape the storm. In their distress, they cried out for Christ's assistance.

Christ may delay coming to us during our times of distress, but it is simply so our faith may be tested and strengthened. His purpose is also that our prayers will be more powerful, our desire for deliverance will be greater, and when deliverance finally comes we will appreciate it more fully.

Gently rebuking His disciples, Christ asked, "Why are you so afraid? Do you still have no faith?" (v. 40). In effect, He was saying, "Why didn't you face the storm victoriously and shout to the raging winds and rolling waves, 'You cannot harm us, for Christ, the mighty Savior, is on board'?"

We will never know our level of genuine faith until it is tested in a fierce storm, and that is why our Savior is on board.

If you are ever to "be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power" (Eph. 6:10), your strength will be born during a storm.

selected

June 4

All that night the Lord drove the sea back. (Exodus 14:21)

The real work of God for the children of Israel did not happen when they awoke that morning to find they could cross the Red Sea, but it occurred "all that night."

There may be a great work occurring in your life when things seem their darkest. You may see no evidence yet, but God is at work.

June 5

Ask the Lord your God for a sign, whether in the

詩56:3 你必能為神給你憂傷來學習信來感謝神。

宣信

神最大的恩賜是要經過大痛苦才會來到。為着建造神的殿，大衛必須忍受強烈的痛苦；為着使恩典的福音得擺脫猶太的傳統，保羅有的必須是一長長痛苦的生命。

六月三日

「我們渡到那邊去吧。」(可 4:35)

雖然我們是遵從基督命令的人，但不要以為可免於風暴。在危機中的他們呼喊祈求基督的幫助。

基督也許在我們遇上危難時延遲來到，為叫我們的信心得試驗和得鞏固。祂的目的也是叫我們的祈禱變得更有能力，我們對得解救的渴望更熱切，當解救終於來到時，我們的感激便更全心全意。

基督輕責門徒後，便問：「為甚麼膽怯，你們還沒有信心麼？」(可 4:40) 實際上祂是說：「你們何不勝利地面對風暴，向狂風和滾浪呼叫：『你不能傷害我們，因為大能的救主基督是在船上』呢？」

我們永不能認識我們的信心程度，除非受兇猛風暴的試煉，就是這原因我們的救主得在船上。

若你向來都「靠着主，倚賴他的大能大力，作剛強的人」(弗 6:10)，暴風便生成你的能力。

選

六月四日

「耶和華便用大東風，使海水一夜退去。」(出 14:21)

神為以色列民真正的工作不是發生在醒來發現他們能過紅海了的早晨，而是發生在那「一夜」。

在你的生命中也許有重大工作發生在事情看起來最黑暗時。你也許看不見證據，但神在作工。

六月五日

「你向耶和華你的神求一個兆頭，

deepest depths or in the highest heights. (Isaiah 7:11)

We must continue to pray and “wait for the Lord” (Isa. 8:17), until we hear the sound of His mighty rain.

It is not within our power to create the wind or to change its direction, but we can raise our sails to catch it when it comes. We do not create electricity, yet we can tap into it with a wire that will conduct it, allowing it to work. We do not control God’s Spirit, but we can place ourselves before the Lord out of obedience to what He has called us to do, and we will come under the influence and power of His mighty breath.

selected

Can’t the same great wonders be done today that were done many years ago? Where is the God of Elijah? He is waiting for today’s Elijah to call on Him.

A simple prayer from our mouths will be powerful enough to call down from heaven God’s gracious dew or the melting fire of His Spirit, just as the words from Elijah’s mouth called down literal rain and fire. All that is required is to speak the words with the same complete assurance of faith with which he spoke.

Dr. Goulburn, Dean of Norwich

June 6

Watch and pray so that you will not fall into temptation. (Matthew 26:41)

Dear friend, never go out into the danger of the world without praying first. There is always a temptation to shorten your time in prayer. After a difficult day of work, when you kneel at night to pray with tired eyes, do not use your drowsiness as an excuse to resign yourself to early rest. Then when the morning breaks and you realize you have overslept, resist the temptation to skip your early devotion or to hurry through it.

Frederick William Robertson

Jesus, the omnipotent Son of God, felt it necessary to rise each morning before dawn to pour out His heart to His Father in prayer. Should we not feel even more compelled to pray to Him who is the giver of “every good and perfect gift” (James 1:17) and who has promised to provide whatever we need?

selected

或求顯在深處·或求顯在高處。(賽 7:11)

我們必須繼續祈禱和「等候……耶和華」(賽 8:17)·直至聽到祂浩瀚恩雨之響聲。

創造風和改變方向不是我們能力範圍之內，但我們可以當風來到時揚帆來迎接它。我們不能創造電力，但用一條導電的電線就能搭上電，用電力來作工了。我們不能控制神的靈，但我們可以用順服把自己放在神面去作祂召我們所作之工，就必能來到大能噴吐的能力和影響力底下。

選

多年前所作的偉大奇事今天不也能作？以利亞的神在那裏？祂正等待今天的以利亞求告祂。

出於我們口中的簡單祈禱能力之大足以求來神恩典的天露或祂聖靈融化之火，如同出於以利亞口中的祈禱求來字面的雨和火。這一切所需的是以祂相同完整的確信來說出那些話吧了。

諾域治主教高賓博士

六月六日

「總要儆醒禱告，免得入了迷惑。」(太 26:41)

親愛的朋友，沒有祈禱以先永不要外出到危險的世界去。總有試探來縮短你祈禱的時間。當一天辛勞工作之後，以疲倦的眼跪下晚禱時，不要以昏昏欲睡作為藉口叫自己逃避祈禱來早點休息。之後當朝早睡來，你知道睡過頭時，要逃避略過靈修或匆匆了事的試煉。

弗雷德裏克·威廉·魯賓斯坦

全能神的兒子耶穌感到有需要，在黎明前的清晨向祂的父傾心吐意禱告。我們豈不更需向這位給予我們「各樣美善的恩賜，和各樣全備的賞賜」(雅1:17)和承諾供應我們凡百所需的祂迫切禱告？

選

June 7

Where is God my Maker, who gives songs in the night? (Job 35:10)

When sleepless happens, why not ask the Holy Spirit to fix your thoughts on God, your Maker, and believe He can fill those lonely, dreary nights with song?

Is your night one of bereavement? Focusing on God often causes Him to draw near to your grieving heart, bringing you the assurance that He needs the one who has died. The Lord will assure you He has called the eager, enthusiastic spirit of your departed loved one to stand with the invisible yet liberated, living, and radiant multitude. And as this thought enters your mind, along with the knowledge that your loved one is engaged in a great heavenly mission, a song begins in your heart.

Is your night one of discouragement or failure, whether real or imagined? Do you feel as if no one understands you, and your friends have pushed you aside? Take heart: your Maker “will come near to you” (James 4:8) and give you a song—a song of hope, which will be harmonious with the strong, resonant music of His providence. Be ready to sing the song your Maker imparts to you.

selected

The strength of a ship is only fully demonstrated when it faces a hurricane, and the power of the gospel can only be fully exhibited when a Christian is subjected to some fiery trial. We must understand that for God to give “songs in the night,” He must first make it night.

Nathaniel William Taylor

June 8

Everyone born of God overcomes the world. This is the victory that has overcome the world, even our faith. (1 John 5:4)

Satan is far from retiring from his work of attempting to deceive and destroy God’s children. At each milestone in your life, it is wise to check the temperature of your experience in order to be keenly aware of the surrounding conditions.

Faith can change any situation, no matter how dark or difficult. Lifting your heart to God in a moment of genuine faith in Him can quickly alter your circumstances. God is still on His throne, and He can

六月七日

「造我的神在哪裏？祂使人夜間歌唱。」(伯 35:10)

當睡不着覺時，你為何不求聖靈來使你的心思集中在神你的創造者身上，相信祂能把這些孤單和淒涼的晚上充滿歌唱？

這是否你的一個喪親的晚上？集中思想神常就近你憂傷的心靈，帶給你這親人死所需的確據。主必向你保證祂已召喚你所愛那離去之人的熱心和熱切的靈與那些不可見卻是被釋放得自由、活着和光輝之群眾站在一起。當這思想並你對你所愛者有分於天上總會的認識進入你的心靈時，你心中便會有歌聲開始響起了。

這是否一個無論是真實或是你幻想出來沮喪或失敗的晚上？你是否感到無人明白你，被朋友們離棄？當振作，你的創造者「必親近你們」(雅 4:8)，和給你一首歌，一首盼望之歌，與祂旨意中強而有力並共鳴的音樂和諧一致。當預備好唱頌你的創造者給你的這首歌。

選

一艘船隻的動力只有它面對颶風時才全然展示，福音的能力也只有在基督徒遭受嚴峻考驗時才能充分展露。我們定須明白神給我們「夜間歌唱」之先，祂必要給我們夜晚。

尼坦尼爾·威廉·泰萊

六月八日

「因為凡從神生的，就勝過世界。使我們勝了世界的，就是我們的信心。」(約壹 5:4)

撒但決不會在他試圖欺哄和破壞神兒女的工作上罷休。在你人生的每個里程碑上為了能敏銳地察覺周遭來檢視你靈性感受上的緊張程度是智慧之舉。

信心能改變任何處境，無論如何黑暗或困難。用真實信入祂裏頭的信來向神提起你的心，你便能迅速改換你的處境。神仍坐着為王，

turn defeat into victory in a split second, if we will only trust Him.

When you have faith, you need never retreat. You can stop the Enemy wherever you encounter him.

Marshal Ferdinand Foch

June 9

Trust in the Lord and do good; dwell in the land and enjoy safe pasture. (Psalm 37:3)

I once met a poor woman who earned a meager living through hard domestic labor but was a joyful, triumphant Christian. Another Christian lady, who was quite sullen, said to her one day, "Nancy, I understand your happiness today, but I would think your future prospects would sober you. Suppose, for instance, you experience a time of illness and are unable to work. Or suppose your present employers move away, and you cannot find work elsewhere. Or suppose—"

"Stop!" cried Nancy. "I never 'suppose.' 'The Lord is my shepherd, I shall not be in want' [Ps. 23:1].

"Be content with what you have, because God has said, 'Never will I leave you; never will I forsake you.' So we say with confidence, 'The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?'" (Heb. 13:5-6).

Hannah Whitall Smith

The eagle that soars at great altitudes does not worry about how it will cross a river.

selected

June 10

We know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him, who have been called according to his purpose. (Romans 8:28)

Paul states this in the present tense: "God works." He does not say, "worked" or "will work." It is a continuing operation.

We also know from Scripture that God's "justice [is] like the great deep" (Ps. 36:6); at this very moment the angels in heaven, as they watch with folded wings the development of God's great plan, are undoubtedly proclaiming, "The Lord is righteous in all his ways and loving toward all he has made" (Ps. 145:17).

Then when God orchestrates "all things ... for the good," it is a beautiful blending. He requires many different colors, which individually may be quite drab,

祂能在片刻間轉敗為勝，只要我們能信靠祂。

有信時你永不需後退。無論何處遇見仇敵你也能夠制止他。

馬歇爾·費迪南·福熙

六月九日

「你當倚靠耶和華而行善。住在地上，以祂的信實為糧。」(詩 37:3)

一個貧窮的婦人過着家庭式操作困苦的茶淡飯生活，卻是一喜樂和得勝的基督徒。另一個愁眉不展的基督徒女士有一日跟她說：「南茜，我知你今天快樂，但想到你的未來境遇便替你憂心。舉一個例，假如你患病不能工作，或假如你現今的僱主遷走了，你在別處也找不到工作，又或者假如……」

「停！」南茜說：「我從不『假如』。耶和華是我的牧者，我必不至缺乏。」(詩23:1)

「你們……要以自己所有的為足，因為主曾說：我總不撇下你，也不丟棄你。所以我們可以放膽說：主是幫助我的，我必不懼怕。人能把我怎麼樣呢？」(來13:5-6)

漢娜·韋滔·史勿夫

在極高處飛翔的鷹鳥從不擔憂如何能渡過河那邊去。

選

六月十日

「我們曉得萬事都互相效力，叫愛神的人得益處，就是按祂旨意被召的人。」(羅 8:28)

保羅說這時是用上現在式的：「神作」。他不是說「作了」，或「將會作」。這是一持續的運作。

聖經告訴我們「祢的公義，好像高山。」(詩36:6)當天使摺起翅膀來注視神偉大計劃的發展時，他們確切地宣告：「耶和華在祂一切所行的，無不公義。在祂一切所作的，都有慈愛。」(詩145:17)

之後神把「萬事」和「得益處」美麗地融合。祂需要很多不同也許每個頗為單調的顏料，但能編繪

to weave into the harmonious pattern. Separate tones, notes, and even discords are required to compose melodious musical anthems; a piece of machinery requires many separate wheels, parts, and connections. One part from a machine may be useless, or one note from an anthem may never be considered beautiful, but taken together, combined, and completed, they lead to perfect balance and harmony.

We can learn a lesson of faith from this: “You do not realize now what I am doing, but later you will understand” (John 13:7).

J. R. Macduff

In a thousand trials, it is not just five hundred of them that work “for the good” of the believer, but nine hundred and ninety-nine, plus one.

George Mueller

June 11

The servant of the Lord must ... be gentle. (2 Timothy 2:24 KJV)

The gifts of “the fruit of the Spirit” (Gal. 5:22) do not automatically become evident in our lives. Every further step of spiritual growth in God’s grace must be preceded by acknowledging our lack of a godly attribute and then by exhibiting a prayerful determination to obtain it.

However, very few Christians are willing to endure the suffering through which complete gentleness is obtained. We must die to ourselves before we are turned into gentleness, and our crucifixion involves suffering. It will mean experiencing genuine brokenness and a crushing of self, which will be used to afflict the heart and conquer the mind.

Yet the heartstrings of their old nature have not been broken, and their unyielding character, which they inherited from Adam, has not been ground to powder. Their soul has not throbbed with the lonely, gushing groans of Gethsemane. Having no scars from their death on Calvary, they will exhibit nothing of the soft, sweet, gentle, restful, victorious, overflowing, and triumphant life that flows like a spring morning from an empty tomb.

G. D. W.

And much grace was upon them all. Acts 4:33

June 12

成調和的圖案。不協和的獨立曲調和音符需用來撰寫旋律優美的讚歌；一件機器需要很多獨立的齒輪、部件和連接物。機器的一個部件可能是無用的，一首讚歌的一個音符永不會被看為美麗的，但當合在一起，併合完成時，他們便會帶來完美的平衡與調和。

我們從以下經文可能得着信心的教訓：「我所作的，你如今不知道，後來必明白。」(約13:7)

J.R.麥道夫

在一千項試煉中，不是只有五百項會生發叫信徒「得益處」之效力的，而是九百九十九項加一項。

慕勒

六月十一日

「主的僕人……要溫溫和和。」(提後 2:24)

「聖靈所結的果子」(加 5:22)不會自動成為我們生命的證據。在神恩典中每進一步的屬靈生長必須先承認我們缺乏敬虔的屬性，因而展示一祈禱的決定來得着它。

但是很少基督徒樂意藉着忍受痛苦來得着完全的溫和。我們定須向我們自己死才叫我們變成溫和，而我們的釘十字架是包括受苦的，它是說到經驗真正己的破碎，這破碎是用來使心受折磨和思想被征服的。

然而他們舊天性的心弦仍未破斷，他們承繼自亞當未降服的品格仍未碾碎成粉。他們的生命仍未被客西馬尼孤寂和迸發的呻吟所悸動。沒有來自他們在加略山死亡的疤痕，他們便不能展示那溫柔、甜美、溫和、安穩、得勝、滿溢和勝利的生命，是在一個春天的早晨從一空墳墓所流溢出來的。

G.D.W.

「使徒大有能力。」(徒 4:33)

六月十二日

In him you have been enriched in every way. (1 Corinthians 1:5)

Have you ever seen people who through some disaster were driven to great times of prayer? And have you noticed that once the disaster was long forgotten, a spiritual sweetness remained that warmed their souls?

For many weeks after the storm, the fields raised their hands, full of heavenly, fragrant flowers, toward the sky. And all summer long the grass was greener, the streams were filled, and the trees, because of their lush foliage, cast a more restful shade. All this—because the storm had come.

All this—even though the rest of the earth had long forgotten the storm, its rainbows, and its rain.

Theodore Parker

God may not give us an easy journey to the Promised Land, but He will give us a safe one.

Horatius Bonar

It was a storm that led to the discovery of the gold mines in India. Have we not seen storms drive people to the discovery of the priceless mines of the love of God in Christ?

June 13

My peace I give you. (John 14:27)

Two painters were once asked to paint a picture illustrating his own idea of rest. The first chose for his scene a quiet, lonely lake, nestled among mountains far away. The second, using swift, broad strokes on his canvas, painted a thundering waterfall. Beneath the falls grew a fragile birch tree, bending over the foam. On its branches, nearly wet with the spray from the falls, sat a robin on its nest.

The first painting was simply a picture of stagnation and inactivity. The second, however, depicted rest. Outwardly, Christ endured one of the most troubled lives ever lived. Storms and turmoil, turmoil and storms—wave after wave broke over Him until His worn body was laid in the tomb. Yet His inner life was as smooth as a sea of glass, and a great calm was always there.

Anyone could have gone to Him at any time and found rest. Even as the human bloodhounds were dogging Him in the streets of Jerusalem, He turned to His disciples, offering them a final legacy: “My peace.”

「你們在祂裏面凡事富足。」(林前 1:5)

你曾否見過有人經過一些苦難後驅使他們進入偉大的祈禱時刻麼？你曾否留意到那苦難雖久被忘記了，但那警告他們生命的屬靈甜美仍然存留呢？

風暴過後幾個星期，田野以滿是屬天和芬芳的花兒來向天空舉起他們的手。整個長長的夏日葉子更綠，水滿溪流，樹木因他們青蔥的葉子投下更憩息的蔭涼，這一切全因風暴已然過去。

雖則世上別處都久已忘記那風暴，但它的彩虹和雨露還在。

西奧多·帕克

神也許不給我們往應許地的輕鬆路，但必會給與安全之路。

可拉蒂斯·波拿

有一場風暴帶來印度一金礦的發現，你豈不曾見過風暴驅使人來發現在基督裏神之愛這無價的寶藏麼？

六月十三日

「我留下平安給你們。」(約 14:27)

有一次兩個畫家被要求畫一幅展示他們對平安意念的畫。首位選擇畫上一遠離塵囂的山間幽靜湖景；第二位卻用快而廣的筆觸在畫布上畫上氣勢磅礴的瀑布，底下長有一株彎枝入水中泡沫脆弱的白樺樹，樹枝上有一隻幾乎被瀑布水氣弄濕的知更鳥坐在牠的巢上。

第一位畫家畫的只是一幅靜止無活動的畫作，而第二位則把平安刻畫出來。基督外在所忍受的是世人所活出其中最困難的生命，風暴騷動，騷動風暴，浪接浪湧向祂直至祂虧損的身軀被安放在墳墓裏；然而祂內裏的生命卻平如海面的一面鏡子，那裏總是平靜安穩。

任何人隨時到祂那兒必得安息，甚至當探子在耶路撒冷街道上跟蹤他時，祂回身向着門徒，給他們那最後的餽贈：「我的平安」。平

Rest is not some holy feeling that comes upon us in church. It is a state of calm rising from a heart deeply and firmly established in God.

Henry Drummond

June 14

I have prayed for you ... that your faith may not fail.
(Luke 22:32)

Faith is the communication link between heaven and earth. And while we are still speaking, "He hears us" (1 John 5:14). My soul will find refuge by leaning in faith upon God. But without faith, I call to Him in vain, for faith is the only road between my soul and heaven.

Faith links me to Holy God and clothes me with the power of Jehovah. Faith insures me that each of His attributes will be used in my defense, helping me to defy the hosts of hell. It causes me to march triumphantly over the necks of my enemies. So without faith, how can I receive anything from the Lord?

"Everything is possible for him who believes"
(Mark 9:23).

Charles H. Spurgeon

"The promise comes by FAITH, so that it may ... be GUARANTEED" (Rom. 4:16).

Faith honors God, and God honors faith.

June 15

God has made me fruitful in the land of my suffering. (Genesis 41:52)

Perhaps you are undergoing some trial as God's child, and you are saying to Him, "O God, it is raining very hard on me tonight, and this test seems beyond my power to endure. Disappointments are pouring in, washing away and utterly defeating my chosen plans."

You are suffering through these tests, but know that God sees sweet flowers of faith springing up in your life beneath these very trials. You try to escape the pain, yet God sees tender compassion for other sufferers finding birth in your soul. Your heart winces at the pain of heavy grief, but God sees the sorrow deepening and enriching your life.

No, my friend, it is not raining afflictions on you. It is raining tenderness, love, compassion, patience, and a thousand other flowers and fruits of the blessed Holy

安不是當我們來到教堂時而有的神聖感覺，而是深深牢靠建基於神時心中所冒起的安穩狀態。

亨利·斟民

六月十四日

「我已經為你祈求，叫你不至於失了信心。」(路 22:32)

信心是天與地之間的聯繫。當我們仍在說話時，「祂就聽我們」(約壹 5:14)。藉信倚靠神時，我的靈魂必找到藏身處；若沒有信，我對祂呼求也枉然。

信叫我聯上聖潔的神，也賦與我耶和華神的能力。信確保我得着每一樣祂的屬性，用來作為我的防禦，幫助我來對抗地獄的軍隊。它使我勝利地踏過我仇敵的頸項。因此若沒有信，我怎能得着從主而來的任何東西呢？

「你若能信，在信的人，凡事都能。」(可 9:23)

司布真

「這應許是本乎信，.....也歸給.....凡信的人。」(羅 4:16)

信尊榮神，而神也尊榮信。

六月十五日

「神使我在受苦的地方昌盛。」(創 41:52)

也許作為神兒女的你正經受試煉，你正向祂說：「神啊，今晚向我下的雨十分大，這試煉似乎是我力不能勝的。失望傾倒入來，沖走和全然破壞我揀選的計劃。」

你是在試煉中受苦，但當知道神看的是你的生命經受試煉所長出甜美的信心花兒。你嘗試逃避痛苦，但神看的是受苦的人在你生命中得見你的慈悲憐憫。你的心因着極大憂傷之痛苦下而畏縮，但神看的是這憂傷加深和豐富你的生命。

朋友啊，降在你身上的不是痛苦，而是溫柔、愛、同情、忍耐和千百樣可稱頌聖靈的花果。他們為

Spirit. And they are bringing to your life spiritual enrichment that all the prosperity and ease of this world could never produce in your innermost being.

J. M. M.

June 16

My hope comes from Him. (Psalm 62:5)

Every prayer of the Christian, whether for temporal or spiritual blessings, will be fully answered if it meets certain biblical requirements. It must be prayed in faith and in accordance with God's will. It must rely on God's promise, be offered up in the name of Jesus Christ, and be prayed under the influence of the Holy Spirit.

Since we see in Scripture that Jesus Christ never rejected even a single petitioner who came to Him, we can believe that no prayer made in His name will be in vain.

The answer to our prayer may be coming, although we may not discern its approach.

Bickersteth

Delayed answers to prayer are not only trials of faith; they also give us opportunities to honor God through our steadfast confidence in Him even when facing the apparent denial of our request.

Charles H. Spurgeon

June 17

Then there came a voice from above the expanse over their heads as they stood with lowered wings. (Ezekiel 1:25)

People often ask, "How can I hear the voice of the Lord?" This is the secret: these "living creatures" (v. 5) heard "there came a voice ... as they stood with lowered wings."

Do you ever sit, or even kneel, before the Lord and yet are conscious of a fluttering in your spirit? If so, you are not exhibiting a sense of genuine stillness while in His presence.

Imagine the calm, the rest, and the peace that will come as we wait in His presence until we hear from Him! Then, and only then, we too may speed "back and forth like flashes of lightning" (v. 14), going directly to "wherever the spirit would go" (v. 20).

June 18

Lift up the hands which hang down, and the feeble

你的生命帶來所有這世上一切的順遂和快意也永不能在你最深處所能產生的屬靈豐盛。

J.M.M.

六月十六日

「我的盼望是從祂而來。」(詩 62:5)

基督徒所祈求無論是今世或屬靈的每個祝福，若符合某些聖經要求，必會得着完全的垂聽。這須用信來祈禱，且要依照神的旨意。它須倚賴神的應許，奉耶穌基督之名，和在聖靈的影響下來祈求的。

我們從聖經中得見耶穌基督連一個來到祂面前的祈求者也不會拒絕，我們便可相信沒有一個奉祂名之祈禱是會徒然而作的。

我們祈禱的回應正要來到，雖然我們看不出它的進程。

碧加士得

祈禱的遲延垂聽不止試煉信心，也給我們機會藉我們對祂堅定信心上來尊榮神，那怕在我們面前的表面上是對我們請求上的說不。

司布真

六月十七日

「在他們頭以上的穹蒼之上有聲音。他們站住的時候，便將翅膀垂下。」(結 1:25)

人們常問：「我怎能聽見主的聲音？」秘訣就在於：當這些「活物」(結 1:5)「將翅膀垂下」時「在他們頭以上.....有聲音」。

你曾否在主面前坐下甚或跪下時意識到你靈的拍翼？若有，那麼你不是在祂同在時展示真正靜止的感覺。

想像我們在祂面前等待直至得聽見祂！那時，亦只有那時，我們也能迅速「往來奔走，好像電光一閃」(結 1:14)，「靈往哪裏去，.....就往那裏去」(結 1:20)。

六月十八日

「所以你們要把下垂的手，發酸的

knees; And make straight paths for your feet, lest that which is lame be turned out of the way; but let it rather be healed. (Hebrews 12:12-13 KJV)

We are tempted to walk around it. We would rather take the easy way than face it.

We tend to find many ways of walking around emergencies instead of walking straight through them.

God says, "Lift up the hands that hang down." March straight through the flood, and behold! The waters will divide, the Red Sea will open, the Jordan will part, and the Lord will lead you through to victory.

A. B. Simpson

June 19

Grain must be ground to make bread. (Isaiah 28:28)

Being a blessing of His often requires sorrow on our part. Yet even sorrow is not too high a price to pay for the privilege of touching other lives with Christ's blessings. The things that are most precious to us today have come to us through tears and pain.

J. R. Miller

God has made me as bread for His chosen ones, and if it is necessary for me to "be ground" in the teeth of lions in order to feed His children, then blessed be the name of the Lord.

Ignatius

Poverty, hardship, and misfortune have propelled many a life to moral heroism and spiritual greatness. Difficulties challenge our energy and our perseverance but bring the strongest qualities of the soul to life. God has chosen opposition as a catalyst to our faith and holy service.

Because he stood at the head of the class, enduring affliction while remaining obedient, Abraham's diploma is now inscribed with these words: "The Father of Faith."

Jacob, like wheat, suffered severe threshing and grinding. Joseph was beaten and bruised, and was forced to endure Potiphar's kitchen and Egypt's prison before coming to his throne.

David, hunted like an animal of prey through the mountains, was bruised, weary, and footsore, and thereby ground into bread for a kingdom. Paul could never have been bread for Caesar's household if he had not endured the bruising of being whipped and stoned.

腿，挺起來。也要為自己的腳把道路修直了，使瘸子不至走差路，反得痊愈。」(來 12:12-13)

我們被試探繞路而行，我們寧願走輕鬆之路而不去面對它。

我們傾向找出很多繞過危急關頭的路，而不是直行而過。

神說：「把下垂的手.....挺起來。」直向洪水操去和舉目來看！水必分開，紅海必開路，約但河會分開，主必會領你經過直至勝利。

宣信

六月十九日

「作餅的糧食是用磨磨碎。」(賽 28:28)

祂的祝福常需要我們付上憂傷的本分。然而所付憂傷的代價也不足以作為觸動他人生命的基督恩福。今天臨到我們最珍貴的東西是藉着眼淚和痛苦而來的。

J.R.米勒

神把我作成祂選民的糧食，若為了要餵養祂的子民而有需要我在獅子的口中「磨碎」時，那麼就願祂的名得榮耀。

依格那丟

窮乏、困難和不幸曾驅使很多生命帶來精神上的英雄氣魄和屬靈偉大。困難向我們的能力和堅毅挑戰，卻也為魂的最高品質帶來生命。神也選用反對作為我們的信和神聖事奉的催化劑。

亞伯拉罕因着忍受苦難而仍保持順服，所以如今站在全班面前，手持獎狀，上頭寫着「信心之父」。

雅各像麥子般經受嚴峻的脫粒和碾碎。約瑟被打和搥碎，被逼忍受波提乏之廚役和埃及的牢籠，才能最終來到王座前。

大衛在山間像獵物般被追捕，受損害、疲憊和赤足，為要來的國度被磨成粉。保羅若未曾忍受被鞭打和拋石之損害，就永不能成為該撒家的糧食，不會被磨成羅馬御營

He was ground into fine flour for the Roman royal family.

June 20

Whether you turn to the right or to the left, your ears will hear a voice behind you, saying, "This is the way; walk in it." (Isaiah 30:21)

When we have doubts or are facing difficulties, we should calm ourselves in the sacred stillness of God's presence, study His Word for guidance, and with true devotion focus our attention on Him. We should lift our nature into the pure light radiating from His face, having an eagerness to know only what God our Lord will determine for us. Soon He will reveal by His secret counsel a distinct and unmistakable sense of His direction.

A new believer should wait for circumstances to also confirm what God is revealing. Yet Christians who have had many experiences in their walk with Him know the great value of secret fellowship with the Lord as a means of discerning His will.

Take your question to God and receive guidance from either the light of His smile or the cloud of His refusal. You must get alone with Him, where the lights and the darkens of this world cannot interfere and where the opinions of others cannot reach you. You must also have the courage to wait in silent expectation, even when everyone around you is insisting on an immediate decision or action. If you will do these things, the will of God will become clear to you. And you will have a deeper concept of who He is, having more insight into His nature and His heart of love.

David

June 21

The people heard that he had come home. (Mark 2:1)

The adult coral invertebrates, known as polyps, work underwater constructing coral reefs. They do so never even imagining they are building the foundation of a new island, which will someday support plants and animals and will be a home where the children of God will be born and equipped for eternal glory as "co-heirs with Christ" (Rom. 8:17).

Beloved, if your place in God's army is hidden and secluded, do not grumble and complain. Do not seek to run from His will and the circumstances in which He has

全軍的精細麵粉。

六月二十日

「你或向左，或向右，你必聽見後邊有聲音說：這是正路，要行在其間。」(賽 30:21)

當我們面對困難時，我們應在神同在的神聖安穩中平靜我們自己，研讀聖經尋求引導，以真實的誠心來聚焦注目祂。我們當把我們的天性開敞在祂臉面所散發的光中，存殷切的心來認識我們的主神，決意為我們作的是甚麼。很快祂必會將祂穩秘的勸導揭示祂的指引，是獨特和不會感到出錯的。

對於一個新信徒亦應等待環境也來作為神在某事上顯明的確據。然而曾多有經驗與主同行的基督徒們知道，與主有穩秘的相交是在辨別神旨意上有重大價值的。

將你的問題帶到神面前，從祂微笑的光中或是祂拒絕的雲中來獲得指引。你必須與祂獨處，在那裏這世界的光與暗都不能干擾，別人的意見亦不能觸碰到你。就算當每個圍繞你的人堅持要得一立時的決定或行動時，你也必須有勇氣來在寂靜的期待中等待，你若能作這些，神的旨意於你便會變得清晰，你亦必會得着對祂的所是有一更深入的概念，對於祂的本性和祂愛之心有更多的看見。

大衛

六月二十一日

「人聽見他在房子裏，」(可 2:1)

成長珊瑚無脊椎動物珊瑚蟲在水底築成珊瑚礁。他們從沒想到正在建築一新海島的根基，這海島有朝一日支托着很多動植物，也成為神兒女的家，他們為着永恆榮耀的緣故在那裏出生，被裝備成「和基督同作後嗣」(羅 8:17)。

親愛的啊，你在神的軍隊中的位置若是隱藏和偏僻的，不要咕噥和埋怨。不要試圖逃離祂的旨意和

placed you. He is looking for those who are willing to serve in places hidden from the sight of others, yet in full view of heaven, and who are sustained by the Holy Spirit.

selected

June 22

Love covers over all wrongs. (Proverbs 10:12)

Follow the way of love. (1 Corinthians 14:1 [also see 1 Corinthians 13:7-13])

A precious child of God wrote. "Waves of cruel injustice were sweeping over me, and the covering of love seemed to have been unknowingly removed from my heart. In great agony I cried to God for the power to obey His admonition, 'Love covers over all wrongs.'

"Immediately His Spirit began to work the power into me that ultimately brought about forgetfulness. I mentally dug a grave, deliberately throwing the dirt out until the hole was very deep. With sorrow, I lowered the offense that had wounded me into the grave and quickly shoveled the soil over it. Then I carefully covered the hole with green sod, planted beautiful white roses and forget-me-nots on top, and briskly walked away.

"Suddenly restful sleep came to me. And the wound that had seemed so deadly was healed without a scar. God's love has covered so completely that today I cannot remember what caused my grief."

June 23

Peter got down out of the boat, walked on the water and came toward Jesus. But when he saw the wind, he was afraid and, beginning to sink, cried out, "Lord, save me!" (Matthew 14:29-30)

John Bunyan said that Peter did have a little faith, even in the midst of his doubts. In spite of crying out in fear, it was by getting out of the boat and walking that he got to Jesus.

In this passage of Scripture, we see that Peter's sight was actually a hindrance. Once he had stepped out of the boat, the waves were none of his business. His only concern should have been the path of light shining across the darkness from Christ Himself. Even the glow of a kingdom ten times brighter than that of ancient Egypt should not have diverted Peter's eyes.

When the Lord calls you to come across the water, step out with confidence and joy. And never glance

祂放你所在的環境。祂是尋找那些願意在別人看不見隱藏之處來事奉的，然而卻是天上全然看見的，他們是聖靈所維持的。

選

六月二十二日

「愛能遮掩一切過錯。」(箴 10:12)

「你們要追求愛。」(林前 14:1)(同時參閱林前 13:7-13)

一個神寶貴的孩子寫道：「不公義的殘酷浪潮向來湧掃而來，愛的遮蓋無明地從我心中被除去。在極大的痛苦下我向神呼求能力來遵行祂『愛能遮掩一切過錯』的忠告。」

「立時祂的靈開始將能力作在我身上，至終帶來寬恕。我心智上挖了一個墳墓，慎重地把泥土拋出，直至那洞穴十分深。我帶着憂傷將那傷害我的侮辱放進裏頭，便快地鏟泥來覆蓋它。之後我小心地用綠茵草皮來鋪在那洞穴上，在上面種植上美麗的白色玫瑰花和毋忘我，便輕快地走開了。」

「平靜的睡眠突然臨到我，那似乎致命的傷口已愈合，連疤痕也沒有。神的愛覆蓋得那麼完美，以致我記不起是甚麼使我憂傷了。」

六月二十三日

「彼得就從船上下去，在水面上走，要到耶穌那裏去。只因見風甚大，就害怕。將要沉下去，便喊着說：主阿，救我！」(太 14:29-30)

約翰·本仁說彼得雖然在疑惑中，儘管在驚懼中大聲呼喊，就在他離開小船而向耶穌走去這事上仍真的存有一點點的信。

在這經文中，我們知道彼得的所見到頭來成了一個難阻。他已踏出了小船，風浪不該是一回事了。他唯一的關注該是基督親自照越黑暗的光明之路。就算比古埃及光十倍的國度光芒亦不應能轉移彼得的視線。

當主叫喚你在水面上走時，該確信和歡欣地踏出去。不要把視線

away from Him for even a moment. You will not prevail by measuring the waves or grow strong by gauging the wind. Attempting to survey the danger may actually cause you to fall before it. Pausing at the difficulties will result in the waves breaking over your head.

“Lift up [your] eyes to the hills” (Ps. 121:1) and go forward. There is no other way.

June 24

Concerning the work of my hands command ye me. (Isaiah 45:11 KJV)

The Lord Jesus took this very approach with God when He said, “Father, I want those you have given me to be with me” (John 17:24). Joshua used it during the moment of his greatest victory, when he lifted his spear toward the setting sun and cried aloud, “O sun, stand still” (Josh. 10:12). Elijah employed it when he stopped the rain from heaven and started it again after three and a half years. Martin Luther followed it when, kneeling by his dying colleague, Philipp Melanchthon, he forbid death to take its victim.

“As Jesus and his disciples were leaving Jericho,” Jesus stopped and responded to two blind men who had called out to Him. “What do you want me to do for you?” (Matt. 20:29, 32). It was as though He said, “I am yours to command.”

Could we ever forget how Jesus yielded the key to His resources to the Greek woman from Syrian Phoenicia because of her reply to Him? In effect, He told her to help herself to all that she needed. (See Mark 7:24-30.)

“And I will do whatever you ask in my name” (John 14:13).

F. B. Meyer

June 25

The Lord said to Moses, “... Tell the Israelites to move on. Raise your staff and stretch out your hand over the sea.” (Exodus 14:15-16)

And as you envision the Red Sea’s mighty walls of water, separated by the outstretched hand of the Eternal in response to the faith of a single man, learn what God will do for His own.

Never dread any consequence resulting from absolute obedience to His command. Never fear the rough waters ahead, which through their proud contempt impede your progress. God is greater than the roar of raging water and the mighty waves of the

轉離祂，一刻也不該。先量浪和測風必不壯膽。嘗試勘探危險會事實上使你在勘探前便下墜。在困難前駐足的結果就是浪水沒頂。

「向山舉目」(詩 121:1)·向前走，別無他路。

六月二十四日

「你可命令我我手的工作。」(賽 45:11 英皇欽定本)

主耶穌以這取態來說「父阿，我在那裏，願祢所賜給我的人也同我在那裏」(約 17:24)。約書亞在最大勝利一刻就用上這個，他舉槍向着落下的太陽大聲呼喊：「日頭阿，你要停在基遍！」(書 10:12)。以利亞在命令天不下雨三年半後要天再降雨時就用上它。馬丁·路德跪在他垂死的同工菲力普·梅蘭希頓旁禁止死亡來索命時用上它。

「他們出耶利哥的時候……耶穌就站住，叫他們來，說：要我為你們作甚麼？」(太 20:29,32) 這就如同祂說「你們可命令我。」

我們又怎能忘記耶穌如何因着來自腓尼基的希臘女子對祂的回答而將祂資源的鑰匙都交與她手上？事實上祂是告訴她隨她所需的來支取。(參可 7:24-30)

「你們奉我的名，無論求甚麼，我必成就。」(約 14:13)

邁爾

六月二十五日

「耶和華對摩西說：……你吩咐以色列人往前走。你舉手向海伸杖，把水分開。」(出 14:15-16)

從你得見在永恆之手回應一人的信心下而伸展使紅海的龐大水牆被分開上來學懂神必會為祂自己的緣故來作事。

不要擔心絕對順順祂命令的後果，不要為前面洶湧的浪濤驚惶，這些浪濤想藉他們驕傲的蔑視來妨礙你的進程。神比這些怒濤吼聲和海中巨浪更偉大，「洪水氾濫之時

sea. "The Lord sits enthroned over the flood; the Lord is enthroned as King forever" (Ps. 29:10). A storm is simply the hem of His robe, the sign of His coming, and the evidence of His presence.

Dare to trust Him! Dare to follow Him! Then discover that the forces that blocked your progress and threatened your life become at His command the very materials He uses to build your street of freedom.

F. B. Meyer

June 26

What if some did not have faith? Will their lack of faith nullify God's faithfulness? (Romans 3:3)

Is it any wonder that we do not receive God's blessing after stumbling over His promise through unbelief? I am not saying that faith merits an answer or that we can work to earn it. But God Himself has made believing a condition of receiving, and the Giver has a sovereign right to choose His own terms for His gifts.

Samuel Hart

Unbelief continually asks, "How can this be possible?" It is always full of "how's," yet faith needs only one great answer to even ten thousand "how's." That answer is—GOD!

C. H. M.

No one accomplishes so much in so little time as when he or she is praying. If only ONE BELIEVER WITH TOTAL FAITH rises up, the history of the world will be changed.

A. E. McAdam

Prayer without faith quickly degenerates into an aimless routine or heartless hypocrisy. However, prayer with faith brings the omnipotence of God to the support of our petitions. It is better not to pray until your entire being responds to, and understands, the power of prayer. When genuine prayer is even whispered, earth and heaven, and the past and future, say, "Amen!"

This is the kind of prayer Christ prayed.

P. C. M.

Nothing lies beyond the reach of prayer except those things outside the will of God.

· 耶和華坐着為王。耶和華坐着為王，直到永遠。」(詩29:10)風暴只不過是祂衣袍的褶邊，是祂來到的徵兆，是祂同在的明證。

要敢於信靠祂！要敢於跟隨祂！之後你會發現阻礙你進程和威脅你生命的力量正是祂命令用來建造你自由之街道的材料。

邁爾

六月二十六日

「即便有不信的，這有何妨呢？難道他們的不信，就廢掉神的信麼？」(羅 3:3)

我們在因不信便在神的應許上絆跌而得不着祂的恩福上還有懸念麼？我不是說因信而配得着回應，或說我們可靠行為來賺取回應。但是神自己使信成為得着的條件，而那賜恩者有其至高的權柄來選擇祂自己給恩賜的條件。

撒母耳·赫特

不信繼續說「這怎樣可能？」總滿口「怎樣」，然而對信心來說就算一千個「怎樣」所需的就只是「神」這一大答案！

C.H.M.

無人的成就比任何男女藉那麼少時間的祈禱成就那麼大。只要有一人用十足的信心起來，世界的歷史將要被改寫。

A.E.麥亞當

沒有信心的祈禱會退化成為無目的的例行公事或無心的偽善；有信心的祈禱則將神的全能帶來作為我們代求的幫助。最好不要祈禱，除非你整個人對禱告的能力有所回應和了解。只要是真的祈禱，就算只是輕聲一說，天與地，過去和未來都一同說「阿們」。

這種就是基督所作的祈禱。

P.C.M.

禱告無遠弗屆，除非是神旨意以外的那些東西。

June 27

Summon your power, O God; show us your strength. (Psalm 68:28)

The Lord imparts to me the underlying strength of character that gives me the necessary energy and decision-making ability to live my life. He strengthens me “with power through his Spirit in [my] inner being” (Eph. 3:16).

“Your strength will equal your days” (Deut. 33:25)—my strength of will, affection, judgment, ideals, and achievement will last a lifetime.

“The Lord is my strength” (Ex. 15:2) to go on. He gives me the power to walk the long, straight, and level path, even when the monotonous way has no turns or curves offering pleasant surprises and when my spirit is depressed with the terrible drudgery.

“The Lord is my strength” to go up. He is my power to climb the straight and narrow path up the Hill of Difficulty, as Christian did in Pilgrim’s Progress, and not be afraid.

“The Lord is my strength” to go down. It is often once I leave the invigorating heights, where the wind and sunlight have surrounded me, and begin to descend to the more confining, humid, and stifling heat of the valley below that my heart grows faint. In fact, I recently heard someone say, referring to his own increasing physical frailty, “It is coming down that tires me most!”

“The Lord is my strength” to sit still. And what a difficult accomplishment this is! I often say to others during those times when I am compelled to be still, “If only I could do something!” I feel like the mother who stands by her sick child but is powerless to heal. What a severe test! Yet to do nothing except to sit still and wait requires tremendous strength.

“The Lord is my strength!” “Our competence comes from God” (2 Cor. 3:5).

from The Silver Lining

June 28

There before me was a door standing open in heaven. (Revelation 4:1)

The doors of heaven have been opened not only for John on the island of Patmos and Jacob dreaming a stairway, but also for many others. And in the world’s estimation, it seems as if their circumstances were

六月二十七日

「神啊，鼓起祢的權能，向我們顯明祢的能力。」(詩 68:28)

主給我品格中潛在的能力來活出生命所需的力量和果斷。祂「藉着祂的靈，叫(你們)心裏的力量剛強起來」(弗 3:16)。

「你的日子如何，你的力量也必如何。」(申 33:25) 我的意志、情感、判斷、理想和成就的力量必能持續一生之久。

以「耶和華是我的力量」(出 15:2) 來前行。祂給我能力走那既長直平穩的路徑。那怕路上沒有帶來歡快驚喜的轉角或彎位，那怕因着嚴嚴的苦活叫我的靈命消沉。

以「耶和華是我的力量」來向上行。祂是我如同《天路歷程》中的基督徒往那又直又窄的困難山上爬的能力，毫無懼怕。

以「耶和華是我的力量」來下行。當我一旦離開那令人心曠神怡有風和日光環繞我的高地後，總常是開始下行至較幽閉，潮濕和令人窒息的悶熱山谷中去，叫我心變得昏厥。我最近實在聽某人提及他的身體越來越差時說：「往下走是最叫我疲累的！」

以「耶和華是我的力量」來穩坐。能這樣何等困難！當我被迫要安定時，我常對他人說：「總想找點事作！」我感到就像站在患病孩子身旁又無力醫治的母親一樣。這是何等的一個嚴峻考驗！無事可作惟有穩坐等待需要極大力量。

得「耶和華是我的力量！」「乃是出於神。」(林後 3:5)

摘自《銀邊白雲》

六月二十八日

「此後，我觀看，見天上有門開了。」(啟 4:1)

天門不單曾為在拔摩島的約翰和夢見天梯的雅各而開，亦為無數的人，而世人似乎也以為他們的狀況絕對不像可接受這等的啟示。然

utterly unlikely to receive such revelations. Yet how often we have seen “a door standing open in heaven” for those who are prisoners and captives, for those who suffer from a chronic illness and are bound with iron chains of pain to a bed of sickness, for those who wander the earth in lonely isolation, and for those who are kept from the Lord’s house by the demands of home and family.

To seeing the open door, we must know what it is to be “in the Spirit” (Rev. 1:10). We must be “pure in heart” (Matt. 5:8) and obedient in faith. We must be willing to “consider everything a loss compared to the surpassing greatness of knowing Christ Jesus” (Phil. 3:8). Then once God is everything to us, so that “in Him we live and move and have our being” (Acts 17:28), the door to heaven will stand open before us as well.

from Daily Devotional Commentary

June 29

There we saw the giants. (Numbers 13:33 KJV)

Those who doubt said, “The land we explored devours those living in it. All the people we saw there are of great size” (v. 32). We should exhibit faith as did Joshua and Caleb, who said, “Do not be afraid ... , because we will swallow them up” (Num. 14:9).

selected

We encounter giants only when we are serving God and following Him.

The power of God actually brings conflict and struggles. Paul endured one long, difficult struggle with the Jews who were persecuting him. He faced fierce winds, poisonous snakes, and all the powers of earth and of hell. And finally, he narrowly escaped drowning, by swimming to shore at Malta after a shipwreck nearly sent him to a watery grave. The pressure on Paul was persistent, but from the conflict he always emerged victorious through the strength of Jesus Christ.

“We are hard pressed on every side, but not crushed; perplexed, but not in despair; persecuted, but not abandoned; struck down, but not destroyed. We always carry around in our body the death of Jesus, so that the life of Jesus may also be revealed in our body” (2 Cor. 4:8-10).

Difficult times and places are our schools of faith and character.

而我們何等經常見到「天上有門開了」，是為那些囚犯和被俘擄的；為那些患慢性病和因牢籠之苦而臥病在床的人；為那些孤獨地在地上遊盪的人；和為那些因家務要求而不能去到神之家的人。

要見天門打開，我們定須「被聖靈感動」（啟1:10），「清心」（太5:8）和在信中順服。我們須願意「將萬事當作有損的，因我以認識我主基督耶穌為至寶。」（腓3:8）神再成為我們的一切，「我們生活、動作、存留，都在乎祂。」（徒17:28）天上的門也必會在我們面前開啟。

摘自《每日靈修註釋》

六月二十九日

「我們在那裏看見亞納族人。」（民13:33）

疑慮的人說：「我們所窺探，經過之地是吞吃居民之地。」（民13:32）有信心的約書亞和迦勒說：「不要怕那地的居民，因為他們是我們的食物。」（民14:9）

選

只有在我們服事神，跟隨祂時才會遇上巨人。

往往是神的能力帶來衝突與爭鬥的。保羅所忍受的既長且困難的掙扎，是來自指控他的猶太人的。他面對烈風、毒蛇和地上並陰間的一切勢力。至終他僅僅免於被溺死在一場幾乎葬身大海的海難後，游往米利大島上岸。在保羅身上的壓力是持續的，但從衝突本身他總能藉耶穌基督的力量來顯出得勝。

「我們四面受敵，卻不被困住。心裏作難，卻不至失望。遭逼迫，卻不被丟棄。打倒了，卻不至死亡。身上常帶着耶穌的死，使耶穌的生，也顯明在我們身上。」（林後4:8-10）

困難的時刻和地方是我們學習信心和品格的學校。

June 30*I heard a hushed voice. (Job 4:16)*

I assumed being still enough to hear His voice would not be a difficult thing to do, so I tried to be still. No sooner had I begun to do so than complete pandemonium seemed to break loose. Suddenly I heard a thousand voices and sounds from without and within, until I could hear nothing except these incredible noises. Some were my own words, my own questions, and even my own prayers, while others were temptations of the Enemy, and the voices of the world's turmoil.

But God said, "Be still, and know that I am God" (Ps. 46:10). Then my mind was filled with worries over my responsibilities and plans for tomorrow, and God said again, "Be still."

As I listened and slowly learned to obey, I shut my ears to every other sound. Soon I discovered that once the other voices ceased, or once I ceased to hear them, "a gentle whisper" (1 Kings 19:12) began to speak in the depths of my being. And it spoke to me with an inexpressible tenderness, power, and comfort.

This "gentle whisper" became for me the voice of prayer, wisdom, and service. No longer did I need to work so hard to think, pray, or trust, because the Holy Spirit's "gentle whisper" in my heart was God's prayer in the secret places of my soul. It was His answer to all my questions, and His life and strength for my soul and body. His voice became the essence of all knowledge, prayer, and blessings, for it was the living God Himself as my life and my all.

A. B. Simpson

六月三十日

「我在靜默中聽見有聲音說：」(伯4:16)

我本以為有足夠的安靜，便能聽到神的聲音這不是難作的事，便嘗試安靜。當我一開始這樣作，那魔窟便似乎被掙脫一樣。我突然聽到來自裏裏外外的上千把聲音，所聽到的不過是令人難以置信的嘈雜聲音。有一些是我自己的說話，我自己的疑問，甚至是我自己的祈禱，而別的就是來自仇敵的試誘，和世人喧嚷的聲音。

神說：「你們要休息，要知道我是神。」(詩46:10)之後充滿我心的是明天的責任和計劃而來的掛慮，而神再次說：「要休息。」

我邊聽邊慢慢學習順服，關上耳朵不聽別的聲音。不久我發覺嘈雜聲一停止，我一旦不聽他們，「微小的聲音」(王上19:12)便開始在我深處說話，是以一難而形容的溫柔、權柄和安慰向我說的。

這「微小的聲音」成為我祈禱、智慧和事奉的聲音。我不再需努力思想、祈禱或信靠，因聖靈在我心中的「微小聲音」成了魂中隱密處向神的祈禱。它成為神對我一切的問題、祂的生命和我們魂和身體力量的回應。祂的聲音成為所有知識、祈禱和恩福的精髓，因作為我們生命和一切的就是永生神本身。

宣信

Streams in the Desert 1

荒漠甘泉上

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《荒漠甘泉》上

因方便印刷，本書分為上下二冊。

信主初期，教會兄姊都鼓勵以本書作為靈修輔助讀物。這確實是不可多得的屬靈寶藏，作者閱讀眾多屬靈書籍，將感動她的結集成書。

信主多年，才懂得某些真理，才感受到作者靈命之深。坊間已有本書的不同譯本，惟望神也用上本書，叫讀者們一同沾上前人的信心。

「人因為先知的名接待先知，必得先知所得的賞賜；人因為義人的名接待義人，必得義人所得的賞賜。」(太 10:41) 這給我們讀屬靈書籍的亮光。屬靈人得神的話，便是先知。聽他們的話就是聽神的話，世上肯聽先知的少之又少。聽後要「接待」，留在生命中。讓神的話發光發力，認罪除黑暗，得力奔天路，與先知同等賞賜，這是「上算」。以屬靈人為義人，一同走義路，得本於信以至於信，豐盛生命的賞賜。

在這荒漠中真需要神供給的甘泉，若神許可，還有別的靈修輔助讀物會跟大家分享。